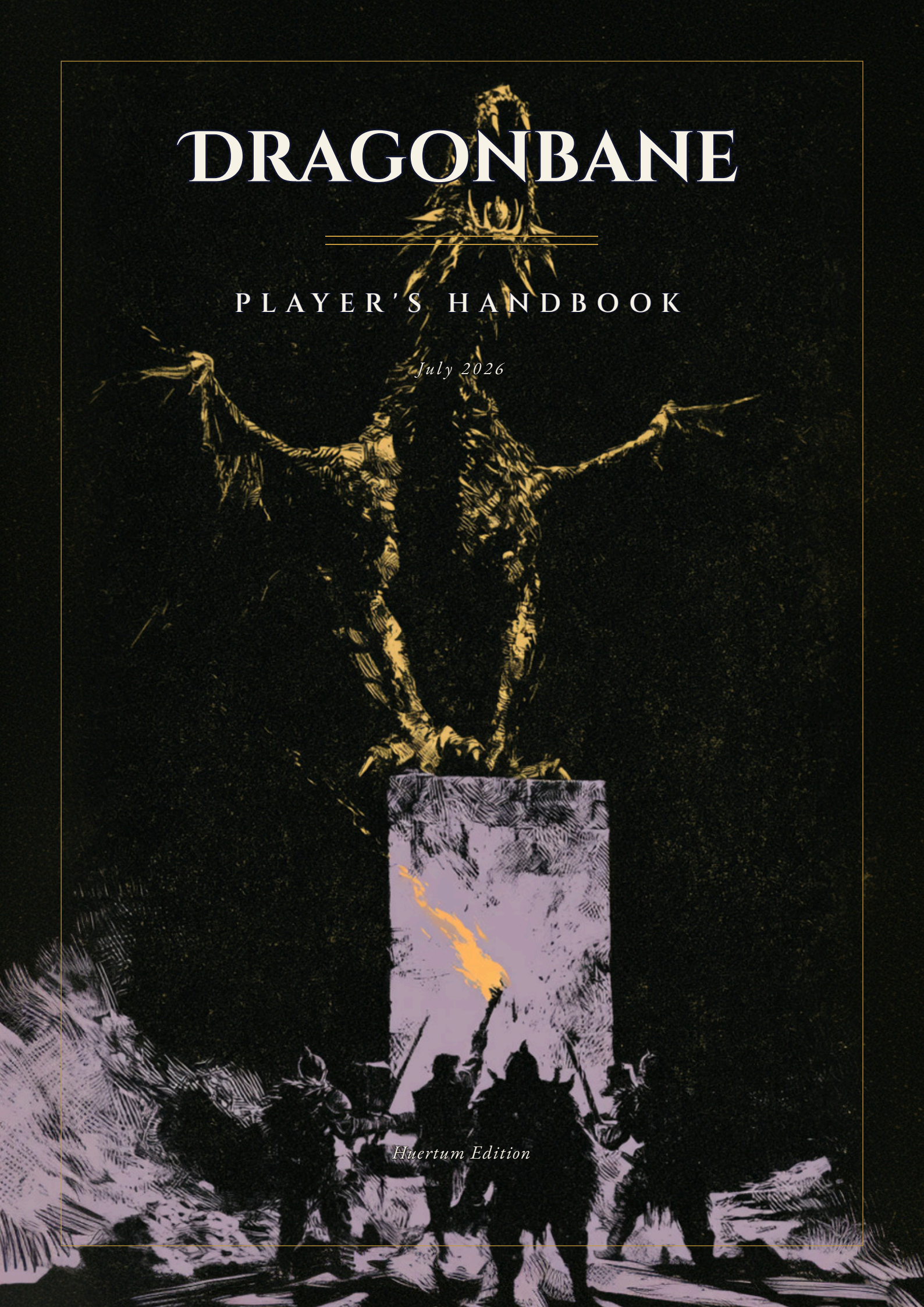


DRAGONBANE



PLAYER'S HANDBOOK

July 2026

Huertum Edition

DRAGONBANE

PLAYER'S HANDBOOK

Everything you need to play Sweden's most celebrated RPG

HOMEBREW EDITION · RE-TYPESET FOR TABLE USE
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THE
WORLD
AS WE
KNOW
IT



You are from Solaria: a few hundred miles of hill country and terraced valley, three cities, and a priesthood keeping the dying god Lorkhan alive through the blood of human sacrifice. That is the whole of the country. It used to be much larger, and everything around it is getting larger still.

Northwest — Maalkatia. The Maalkatian Kingdom has spent thirty years grinding down the tribes of the Dust Deserts, and is winning. They are patient and well organised, and do not look finished. Solaria shares no border with them. Not yet.

Far Northwest — the Eagle People. Beyond Maalkatia, and the newest arrivals in the world: they came in ships within living memory and settled a coastline. They do not write, they keep a great many gods, and by any measure they are barbarians. It is their missionaries that get discussed in Solaria: they travel further than their warriors, turn up in every polity from Ciclopea to the Republic, and are patiently converting people in all of them.

West — Ciclopea. A city on the edge of the Dust Deserts. Nearly everything moving between the Eagle People and the Wetlands of the far southwest passes through it, and Ciclopea takes a share on the way. They own a surprising amount.

Near Southwest — the Hermit Kingdom. Walled all the way round and shut. Nobody goes in or out except the occasional ambassador — Maalkatian, Ciclopean, or ours — who is received, watched and sent home again. It was part of Greater Solaria long before our ancestors took these hills: some of their

family names are recognisably cousins of ours. Centuries of talking to nobody has done the rest.

Southeast — the Degenerate Republic. Growing faster than anyone expected and swallowing the mountains and deserts that used to belong to the Black Kingdom. Their rapid expansion is worrying, but they are spreading themselves too thin, sending their homosexual magistrates to take over the Black Mountains and leaving their own city-states undermanned.

South — The Warring States. Our old country, formerly Greater Solaria, lost to invasion a century ago. There is no government there now, only warlords, and the number of them changes from season to season. Caravans that go south come back smaller, or late, or not at all, and have very little good to say.

The nearer problem for Solaria is resources. Trinimac, Almanacc and Bibec have all grown faster over the last twenty years than the terraces feeding them have. Unlike the once massive Greater Solaria that spanned from the south of the world to the north, the Three Cities have limited land, limited crops, and many mouths to feed. And Lorkhan's hunger grows, now that his Heart has been lost to the barbarians of the Dust Deserts. The world, for now, goes on, each region swinging through times of peace and war. But war, war never changes.

DRAGONBANE AND D&D

Dragonbane is the English edition of Drakar och Demoner, which has been running in Sweden since 1982, and it plays like a game written before builds and levels existed. You roll a D20 and want your skill level or under; there are no difficulty numbers and the GM never sets one. There are no classes and no levels — your background gives you a few starting skills, and after that you improve one at a time.

It is also more dangerous than you are used to. Hit points are your White score and barely grow, armour subtracts from damage rather than making you harder to hit, and you get one action a round — parrying or dodging spends the turn you meant to attack with. Three of you on one enemy will get through, and so will three of them on you. Walking away is a normal move here, not a failure. Three to five players suits it best.



CHARACTER CREATION



Character Sheet: To create your player character you need a character sheet. Your GM has them.

CREATING YOUR CHARACTER

This Chapter explains in detail how to create your player character. The summary below gives you an overview of the process. Grab a character sheet and a pencil and follow these steps:

1. Choose your **Colors**.
2. Note your **Color scores**.
3. Choose or roll your **kin**.
4. Note your **innate ability**.
5. Choose your **name**.
6. Calculate your **derived ratings**.
7. Choose or roll your **background**.
8. Choose your **trained skills**.
9. Note your **perk**.
10. Choose or roll your **gear**.
11. Choose or roll your **memento** (optional).

COLORS

Every adventurer draws on the five Colors: **White**, **Blue**, **Black**, **Red**, and **Green**. Your Colors are the first thing you decide about your character, and they alone set your five *Color scores* — the numbers that measure your basic physical and mental capabilities,

on a scale from 3 to 18. The higher the score, the better.

 **White:** Order, endurance, and the will to protect. Physical fitness and resilience. **Your**  **score is your Hit Points.**

 **Blue:** Knowledge, cunning, and patience. Mental acuity, intellect, and reasoning.

 **Black:** Ambition, resolve, and self-interest. Self-discipline and focus. **Your**  **score is your Willpower Points.**

 **Red:** Impulse, speed, and passion. Body control and fine motor skills.

 **Green:** Instinct, growth, and raw life. Muscle power and vigor.



THE COLOR WHEEL

The five Colors sit on a wheel in the order **White** – **Blue** – **Black** – **Red** – **Green**, and round again to White. Each Color has two **allies** – its neighbors on the wheel – and two **enemies**, the two Colors it does not touch.



COLOR	ALLIES	ENEMIES
 White	Blue, Green	Black, Red
 Blue	White, Black	Red, Green
 Black	Blue, Red	Green, White
 Red	Black, Green	White, Blue
 Green	Red, White	Blue, Black



BUILD	SCORES
Mono	18 / 13 / 13 / 10 / 8
Main & Minor	15 / 14 / 13 / 13 / 7
Dual	15 / 15 / 13 / 10 / 9



CHOOSING YOUR COLORS

There are three ways to commit to your Colors. **Monocolor** is a single Color – a sharply defined personality with intense characteristics and equally intense antagonist views. **Main & Minor** is one Color that is your dominant streak, and a secondary one that plays a more subdued role in who you are. **Dual** is two Colors held equally, a generalist astride both.

Your choice fixes your five scores. It is the only thing that does.

All three add up to the same total, and to the same total base chance (see *Skills*, below). They differ only in shape – how much you concentrate and how much you spread. If Blue is one of your Colors, you begin with one extra trained skill.



WHITE

White looks at a world of crime, injustice, hunger, disease, and suffering and insists that it does not have to be this way. There is enough for everyone; suffering persists only because people put themselves ahead of the welfare of others. A world without hunger, crime, or fear is genuinely achievable, and it asks one change of us — a very large one: that we learn to put the needs of the group ahead of our own, and ask what the group needs instead of what we want.

The obstacle is that human motivation is naturally inward-turned and selfish, not out of malice but because self-interest is the path of least resistance. Empathy is in everyone, but it must be nurtured. White's answer is structure — a society in which helping one another is built into the way things work, held in place by positive incentives of

reward, belonging, and status, and negative ones of lost resources, lost freedom, and exile from the group.

It works through two great tools. **Morality** teaches an objective right and wrong, usually reinforced by religion, so that doing good earns pride and ultimate reward while doing evil earns guilt and punishment; this is White's answer to selfishness. **Law** sets out a clear, public list of forbidden acts with proportional punishments, and a judicial system to weigh the circumstances; this is its answer to recklessness. Selfishness and recklessness are, to White, the two great threats to peace. It would prefer no enemies at all and one world working toward a shared vision, but it will settle for building smaller communities along the way and hope its example spreads.

Strength: order gives White more answers to more threats than any other Color, and given time to plan it can solve almost anything — with a clean conscience, which is not nothing.

Weakness: those answers are prescriptive, tailored to threats it anticipated, so the unforeseen catches it flat-footed. And its moral limits — refusing to kill, preferring the cell to the grave — sometimes let an enemy walk free to undo everything it built.



BLUE

Blue holds that every person is born a blank slate, free of any fixed mental content. Who you become is shaped by the people you meet, the knowledge you gather, the experiences you have, and the tools you can lay hands on — but above all by your own drive. You become who you want to be.

Four things follow from that. **Knowledge is power:** good choices require information, so education, formal and informal, out of books and people and

the world alike, is the first priority, pursued as early and as deeply as possible. **Deliberation beats haste:** never rush a decision, but take the time to understand every ramification, and the choice you make will be the right one for the long run — you do not pick a destination by driving off at random. **Experience matters:** knowing is not the same as doing, and only a life lived teaches you what you actually enjoy. **Tools and technology** let you do what you otherwise could not; when the words blur you do not give up reading, you get spectacles.

Blue's ideal society prizes efficiency over expediency and intellect over emotion, reveres its teachers as its central pillar, and builds depositories of knowledge open to all, so that everyone may reach their potential. The same optimization scales from a single person up through family, community, and society.

Strength: Blue simply knows more. It sees and understands systems that others cannot, which makes it the master of control and of unmaking a spell before it lands, and given time it can build the resources to answer any threat.

Weakness: it needs that time. Blue's power is reactive, and an aggressive or oblique opponent who refuses to fight on its terms can overwhelm it long before it is ready.



BLACK

Black considers itself the most misunderstood of the Colors. What it actually wants is for every person to have the opportunity to thrive. It does not expect everyone to succeed — most will not — but anyone willing to work and dedicate themselves deserves the chance.

Black is the pragmatist. The world is a harsh place, people are fundamentally selfish, and Black does not think that is a bad thing. Everyone deserves a champion, and the only person who reliably has your interests at heart is you. **Be your own champion:** fit your own life vest before helping anyone else, and help those you love when it does not cost you what you need. **Merit decides:** fates rise and fall on accomplishment, gain comes at someone else's loss,

and that is acceptable — the winners earned it and the losers were not as good. **Conquer fear:** most people fail because they will not seize the opportunity in front of them, paralyzed by the fear of failing or of doing what they were told not to do. This is not recklessness; Black's pursuit of excellence is careful, methodical, and ruthless.

The goal is **power** — the ability to do what you want and live on your own terms. The method is a loop: decide what you want, list every step needed to reach it, name the obstacles in the way, take inventory of every resource you hold, then spend those resources to break those obstacles. Then begin again, and do whatever it takes.

Strength: Black sees opportunity where others see none, and it has no taboos, no qualms, no mercy, and no limitations. It is unattached — it will sacrifice anything of value to gain what it needs — and it will take a calculated risk.

Weakness: things do not always work out. Meddling with forces the other Colors leave alone means some of those risks go badly wrong. With risk comes reward, and also punishment.



RED

Red asks what the purpose of a finite life is, and answers: to live it to the fullest, so that at the end you can say you found love, made friends, did exciting things, and have great stories to tell. The recipe has two steps.

Listen to your own body. It knows what you need. Hunger tells you to eat and tiredness tells you to rest; loneliness, anger, and sadness are the same body telling you it needs something else. Your inner voice is not a danger to be managed. **Then act on what it tells you.** Inaction is easy and safe and empty. Acting — saying the thing, trying the thing — may or may not get you what you wanted, but you are always better off than if you had never tried. Life is messy. Embrace the mess.

What separates the fulfilled from the unfulfilled is the willingness to act. Passion is what feeds you: care about something with your whole heart, and have as many passions as you have hours for. Red admits this

invites conflict, since two people may want the same thing, but conflict, disagreement, and even violence are people being people, not a catastrophe. Desire is not evil; it is the core of experience. Better a life of high highs and low lows than a life of feeling nothing at all.

Red will also tell you that anger is only one of its faces. Love, happiness, sadness, fear, and disgust weigh just as much. The point is all of the emotions, not only the ones that break things.

Strength: speed. Red decides fast and acts fast — attacking before its enemy has had time to put out their cigarette — and paired with its capacity for destruction, that aggression is a genuine threat.

Weakness: short-sightedness. Acting in the moment and considering the consequences afterward gets Red into trouble, and it makes more than its share of mistakes, though it will insist that mistakes are excellent teachers. Some would say Red is its own worst enemy.



GREEN

Green is the one Color not arguing for change. The world is not broken and does not need fixing. Nature is already a perfect, self-balancing system, and the purpose of a life is to accept what is rather than chase what might be. The other four all claim the world is somehow less than it should be; Green's answer is to stop striving and start acknowledging.

Sit quietly in nature, Green says, and four truths surface. There is a deep **peace** in it, and a sense of belonging — you are part of the world, not a stranger passing through it. **Everything has a role** in the ecosystem. **Everything is interconnected**, nothing exists in a vacuum, and to understand a creature you must first understand where it lives. And **everything happens for a reason** — Green is not opposed to change, but change in nature is slow, purposeful, and measured in lifetimes rather than minutes.

Out of that acceptance comes Green's path to satisfaction, in four steps: acknowledge that you are part of something vast; discover your innate skills, since every creature is born with what it needs; find by trial and error how those skills are best applied,

which is your role and your destiny; then fulfill that role, and help others find theirs. It is the simplest pitch any of the Colors make. You need change nothing about yourself, because you are already perfect. You need only change how you think, and accept it.

Strength: unwavering belief. Every other Color is still searching for something; Green has its answers already, and that certainty grants a focus the others lack. It knows what it wants, and it is all in.

Weakness: it leans too hard on its own intuition. When its routines fail, Green struggles to find another way.



PLACING THE SCORES

Deal your scores out in this order:

1. **Your chosen Colors take the highest scores** — your main Color first, then your minor. A mono character's single Color takes the 18.
2. **Any Color allied to both of your Colors comes next**, then Colors allied to *one* of them.
3. **Colors that oppose your Colors take what is left.**

Where two Colors sit at the same rank, you choose which of them gets which score. And you may always place your **lowest** score on any Color that opposes at least one of your Colors — never on an ally.

You can never have more than 18 in a Color. Once placed, your Color scores rarely change during the game.

KIN

You come from **Solaria**: a wide country of hills and terraced valleys, ruled by the priesthood of Lorkhan, the sun god, who has been dying for as long as there have been records of him. His blood runs out of him and the world continues only so long as it is replaced. Two peoples live under that arrangement: the

PLACING THE SCORES – THREE EXAMPLES

Mono Red. Red takes the 18. Red's allies, Black and Green, take the two 13s. Red's enemies, White and Blue, take the 10 and the 8 – and since White is your hit points, you give White the 10 and Blue the 8.

Main Green, minor White. Green takes 15, White 14. Green and White are allies, so no Color is allied to both. Red is allied to Green and Blue is allied to White, so those two take the 13s, and Black – which opposes both of your Colors – takes the 7. Red and Blue each oppose one of your Colors too, so you may move the 7 onto either of them instead.

Dual White and Black. Each takes a 15. Blue is allied to both, so Blue takes the 13. Red and Green each ally one of your Colors and oppose the other, so they take the 10 and the 9 in whichever order you please.

Dunameri, who brought Lorkhan with them, and the **Sunameri**, who were here before he arrived. Choose the one you want.

Innate Ability: Each kin has an *innate ability* that the other kin cannot learn. In most cases, using such an ability requires *Willpower Points (WP)*. Write down your innate ability in the Abilities & Spells section on your character sheet.



LANGUAGE

All player characters can speak, read, and write **Solarian**, the common tongue of the polity. Centuries of living in the same valleys has ground the conquerors' speech together with the conquered's, and almost everyone you meet in Solaria will speak either as a result. Each kin also keeps an older tongue: the Dunameri for their liturgical speech, in which the rites of Lorkhan are muttered, and Old Sunameri, mostly spoken by grandmothers of that kin. To understand any other language, the **LANGUAGES** skill is used.



DUNAMERI



Your ancestors came up from the south about four hundred years ago. They arrived as an army and then stayed, and within three generations there was a priest of Lorkhan in every temple from the coast to the far passes. The empire they built came apart a century ago under invasions your grandparents still can't put in the right order. Solaria is the piece of it that didn't fall over: a few hundred miles of hill country holding on to the paperwork of something much larger.

Besides the god, what your people brought was record-keeping. The tithe rolls, the canal courts, the calendar everyone plants by, the exact wording you use to swear an oath with a hand on a stone — all of that is Dunameri, whoever happens to be administering it now. It has outlasted the army by a comfortable margin.

Lorkhan has been dying for a long, long time. If he ever truly dies, the world will end. Your ancestors have been capturing foreigners and slaves to sacrifice to Lorkhan for countless generations.

About one Solarian in three is Dunameri. The priesthood is yours and so are the old land grants, but four hundred years in the same valleys blurs a lot, and the division the temple describes is not the one you will actually run into. Your grandmother may well be Sunameri. There are Dunameri tenants who owe money to Sunameri lenders, and plenty of Dunameri who have never been near a land grant. What is left of the difference is mostly a question of office — who is owed, who owes, and who keeps the book.

Dunameri are culturally conservative and past-looking. They hold grudges easily, and their empire's recent collapse has instilled in them a collective anxiousness that puts them on the defensive.

Male Names: Arvel, Ben-Mivon, Dovran, Gershil, Hlen, Mordai, Lleril, Shimo, Mivon, Baru, Nads, Relms, Varon, Zev, Dravin.

Female Names: Avelka, Daliah, Rivka, Shifra, Tzivra, Liril, Malkah, Zlata, Nira, Bat, Yuditha.

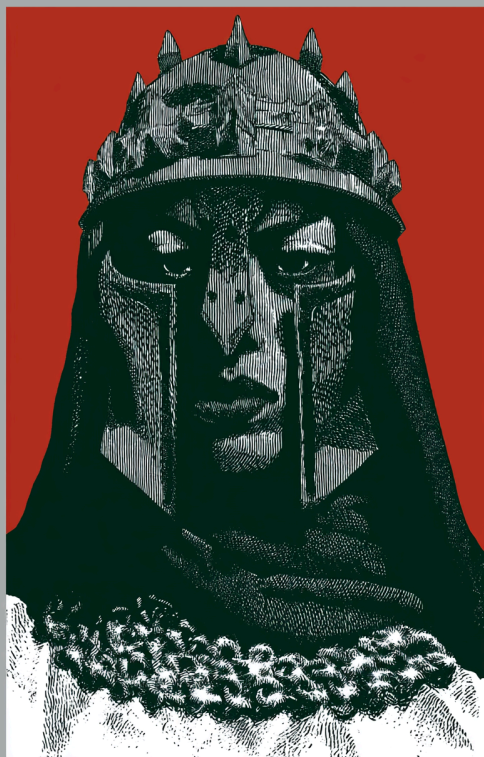
ABILITY: UNFORGIVING

◆ Willpower Points: 3

You can activate this ability when attacking someone who harmed you in the past (at least 1 point of damage) and get a boon to the roll. It does not matter when the damage was inflicted. It may be wise to write down the names of everyone who harms you, so you do not forget them.



SUNAMERI



Your family was in these hills before the Dunameri turned up. Sunameri dug the cisterns, cut the terraces, and built most of the temples the priests sing in now. Over everything stood the Tribunal, three gods worshipped everywhere Sunameri lived, and under the Tribunal came a god for each city, each spring, each particular black rock. When the conquest came the stones came down, and a god with no house left doesn't have much of a voice. The small ones survive as a word your grandmother says before she eats, and nobody can tell you what it used to mean. The three are still named at a birth and at a burial, by people who also go up at the turn of the year and give to Lorkhan, and who see nothing strange in doing both.

The temples went, but families kept their own dead. Most Sunameri houses have a niche by the door with the household in it: a bowl, a bead, a bit of hair, a name scratched small. You say something on your way out and again on your way back. You tell them when there's a baby, and when a debt finally

gets paid. No priest has ever really tried to put a stop to it — Lorkhan is a sun god with a calendar to run and no argument with anybody's grandmother, and a shrine inside a doorway is difficult to knock down anyway.

There are many more Sunameri than Dunameri, roughly seven in ten, and you are everywhere: the fields, the workshops, the customs houses, the caravans, and the back rooms of the temple doing the jobs the priests won't. Almost none of the land is yours. Almost all of the trades are, and a trade gets handed down inside a family much the way a grant gets handed down inside a name.

Four hundred years has taken most of the edge off the rest of it. You use the Dunameri calendar because by now it is simply the calendar. Your cousin married a Dunameri and nobody thought that worth commenting on. The conquest still gets talked about and it is still true, but it isn't what people are actually arguing about this year: the tithe has gone up, the passes aren't safe, and the god is not getting any better. Those are everyone's problems.

What the arrangement has left you is less a grudge than a habit — don't count on only one way in. A Sunameri who can't get through the front knows four people who can get them in round the side, and will have worked six jobs before turning thirty. It isn't craftiness so much as arithmetic, given who the front door has belonged to your whole life.

Male Names: Altugar, Ayberion, Bekezar, Elario, Gokhael, Ilterion, Korayel, Tarkans, Temuriel, Yalcenar.

Female Names: Aybanu, Cereniel, Dilaraen, Elcinara, Gulseris, Leylathil, Narinwe, Sevinciel, Yulduzara, Zuleyra.

ABILITY: ADAPTIVE

◆ Willpower Points: 3

When rolling for a skill, you can choose to make the roll using another skill of your choice associated with your primary Color(s). You must be able to justify how you use the selected skill instead of the normal one.

DERIVED RATINGS

Based on your Colors, you have a number of derived ratings that are used in various ways.



MOVEMENT

This rating determines how many meters you can run in a round of combat (page 43). It is based on your kin, then modified by your . That modifier is your *movement bonus*, and you also add it to your initiative roll in combat (page 41).



DAMAGE BONUS

Your damage bonus increases the damage inflicted by your attacks. You have two separate damage bonuses – one for -based weapons and one for -based

weapons. Brawling is the exception: it is a skill, but unarmed damage uses your damage bonus. It is your build that puts weight behind a punch, not your aim.



HIT POINTS (HP)

This rating determines how much damage you can take. Your maximum number of **HP** is equal to your score, but can be increased by the perk Robust. For more information about damage, see Chapter 4.



WILLPOWER POINTS (WP)

Willpower Points are used for sorcery, as well as innate abilities and perks. Your maximum number of **WP** is equal to your score, but can be increased by the perk Focused.

KIN	MOVEMENT
Dunameri	10
Sunameri	10
1–6	–4
7–9	–2
10–12	+0
13–15	+2
16–18	+4

	DAMAGE BONUS
≤12	—
13–16	+D4
17+	+D6

COLOR SCORE	BASE CHANCE
1–5	3
6–8	4
9–12	5
13–15	6
16–18	7

SKILLS

Skills represent knowledge and abilities you have acquired during (or prior to) your life as an adventurer. They are important, as they determine how effectively you can perform certain actions in the game. There are thirty core skills in the base game, and they are all described in detail in the next Chapter. Your skills are measured by *skill level* on a scale from 1 to 18. The higher, the better.

Base Chance: Every skill is connected to a Color, which determines your *base chance* in that skill. This is indicated on the character sheet and in Chapter 3. The base chance is a "free" skill level that you get automatically. See the table below.

Starting Skill Levels: In addition to the base chances, you start out with ten *trained skills*, plus one more if Blue is one of your Colors. At the start of the game, your level in a trained skill is equal to *twice* the base chance. Six of your trained skills must be selected from those listed by your background (below). The rest are chosen freely. You can increase your skill levels during the game.

Secondary Skills: Beyond the core skills there are *secondary skills*, such as the schools of sorcery. You don't get a base chance in any secondary skill.

PERKS

Perks are special abilities that give you specific advantages and benefits in the game. You will find a range of perks described in the next Chapter, and more can be added in future supplements.

You start the game with one perk, determined by your background (below). You can gain new perks during play (page 29). Note that some perks require a minimum skill level. Such requirements don't apply to your starting perk.

Sorcerers: If you play a sorcerer, you don't get any perk at the start of the game – your sorcery will make up for that disadvantage! You can earn new perks during play just like other backgrounds, however.

SORCERY

Sorcery is divided into five schools, and each school is a separate skill. As a newly created sorcerer you must select one, which then becomes one of your trained skills (based on ①).

You may choose three rank 1 spells and three magickal tricks from your school or general sorcery (page 57). Alchemy has no magickal tricks – take three rank 1 recipes instead.

You can learn more spells, and schools of sorcery, during the game. For more on sorcery, see Chapter 5.

GEAR

When going on adventures you need the right gear. You must write down all the items you are carrying on your character sheet. Any weapons *at hand*, as well as the armor, helmet, and shield you are wearing, are listed in the respective boxes, while other items are recorded under Inventory.

Write down one item per row. If it is not listed on your sheet, you do not have it with you. Lists of weapons and other equipment are found on pages 73–81.

Starting Gear: Your background (below) determines what gear you can choose from at the start of the game. You may roll or select one of the three sets of items listed by your background. If you want to, you may go back and adjust your trained skills to fit your gear. You can also have a memento (below). In addition, you have simple clothes which do not need to be written down.

MEMENTO

In addition to your other equipment, you can have a *memento* – an item of great sentimental value that you always carry with you. Choose something suitable or roll on the table below.

A memento is always a tiny item with no practical use, but once per gaming session you can use your memento to recover an additional condition during a stretch rest (page 52).

If you lose your memento, you may choose a new item that you have found on your adventures, at the end of the gaming session.

D20 MEMENTO

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | Your trusty old shoes |
| 2 | A simple silver medallion |
| 3 | A letter from an old friend or relative |
| 4 | A ragged old journal |

D20 MEMENTO

- | | |
|----|---|
| 5 | A bracelet passed down in your family |
| 6 | A wooden figurine you got as a child |
| 7 | A strangely shaped stone |
| 8 | A lead coin from a treasure sought by your mother or father |
| 9 | An old pewter tankard |
| 10 | A horn taken as a trophy from a monster |
| 11 | A fang taken as a trophy from a beast |
| 12 | A couple of simple dice made of bone |
| 13 | A locket containing a lock of hair |
| 14 | An ornate key |
| 15 | A hand-drawn map you inherited |
| 16 | A ring with an inscription |
| 17 | A bone whistle |
| 18 | Your mother's or father's ragged old hat |
| 19 | A tithe token from a year your family could not pay |
| 20 | A beautifully carved pipe |

ENCUMBRANCE

You can carry a number of items equal to half your  (rounded up) in your Inventory without difficulty. Only the items written down in your Inventory box count towards your encumbrance.

Weapons at Hand: You can have up to three weapons *at hand*, which means that they are worn on your belt or otherwise readily available for use in combat. Weapons kept at hand are recorded under Weapons on the character sheet and do not count toward your encumbrance. Shields count as weapons and are also recorded here.

Helmet & Armor: Any helmet or armor worn on your body is recorded in its respective section and does not count toward your encumbrance.

Food: Up to four rations of food count as one item in terms of encumbrance. Always record the number of rations you have left in your Inventory.

Torches & Lanterns: A torch, lamp, or lantern is an item. Their fire may go out (page 52). Lamps and lanterns can be refilled with lamp oil.

Arrows & Slingstones: You do not have to count every arrow you are carrying. Instead, each quiver of arrows counts as a single item. As long as you have the quiver, you can use your weapon. Slingstones do not need to be noted down at all – you are assumed to have enough of those.

Backpack: A backpack increases your carrying capacity by 2. It does not count toward your encumbrance, but you can only carry one backpack at a time.



HEAVY ITEMS

Really heavy items count as two, three, or even more normal items in terms of encumbrance. These will be indicated as having weight 2, 3, 4, and so on. In your inventory, heavy items take up a number of rows equal to their weight. If no weight is specified, it is always 1.



TINY ITEMS

Small and light items that can be hidden in a closed fist are called *tiny*. Items of this size do not affect your encumbrance at all. Tiny items are recorded in their own section on the character sheet and do not take up any space in your Inventory.

Coins: Single coins count as tiny items and do not affect your encumbrance as long as they are fewer than 100. 100–199 coins count as one item, 200–299 as two, and so on.



OVER-ENCUMBERED

You can temporarily carry more than your normal encumbrance limit. In that case you must make a 🎲 roll whenever you want to move in a round of combat or walk for a shift of travel. If the roll fails, you must either drop what you are carrying or stay where you are.

Carrying Others: While carrying another person, you automatically count as over-encumbered and cannot fight in combat.



RIDING ANIMALS & VEHICLES

If you have a zebra or some other riding animal, the animal can carry your gear for you. Wagons and boats can carry even heavier loads. You can find them in the gear lists on page 81.

BACKGROUND

You also need to select a background for your character. All the player characters are adventurers, but you have learned a thing or two before the game begins. Your choice of background will determine much about your character, mainly your skills – six of your trained starting skills (above) must be chosen from those listed for your background. Your background also determines what gear you start out with and which perk you get. There are ten backgrounds to choose from, all described on the following pages. You are free to select a background or roll for one randomly using the table below.

D10	BACKGROUND
1	Artisan
2	Barbarian
3	Colonist
4	Hunter
5	Magistrate
6	Mercenary
7	Priest
8	Scholar
9	Sorcerer
10	Thief



D6 GEAR: BARBARIAN

- | | |
|-----|--|
| 1–2 | Broadsword/morning star, shield (small), plate armor, great helm, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D12 orichalcum |
| 3–4 | Flail/warhammer (small), shield (small), chainmail, open helmet, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D12 orichalcum |
| 5–6 | Short sword, lance, shield (small), chainmail, open helmet, combat trained zebra, D6 food rations, D12 orichalcum |

THE TEN BACKGROUNDS



ARTISAN

With a decent hammer, a trowel, and mortar, a skilled artisan can astonish even the gods. They are proud individuals, these tamers of nature and physical matter. Whether they be builders, bricklayers, wainwrights, blacksmiths, tanners, or coopers, the artisans are driven by a solemn mission to bring order and structure out of chaos. They construct bridges, houses, and fortifications, forge weapons and tools, mold pots and jugs, make barrels, and craft leather armor from tanned animal hides. Every village needs capable artisans, and they are often greatly respected for their practical and extremely useful expertise.

- ◆ **Skills:** Axes, Brawling, Crafting, Hammers, Knives, Sleight of Hand, Spot Hidden, Swords

D6 GEAR: ARTISAN

- | | |
|-----|---|
| 1–2 | Warhammer (small), leather armor, blacksmith's tools, torch, flint & tinder, D8 food rations, D8 orichalcum |
| 3–4 | Handaxe, leather armor, carpentry tools, torch, rope (hemp), flint & tinder, D8 food rations, D8 orichalcum |
| 5–6 | Knife, leather armor, tanner's tools, lantern, lamp oil, flint & tinder, D8 food rations, D8 orichalcum |

- ◆ **Perk:** Master Blacksmith, Master Carpenter *or* Master Tanner



BARBARIAN

You are Solarian, mostly. You have the name, or half of it. But you were not raised in the valleys. Perhaps your mother was taken on the road and never came back; perhaps your father married outside and stayed out; perhaps you were sent away young, as an apprentice, or as somebody's guarantee that a peace would hold. The Dust Deserts, a coast town of the Eagle People, a frontier village in the Republic – it hardly matters which, because to a Solarian they are all the same word. Barbarian says nothing about how you fight. It is a remark about where you learned to eat, swear, mourn and bargain, and twenty years in Trinimac does not stop it being true.

- ◆ **Skills:** Beast Lore, Hammers, Inspire, Myths & Legends, Persuasion, Riding, Spears, Swords
- ◆ **Perk:** Guardian

D6 GEAR: HUNTER

- 1–2 Dagger, short bow, quiver, leather armor, sleeping pelt, torch, flint & tinder, rope (hemp), snare, D8 food rations, D6 orichalcum
- 3–4 Knife, longbow, quiver, leather armor, sleeping pelt, torch, flint & tinder, rope (hemp), fishing rod, D8 food rations, D6 orichalcum
- 5–6 Dagger, sling, leather armor, sleeping pelt, torch, flint & tinder, rope (hemp), snare, D8 food rations, D6 orichalcum

**COLONIST**

Solaria has more mouths than it has terraces, and the one answer everybody agrees on is to go out and make more Solaria. Colonists are the ones who actually go – southeast into scrub the Republic has not got round to yet, or west toward the Dust Deserts, where the ground is poor but nobody is holding it very hard. You walk the land, you buy it or you claim it, you put up a wall, and you write home for more people. It is not empty, and the people already on it are not asked, which is a thing colonists have a hundred ways of not saying out loud. In the Three Cities you are a patriot and there is a subscription with your name on it. Out on the line you are whatever your neighbours have decided you are.

- ◆ **Skills:** Awareness, Bartering, Bluffing, Evade, Knives, Persuasion, Spot Hidden, Swimming
- ◆ **Perk:** Treasure Hunter

**HUNTER**

Snaring hares, knifing boars, and silently stalking deer in the depths of the forest with arrows on their bowstrings. Hunters live for the hunt and the catch. Killing one's prey in a respectful manner and making use of all its parts – for food, clothes, tools, and weapons – is a sacred calling for all true hunters. Their home and destiny are in the wilds; the magnificent, untamed, and cruel. That is where they find peace of mind and gather their strength. That is where their ruthless gods dwell. Many hunters are therefore quite solitary and sometimes find it difficult to behave properly among people.

- ◆ **Skills:** Acrobatics, Awareness, Bows, Bushcraft, Hunting & Fishing, Knives, Slings, Sneaking
- ◆ **Perk:** Companion

**MAGISTRATE**

Solaria runs on writing. The tithe rolls, the canal courts, the land grants, the exact wording of an oath sworn with a hand on a stone – all of it goes down on parchment, and somebody has to read it, check it,

D6 GEAR: COLONIST

- 1–2 Dagger, sleeping pelt, torch, flint & tinder, rope (hemp), donkey, D6 food rations, D12 orichalcum
- 3–4 Knife, sleeping pelt, lantern, lamp oil, flint & tinder, field kitchen, donkey, cart, D6 food rations, D12 orichalcum
- 5–6 Dagger, sleeping pelt, large tent, oil lamp, lamp oil, flint & tinder, backpack, D6 food rations, D12 orichalcum



D6 GEAR: MAGISTRATE

- 1–2 Dagger, quill & ink, notebook, abacus, lantern, lamp oil, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D10 orichalcum
- 3–4 Knife, quill & ink, parchment, book, leather armor, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D10 orichalcum
- 5–6 Knife, quill & ink, notebook, padlock, chest, riding zebra, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D10 orichalcum

D6 GEAR: MERCENARY

- 1–2 Broadsword/battle axe/morning star, small shield, chainmail, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D6 orichalcum
- 3–4 Short sword/handaxe/short spear, light cannon, fire salts, leather armor, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D6 orichalcum
- 5–6 Long spear, studded leather armor, open helmet, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D6 orichalcum

argue about it and say what it means. That is a magistrate. Part clerk, part advocate, part auditor, you ride a circuit of villages with a notebook and settle what the headman cannot: who owes what, whose boundary is whose, and which of two brothers is lying. The office is Dunameri by tradition and steadily more Sunameri in practice, because somebody has to do the work. Nobody is pleased to see a magistrate. Everybody sends for one.

- ◆ **Skills:** Awareness, Bartering, Bluffing, Knives, Languages, Myths & Legends, Persuasion, Spot Hidden
- ◆ **Perk:** Silver-Tongued

**MERCENARY**

Mercenaries earn their living by following the way of the sword. It may of course also be the way of the spear or cannon, but a mercenary's specialty is always weapon proficiency and violence. There is work: the passes are not safe, the Warring States pay in whatever they have left, and no caravan leaves Ciclopea without somebody walking beside it. But this is not to say that all mercenaries are driven by bloodlust. For some it is a matter of professional pride to achieve the maximum effect with minimal

bloodshed; others are lazy and prefer saber-rattling to actual combat. Many are troubled people, haunted by nightmares and bad memories of a life spent in the company of death. They can therefore be surprisingly sentimental, prone to tears and compassionate embraces.

- ◆ **Skills:** Axes, Bows, Brawling, Cannons, Evade, Hammers, Spears, Swords
- ◆ **Perk:** Veteran

**PRIEST**

Somebody has to say the words. In Solaria that usually means a priest of Lorkhan: keeping the calendar, collecting the tithe, and standing at the bowl on the days the rite requires one. It is a Dunameri office, and a comfortable one if you rise. But it is not the only priesthood in the country. Sunameri houses still keep the Tribunal - three great gods, and a long tail of smaller ones whose temples came down centuries ago - and whoever knows which words go with which name is a priest, whether or not the temple would use the word. Foreign priests turn up as well, mostly Eagle People missionaries, who travel further than their warriors do and are in no hurry about it. What all of them



D6 GEAR: PRIEST

1–2	Lyre, knife, oil lamp, lamp oil, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D8 orichalcum
3–4	Flute, dagger, rope (hemp), torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D8 orichalcum
5–6	Horn, knife, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D8 orichalcum

have in common is the voice. The rite is sung, and a priest who cannot carry a line of it is no use to anybody.

- ◆ **Skills:** Acrobatics, Bluffing, Evade, Knives, Languages, Myths & Legends, Performance, Persuasion
- ◆ **Perk:** Musician

**SCHOLAR**

Scholarly individuals gather knowledge about nature and the shrouded history of the world. They seek the truth in order to understand the unseen forces and deep structures that hold the universe together as a single entity. Some are specialists with specific areas of expertise, such as monsters, plants, or dead languages. Others pride themselves in avoiding limitations and dedicating themselves to an all-encompassing, non-discriminatory pursuit of knowledge where the mating calls of dragons, the foaming of beer, and the inner workings of minerals are all covered by the same academic system. Scholars are often well-versed in myths, legends, and folklore, and have learned to decipher ancient languages and forgotten scripts.

- ◆ **Skills:** Awareness, Beast Lore, Bushcraft, Evade, Healing, Languages, Myths & Legends, Spot Hidden

- ◆ **Perk:** Precognition

**SORCERER**

Sorcerers have learned to control the ancient forces that permeate nature and the primordial structures of the world. It is not a uniform calling, but includes a motley crew of individualists and headstrong eccentrics. There are five schools of sorcery, each with its own view of what sorcery is and how it works. Animists believe that everything in the world has a spiritual presence and see sorcery as a power lent by nature's spirits. Elementalists describe sorcery in terms of four elements that constitute the essence of all things. Daedrologists open a door onto Oblivion and bargain with whatever answers. Symbolists write their sorcery down as marks that work on whoever sees them. Alchemists brew theirs and carry it in a bottle.

- ◆ **Animist Skills:** Animism, Beast Lore, Bushcraft, Evade, Healing, Hunting & Fishing, Sneaking, Staves
- ◆ **Daedrologist Skills:** Daedrology, Bartering, Bluffing, Evade, Languages, Myths & Legends, Persuasion, Sneaking

D6 GEAR: SCHOLAR

1–2	Staff, notebook, quill, sleeping pelt, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D10 orichalcum
3–4	Knife, book (any subject), sleeping pelt, oil lamp, lamp oil, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D10 orichalcum
5–6	Short sword, bandages, sleeping poison (one dose), sleeping pelt, lantern, lamp oil, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D10 orichalcum

SORCERY

As a sorcerer you can use sorcery. You must select one of the five schools of sorcery, which then becomes one of your trained skills. As a newly created sorcerer you may choose three rank 1 spells and three magickal tricks. You can only choose spells from your school or from the general sorcery category. You also get a grimoire where all your spells are listed.

Alchemy works a little differently: it has no magickal tricks, so take three rank 1 recipes instead, and add a small field laboratory and D6 doses of general herbs to your starting gear. For more on sorcery, see Chapter 5.

D6 GEAR: THIEF

1–2 Dagger, sling, rope (hemp), grappling hook, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D10 orichalcum

3–4 Knife, lockpicks (simple), torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D10 orichalcum

5–6 Two daggers, marbles, rope (hemp), torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D10 orichalcum

- ◆ **Elementalist Skills:** Elementalism, Awareness, Evade, Healing, Languages, Myths & Legends, Spot Hidden, Staves
- ◆ **Symbolist Skills:** Symbolism, Awareness, Crafting, Evade, Myths & Legends, Sleight of Hand, Sneaking, Spot Hidden
- ◆ **Alchemist Skills:** Alchemy, Bartering, Beast Lore, Bushcraft, Healing, Myths & Legends, Sleight of Hand, Spot Hidden
- ◆ **Perk:** As a sorcerer, you don't get a starting perk. Instead, you get your sorcery.

trade. They like to refer to solemn principles of honor and honesty among thieves – something that is often hard to take seriously for theft victims and other outsiders. Many thieves organize themselves into guilds; others take pride in working independently and walk alone through the night and the shadows. Some are discreet specialists whose only method is guile, but the thief's trade also includes brutal brigands who do not hesitate to use weapons to achieve their ends.

- ◆ **Skills:** Acrobatics, Awareness, Bluffing, Evade, Knives, Sleight of Hand, Sneaking, Spot Hidden
- ◆ **Perk:** Backstabbing



THIEF

Thieves see themselves as professional experts specialized in the acquisition of other people's property. It is a proud and surprisingly principled

D6 GEAR: SORCERER

1–2 Staff, orbuculum, grimoire, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D8 orichalcum

3–4 Knife, wand, grimoire, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D8 orichalcum

5–6 Amulet, grimoire, sleeping pelt, torch, flint & tinder, D6 food rations, D8 orichalcum



EXPERIENCE

To earn a new perk, you must meet its skill requirement.

Life as an adventurer brings many challenges, and if you survive you are sure to change and maybe even learn a thing or two along the way.

Advancement Marks: When you have rolled a dragon or demon (page 31) when using a skill, tick the check box next to that skill. Then, at the end of every game session, place two more advancement marks next to any unmarked skills of your choice. You do not have to justify them to anybody.

Advancement Rolls: After placing your marks, roll a D20 for each of them – if the result *exceeds* your current skill level, it is increased by one, up to a maximum of 18. Once you have made your advancement rolls, erase the marks and start over in the next game session.

Teacher: A shift of intense training with a teacher whose skill level is 15 or higher and exceeds your own gives you an additional advancement roll to improve the skill in question. Make the roll immediately, without waiting for the session to end. However, a teacher can only raise a skill level by *one* – after that you must improve the skill through experience before you can get more help from a teacher. Teachers, especially those with high skill levels, are usually very expensive.

Sorcery: A school of sorcery that you already know can be improved like any other skill. However, learning new spells and new schools of sorcery requires special training. For more information, see Chapter 5.

Perks: You can earn new perks during play in two ways:

- ◆ When you increase a skill level to 18, you immediately gain a new perk of your choice. If the skill level is reduced below 18 for any reason, you keep the perk and you will even gain a new ability if the skill level is increased to 18 again.
- ◆ After a grand heroic deed, the GM or the adventure can reward you with a perk. This should be a rare event, never more than once per standard-length adventure.



SKILLS



Sooner or later a decisive situation will arise, a point of no return, a conflict that conversation alone cannot resolve. Then it's time to break out the dice and use one of your skills.

This Chapter also describes perks, which allow you to perform extraordinary actions that ordinary people cannot.

ROLL THE DICE

There are thirty core skills in total in the game, not counting secondary skills like the schools of sorcery, and they are all described later in this Chapter. Each skill is connected to one of the five Colors, which determines your base chance in the skill when you create your player character.

When using a skill, first describe what your player character is trying to achieve. Then roll a D20. A result that is lower than or equal to your skill level means that your action succeeds. In combat your skill rolls often have specific effects. Outside of combat the GM, or the adventure you are playing, determines the effects of the roll.



ROLLING A DRAGON

Rolling a one (1) on D20 means that you are particularly successful. This is called *rolling a dragon*. In combat, a dragon roll has specific effects – increasing the damage of an attack, for example. Outside of combat the GM decides the effect. Some suggestions:

- ◆ You impress everyone around you.

- ◆ You achieve more than intended.
- ◆ The action is performed faster than usual.



FAILURE

Rolling above your skill level means that your action fails. For some reason you do not achieve your goal – feel free to describe what happens together with the GM. The GM can also let failures have additional consequences to advance the story in an exciting way.

No Standstills! Failure must not stop the story completely. Even when you fail, there must be a way forward – perhaps at the cost of time, risk, or silver, but still a way. The GM has the final say on the consequences of failure in that particular situation.



ROLLING A DEMON

Rolling a 20 on D20 is called *rolling a demon* and means that the roll fails regardless of your skill level and other circumstances. Rolling a demon also means that the roll cannot be *pushed* (page 32). Demon rolls can have additional effects in combat (page 46 and page 49) and during spellcasting (page 59). Outside of combat the GM can let demon rolls have effects such as:

- ◆ You damage yourself, someone else, or an item.
- ◆ You make a fool of yourself in front of everyone around you.
- ◆ You make a lot of noise.

COLOR ROLLS

When no skill seems relevant to the situation, the GM can instruct you to roll against one of your Colors instead – rolling 🍀 to resist a new idea you don't like, for example, or 🌟 to empathize with a traveler sharing his woes. But if there is a skill that covers the action you wish to perform, your roll must be based on that. In unclear cases the GM decides what is appropriate.

BOONS & BANES



Normally, the GM does not assess how difficult an action is. You only roll dice in challenging situations – period. But sometimes the GM might want to underscore that external factors either help or hinder an action. You might then get a *boon* or *bane* to your roll.

In both cases you roll two D20, but only one result counts. If you have a boon, only the lowest result applies. If you have a bane, only the highest result applies.

There are also cases where the rules say that you get a boon or a bane, for example when attacking a prone opponent or shooting at long range.

Multiple Boons/Banes: If you get multiple boons/banes to your roll, roll an additional D20 for

each boon/bane and count only the lowest/highest result. However, please note that unless you have a very high skill level, rolls with multiple banes have a very low chance of success.

Boon and Bane: Sometimes you might get both boons and banes to your roll. Each boon negates one bane, and vice versa. If you have one boon and one bane, make a normal roll (one D20). If you have two boons and one bane, it counts as a boon.

HELP FROM OTHERS

One other player character or NPC can help you succeed at a die roll. This must be declared before you roll any dice. It must also make sense in the story – the individual helping you must be physically present and have the capacity to support your action. The GM has the final say.

Whenever someone helps you with a roll, you get a boon (see above). In combat, helping counts as an action – by helping someone else you lose your own action that round. NPCs can help each other just as player characters can. Only one character can help a roll.

PUSHING YOUR ROLL

If you fail a skill or Color roll, you can choose to *push the roll*, which means that you make another attempt. The new result applies, whatever it is. If you have boons or banes, you must re-roll all dice. You can *never* push a demon roll (a natural 20).

Whenever you push a roll, immediately after the re-roll, you suffer a condition. This means that you get a bane on all rolls for skills based on a certain Color, and rolls against the Color in question. Each Color is linked to a certain condition. Thus, there are five different conditions:

- ◆ **Sickly** – ☀
- ◆ **Angry** – ⚡
- ◆ **Scared** – ☹
- ◆ **Dazed** – 🌀
- ◆ **Exhausted** – 🥱

You decide which condition you get from pushing a roll, with two important restrictions:

- ◆ You cannot choose a condition you already have.
- ◆ You must be able to explain how the condition results from the action you are trying to perform. The GM has the right to reject clearly unreasonable explanations.

Once you have all five conditions, you may no longer push your rolls. In addition to their effects, conditions provide inspiration for roleplaying. Mark conditions on your character sheet.

Healing Conditions: You can recover from a condition by resting – for more on resting and healing, see page 52.

NPCs and Monsters: Only the player characters can push their rolls, not NPCs or monsters.

OPPOSED ROLLS

Sometimes you must beat your enemy in an *opposed roll* to succeed with an action. This means that both you and your adversary roll dice. Opposed rolls are used sparingly in the game, and only when someone is actively opposing you. In combat it only counts as an action for the active party.

- ◆ If your roll fails, your action fails as well, regardless of your opponent's roll.
- ◆ If your roll succeeds while your opponent fails, your action succeeds.
- ◆ If both of you succeed with your rolls, your action succeeds if the result of your roll is *lower than or equal to* your opponent's result. If the opponent's result is lower than yours, you fail.

Pushed Rolls: Opposed rolls can be pushed (see above) as well, but only if you are the active party. This can be done even after your opponent's roll.

Open Opposed Rolls: The GM can also use opposed rolls in situations where there is no active party – e.g. rolling 🌀 against 🌀 to decide the outcome of an arm-wrestling match. This is called an *open opposed roll*. Open opposed rolls are re-rolled if both parties fail, or if both succeed and get the same result. Both parties can push their rolls.

CORE SKILLS

This section describes all core skills in the game. The schools of sorcery are secondary skills and covered in Chapter 5.

The table below lists every core skill, the Color it is based on, and the backgrounds that offer it among their six.



ACROBATICS

When jumping, climbing, balancing or performing a similar physical action, roll for this skill.

SKILL	COLOR	BACKGROUNDS
Acrobatics		Hunter, Priest, Thief
Awareness		Colonist, Hunter, Magistrate, Scholar, Sorcerer, Thief
Axes		Artisan, Mercenary
Bartering		Colonist, Magistrate, Sorcerer
Beast Lore		Barbarian, Scholar, Sorcerer
Bluffing		Colonist, Magistrate, Priest, Sorcerer, Thief
Bows		Hunter, Mercenary
Brawling		Artisan, Mercenary
Bushcraft		Hunter, Scholar, Sorcerer
Cannons		Mercenary
Crafting		Artisan, Sorcerer
Evade		Colonist, Mercenary, Priest, Scholar, Sorcerer, Thief
Hammers		Artisan, Barbarian, Mercenary
Healing		Scholar, Sorcerer
Hunting & Fishing		Hunter, Sorcerer
Inspire		Barbarian
Knives		Artisan, Colonist, Hunter, Magistrate, Priest, Thief
Languages		Magistrate, Priest, Scholar, Sorcerer
Myths & Legends		Barbarian, Magistrate, Priest, Scholar, Sorcerer
Performance		Priest
Persuasion		Barbarian, Colonist, Magistrate, Priest, Sorcerer
Riding		Barbarian
Sleight of Hand		Artisan, Sorcerer, Thief
Slings		Hunter
Sneaking		Hunter, Sorcerer, Thief
Spears		Barbarian, Mercenary
Spot Hidden		Artisan, Colonist, Magistrate, Scholar, Sorcerer, Thief
Staves		Sorcerer
Swimming		Colonist
Swords		Artisan, Barbarian, Mercenary





AWARENESS

As an adventurer you must always be on your guard, or you won't live long. You use your **AWARENESS** skill to watch or listen for anyone sneaking around nearby (opposed roll, see **SNEAKING** below). The GM can also let you make an **AWARENESS** roll to notice emerging threats in time. Such a passive roll cannot be pushed.

Groups: If multiple player characters are in the same place, each of you makes a separate **AWARENESS** roll. You cannot help (page 32) each other.



BARTERING

When haggling over the price of something you are buying or selling, roll for **BARTERING**. If you succeed, the price goes down or up by 20%. If you roll a dragon, the price is halved or doubled. If you roll a demon, you have offended the other party so badly that they refuse the trade.



BEAST LORE

The world is full of common and rare animals and beasts of all kinds. Roll for **BEAST LORE** when trying to identify an animal or monster, or to know its habits, abilities, and weaknesses. If you succeed, the GM should give you some piece of useful information.



BLUFFING

To quickly come up with a convincing lie can be an invaluable skill as an adventurer. If the GM finds your bluff unconvincing, you get a bane to your roll. If your bluff is completely unbelievable, it fails automatically – no matter how well you deliver it.



BUSHCRAFT

The vast wilderness is a dangerous place where wild beasts roam. The ignorant can lose their lives by choosing the wrong path through the woods or making camp in the wrong spot. Roll for **BUSHCRAFT** to lead the way through the wilderness, make camp, cook food, or stay warm in cold weather. Read more in Chapter 8.



CRAFTING

As an adventurer, you must often repair your gear if it breaks. Typically, it takes one shift to repair a damaged item, and you need access to the appropriate tools (page 78).



EVADE

Roll for this skill when trying to dodge an attack or flee from combat. Read more in Chapter 4.



HEALING

As an adventurer there is a significant risk that you and your friends will be injured, sooner or later. That is when **HEALING** is useful – with this skill you can get fallen companions back on their feet or even save their lives. Read more on page 50.



HUNTING & FISHING

Out in the wild, you will often need to find your own food by hunting or fishing. This is further described on page 103.



INSPIRE

Courage is contagious. Roll for **INSPIRE** to put heart back into someone who has none left – most often to rally a fallen companion in the middle of a

fight (page 50). The GM can also call for an **INSPIRE** roll to steady an ally against fear, or to hold a frightened group together when everything is going wrong.

You cannot **INSPIRE** yourself. Getting back on your feet under your own power is a ☹ roll with a bane – see *Rally* on page 50.



LANGUAGES ☹

All player characters can speak the common tongue and read simple texts, and also know the tongue of their own kin. To understand foreign or ancient languages, roll for this skill.



MYTHS & LEGENDS ☹

When trying to remember stories of old times or distant lands, or trying to understand links to the past, roll for this skill.



PERFORMANCE ☹

When singing a song, reading a poem, making jokes or in some other way try to amuse a crowd, roll for **PERFORMANCE**.



PERSUASION ☹

Life as an adventurer is dangerous, but you can often reach your goals without violence, through charm, threats, or sensible reasoning. Roll for **PERSUASION** to make another person see things your way. If you succeed, you achieve your stated objective, and the NPC does what you want. However, they might demand something in return – the GM decides what that entails.

If what you are asking for requires the NPC to sacrifice or risk something important, the roll is more difficult – it becomes an opposed roll between your **PERSUASION** and the other person's ☹. But even in this case your request must be reasonable – no

NPC will agree to just anything or act entirely against their own interests, no matter how successful the roll. The GM has the final say. You cannot **PERSUADE** monsters (Chapter 7) unless it is explicitly allowed.



RIDING ☹

To get up on a zebra and ride slowly doesn't require a skill roll, for but for more advanced maneuvers you need to roll for **RIDING**. Special rules apply in combat (page 55).



SLEIGHT OF HAND ☹

When you are trying to steal something unnoticed, pick a lock, or perform any other action that requires fine motor skills, you roll **SLEIGHT OF HAND**.



SNEAKING ☹

It is often wise to avoid combat and hide or sneak past the enemy instead. If you win, you remain undetected. It is usually a straight skill roll, but if someone is *actively looking for you*, you must make an opposed roll with your **SNEAKING** against the enemy's **AWARENESS**.

Note that you can only make a **SNEAKING** roll when you can actually see or hear the enemy you wish to avoid. You never use **SNEAKING** "just in case" there is an enemy nearby.

Group Sneaking: If multiple player characters are sneaking around together, each person makes a separate roll. If one of you fails, the whole group is detected.



SPOT HIDDEN ☹

The art of finding what's hidden can make you rich beyond measure – or save your life. When you are looking for something concealed, you roll **SPOT HIDDEN**. If your description of where you are

searching is very precise, the GM can give you a boon or even let you succeed without a roll.

Each **SPOT HIDDEN** roll takes roughly a stretch. You only get one attempt to look for the same thing in exactly the same place. Multiple player characters can look simultaneously.



SWIMMING

All player characters can keep afloat for a short time, but for more challenging situations a roll for **SWIMMING** is required. Read more about swimming and drowning on page 53.



WEAPON SKILLS

There are several skills for wielding different types of weapons. You can read more about weapons and combat in the next Chapter.

Axes (): A skill used for combat with axes of all kinds, including when thrown.

Bows (): A skill for attacks with all types of bows.

Brawling (): Used for unarmed combat with fists, feet, teeth, or claws, and for grappling. Unarmed damage uses your  damage bonus, not your  (page 15).

Cannons (): Used for attacks with cannons of all kinds – iron tubes that throw their shot with fire instead of muscle.

Hammers (): Used for combat with warhammers and other blunt weapons such as clubs and maces.

Knives (): This skill is used for combat with knives and daggers, including when thrown.

Slings (): Roll for this skill when attacking with a sling.

Spears (): A skill used for combat with spears and tridents, including when thrown. It also covers lances.

Staves (): Use this skill when fighting with a staff.

Swords (): Used for combat with all types of swords.

PERKS

Described below are a number of perks. All player characters except sorcerers get one perk each at the start of the game, and you can earn new ones as described on page 29. Note that some perks require a minimum skill level to be learned.

Some cost Willpower Points to activate, others do not. Unless stated otherwise, it is possible to combine multiple abilities in the same action, e.g. Assassin and Dragonslayer, but you must pay the **WP** cost for each ability you wish to use.

Some perks require optional rules. If you are playing without these optional rules, those perks should not be used.

The tables overleaf list every perk at a glance. Where a skill is named, you need level 12 or higher in that skill to learn the perk. A dash in the **WP** column means the perk costs nothing to use — it is either permanent or free.



PERK	REQUIRED SKILL	WP
Assassin	Knives	3
Backstabbing	Knives	3
Battle Cry	—	3
Berserker	Any melee weapon	3
Bloodhound	Bushcraft	3
Catlike	Acrobatics	Varies
Charming	☹ 14	4
Companion	Hunting & Fishing	3
Contortionist	Evade	1
Defensive	Any melee weapon	3
Deflect Arrow	Any melee weapon	1
Disguise	Bluffing	2
Double Slash	Axes or Swords	3
Dragonslayer	Any weapon	3
Dual Wield	Any melee weapon	3
Eagle Eye	Awareness	2
Fast Footwork	Evade	3
Fast Healer	—	2
Fearless	—	2
Focused	—	—
Guardian	Axes, Hammers, or Swords	2
Insight	Persuasion	2
Iron Fist	Brawling	1

PERK	REQUIRED SKILL	WP
Iron Grip	Brawling	1
Lightning Fast	Evade	2
Lone Wolf	Bushcraft	—
Massive Blow	Any ☹-based melee weapon	3
Master Blacksmith	Crafting	Varies
Master Carpenter	Crafting	Varies
Master Chef	—	1
Master Spellcaster	Any school of sorcery	3
Master Tanner	Crafting	Varies
Musician	Performance	3
Pathfinder	Bushcraft	1
Precognition	Myths & Legends	3
Quartermaster	Bushcraft	1
Robust	—	—
Shield Block	Any ☹-based melee weapon	2
Silver-Tongued	Bluffing or Persuasion	2
Sorcerous Talent	—	—
Throwing Arm	Any melee weapon	2
Treasure Hunter	Bartering	3
Twin Shot	Bows	3
Veteran	Any weapon	1
Weasel	Evade	3
Wilderness Expert	Bushcraft	3



ASSASSIN

- ◆ **Requirement:** Knives 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

Your sneak attack (page 43) deals an extra D8 damage. This perk can be combined with the perk Backstabbing. You activate this ability after you roll to hit, but before you roll for damage.



BACKSTABBING

- ◆ **Requirement:** Knives 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

You can activate this ability when making a melee attack against an enemy that is also within 2 meters of another player character. Your attack then counts as a sneak attack, which means it cannot be dodged or parried, you get a boon to the roll, and the number of dice rolled for the damage is increased by one (i.e. 2D8 instead of D8). This ability can only be used with a *subtle* weapon (page 74). Activating this ability does not count as an action.



BATTLE CRY

- ◆ **Requirement:** —
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

You can, as an action in combat, let out a battle cry that inspires your friends. All other player characters within earshot immediately heal a condition of their choice (page 51). This perk can only be used in combat.



BERSERKER

- ◆ **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

You gain the Angry condition and immediately attack the nearest opponent in melee combat. If already Angry, you gain another condition of your

choice. Then you must keep fighting until all opponents within sight have been defeated or you reach 0 HP. You gain a boon to melee attacks, but can neither parry nor dodge. After the fight you become Exhausted.



BLOODHOUND

- ◆ **Requirement:** Bushcraft 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

Once you have caught a trail, getting away from you is difficult. By spending 3 WP, you gain a boon on any skill roll that might yield information about your quarry's whereabouts.



CATLIKE

- ◆ **Requirement:** Acrobatics 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** Varies

The number of D6 rolled for damage from a fall (page 53) decreases by one for each WP spent. You can first make an **ACROBATICS** roll and then activate this perk.



CHARMING

- ◆ **Requirement:** ☹ 14
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 4

Few can resist a true charmer. You know exactly what a person wants to hear. For every shift you spend in a person's company you may spend 4 WP on them, and once you have spent 12 WP on the same person you gain a boon on all ☹-based rolls against them. Common requests are granted without a roll at all. The GM decides what counts as common.



COMPANION

- ◆ **Requirement:** Hunting & Fishing 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3



You can activate this ability to turn an animal (not a monster) into your companion. This takes a stretch of time, and you can only have one animal companion at a time. The GM decides which animals are nearby – see the list on page 99. The animal follows you as long as you remain in its natural environment, and it can scout for you at no additional **WP** cost. For 3 additional **WP** you can command the animal to attack an enemy (free action for you).



CONTORTIONIST

- ◆ **Requirement:** Evade 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 1

You escape from your shackles or squeeze through a narrow space without rolling for any skill.



DEFENSIVE

- ◆ **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

You may attempt to parry an attack (page 46) without consuming your action for the round. The bonus parry can be used at any time during the round. You may only try to parry the same attack once and you cannot try to dodge and parry the same attack. This ability can be used multiple times per round, as long as you have enough **WP**.



DEFLECT ARROW

- ◆ **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 1

You can parry a ranged attack with a melee weapon, instead of using a shield.



DISGUISE

- ◆ **Requirement:** Bluffing 12

- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 2

You are a master of disguise and can easily assume the appearance of others. After working for a stretch of time you can assume another person's looks, voice, and demeanor. The person must be of the same kin as you. Anyone who knows the person and sees you from up to 10 meters away can make an **AWARENESS** roll to see through your disguise.



DOUBLE SLASH

- ◆ **Requirement:** Axes or Swords 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

When wielding a slashing weapon, you can attack two enemies within 2 meters with a single slash. You only roll for the attack once – if it succeeds, both enemies are hit. Your enemies can parry or dodge the attack individually. Damage is rolled separately. This ability can be combined with Dual Wield.



DRAGONSLAYER

- ◆ **Requirement:** Any weapon skill 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

An attack aimed at a monster (not a normal NPC) deals an additional D8 damage. You activate this ability after you roll to hit, but before you roll for damage. Read more about monsters in Chapter 7.



DUAL WIELD

- ◆ **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

This perk can only be used if you wield a one-handed weapon in each hand. The 🌀 requirement of the weapon in your off hand (you decide if it is right or left) increases by 3. You activate the ability on your turn in combat and can then perform an extra attack with your second weapon. The second attack is done with a bane. You decide in which order to use your two weapons. Finish the first attack, including



damage, before rolling the second one. This ability can be combined with Double Slash.



EAGLE EYE

- ◆ **Requirement:** Awareness 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 2

You can see a person or object up to 200 meters away in great detail, as if standing right next to it. The effect lasts for one stretch. In combat you can also shoot at a target beyond the weapon's effective range (page 49) without getting a bane to your roll. This perk must be activated for each new target.



FAST FOOTWORK

- ◆ **Requirement:** Evade 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

You may attempt to dodge an attack (page 47) without consuming your action for the round. The bonus dodge can be performed at any time during the round. You may only try to dodge the same attack once and you cannot try to dodge and parry the same attack. This ability can be used multiple times per round, as long as you have enough WP.



FAST HEALER

- ◆ **Requirement:** —
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 2

You heal an extra D6 HP during a stretch rest. This perk does not affect WP or conditions.



FEARLESS

- ◆ **Requirement:** —
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 2

You automatically resist fear (page 52), without a ☹ roll.



FOCUSED

- ◆ **Requirement:** —
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** —

Your maximum number of Willpower Points is permanently increased by 2. You can select this perk multiple times, without limit.



GUARDIAN

- ◆ **Requirement:** Axes, Hammers, or Swords 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 2

You do not hesitate to take a hit to protect your friends. If you and another player character are both within 2 meters of the same enemy and the enemy tries to attack the other character, you can activate this ability to force the enemy to attack you instead. Using this ability can be done out of turn and it does not count as an action.



INSIGHT

- ◆ **Requirement:** Persuasion 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 2

If you talk a while with another person, you can roll AWARENESS to determine whether that person is telling the truth. You cannot tell exactly what a person is lying about.



IRON FIST

- ◆ **Requirement:** Brawling 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 1

The damage of an unarmed attack increases by one D6. You can activate this perk as a free action after rolling the attack.



IRON GRIP

- ◆ **Requirement:** Brawling 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 1

You get a boon to your **BRAWLING** roll when trying to grapple another person or prevent the enemy from breaking free.



LIGHTNING FAST

- ◆ **Requirement:** Evade 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 2

When you roll the initiative at the start of an encounter (page 41), you may roll two D20 and choose which result you want to use.



LONE WOLF

- ◆ **Requirement:** Bushcraft 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** —

You can take a shift rest in the wilderness without first rolling for **BUSHCRAFT** to make camp (page 103). The effect only applies to you, even if you have a tent.



MASSIVE BLOW

- ◆ **Requirement:** Any 🗡️-based melee weapon skill 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

A strike with a two-handed melee weapon inflicts D8 additional points of damage, but you cannot move in the same round. You can activate this ability after the roll to hit, but not if you moved.



MASTER BLACKSMITH

- ◆ **Requirement:** Crafting 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** Varies

This ability requires blacksmithing tools. In one stretch, you can sharpen a bladed or pointed weapon, at the cost of 3 **WP**. Against a sharpened weapon, the armor rating of an item counts as one step lower. The effect wears off after one combat encounter where the weapon was used to attack or parry.

In one shift, you craft a metal weapon or metal armor of your choice from the lists on pages 73–75. It requires a forge, an anvil, and iron (weight 1). The cost in **WP** is equal to the item's price in silver (rounded up). You can spread the work across multiple shifts if you do not have enough **WP**.



MASTER CARPENTER

- ◆ **Requirement:** Crafting 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** Varies

This ability requires carpentry tools. As an action, you can inflict D12 points of damage per **WP** spent on a door, wall, or any other inanimate object, ignoring the object's armor rating.

In one shift of time you can craft a wooden item of your choice, such as a club, staff, or shield, from the lists on pages 73–75. It requires wood (weight 1 or determined by the GM), and costs a number of **WP** equal to the item's price in silver (rounded up). The GM decides the cost for unlisted items.



MASTER CHEF

- ◆ **Requirement:** —
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 1

You automatically succeed at cooking food (page 103) without rolling **BUSHCRAFT**.



MASTER SPELLCASTER

- ◆ **Requirement:** Any school of sorcery 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

If you activate this ability on your turn in combat, you can cast two different spells as a single action. It



must be two different spells. You can roll for the first spell and then activate this perk.



MASTER TANNER

- ◆ **Requirement:** Crafting 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** Varies

This ability requires leatherworking tools. You can craft one set of leather armor from the skin of an animal or a monster. The armor gets half the beast's armor rating (rounded up), but always has at least 1. It takes one shift and the cost in **WP** is equal to the item's armor rating.



MUSICIAN

- ◆ **Requirement:** Performance 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

Your beautiful voice instills courage in your friends or fear in your foes. Activating this ability (an action in combat) gives all allies within 10 meters a boon to all rolls, or a bane to all enemies within the same range – choose one or the other. The effect lasts until your turn in the next round.

Instruments: You can use instruments for the Musician ability. This can increase the ability's range or reduce the cost in **WP**. See page 75.



PATHFINDER

- ◆ **Requirement:** Bushcraft 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 1

You get a boon to your **BUSHCRAFT** roll when trying to find the right direction in the wilderness.



PRECOGNITION

- ◆ **Requirement:** Myths & Legends 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

When faced with a difficult decision, you can activate this ability to ask a question directly to the GM and receive a helpful answer. The answer represents your ability to see several possible paths of the future. It can aid your decision-making, but it will not reveal everything there is to know. In general, future events are much easier to precog when they are not immediately related to a creature you are currently interacting with.



QUARTERMASTER

- ◆ **Requirement:** Bushcraft 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 1

You are good at finding suitable campsites. You automatically succeed at making camp during journeys (page 103).



ROBUST

- ◆ **Requirement:** —
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** —

Your max **HP** increases by 2. This perk can be selected multiple times, without limit.



SHIELD BLOCK

- ◆ **Requirement:** Any -based melee weapon skill 12
- ◆ **Willpower Points:** 2

You can activate this ability when parrying with a shield to roll with a boon. Using this ability, you can also parry physical monster attacks (not area effects) that normally cannot be parried. This requires a shield and you get a boon to the roll. This ability can be combined with Defensive.



SILVER-TONGUED

- ◆ **Requirement:** Bluffing or Persuasion 12



◆ **Willpower Points:** 2

You come across as trustworthy and easy to believe. By spending 2 **WP**, you gain a boon on a roll for **BLUFFING** or **PERSUASION**.



SORCEROUS TALENT

◆ **Requirement:** —

◆ **Willpower Points:** —

You have an aptitude for sorcery and can learn a new school of sorcery (whether you already know any or not). Spells need to be learned separately. For more information on how it works, see page 61. This perk can be selected multiple times – once for each new school you want to learn.



THROWING ARM

◆ **Requirement:** Any melee weapon skill 12

◆ **Willpower Points:** 2

You can throw a melee weapon with tremendous force at an enemy within your  meters away. It must be a one-handed weapon. Roll the attack as normal. The enemy can parry or dodge the attack as usual. The weapon lands at the enemy's feet.



TREASURE HUNTER

◆ **Requirement:** Bartering 12

◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

At a crossroads of some kind, you can activate this ability to learn the direction of the greatest treasures.



TWIN SHOT

◆ **Requirement:** Bows 12

◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

By activating this ability when attacking with a bow (not a cannon), you shoot two arrows instead of one. Roll just once to hit, with a bane. Damage is rolled

separately. The arrows can be directed at the same target or two different targets.



VETERAN

◆ **Requirement:** Any weapon skill 12

◆ **Willpower Points:** 1

Activating this ability at the start of a round allows you to take your turn at any point in that round's turn order that you choose, instead of your normal place. Doing so does not count as an action. For more information on combat and initiative, see Chapter 4.



WEASEL

◆ **Requirement:** Evade 12

◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

If you are attacked and have another player character within 2 meters, you can activate this ability to let the attack hit that character instead of you. This ability has no effect against area attacks and you must activate this ability before attempting any dodge or parry. The new target may try to dodge or parry normally.



WILDERNESS EXPERT

◆ **Requirement:** Bushcraft 12

◆ **Willpower Points:** 3

You cannot suffer a demon roll on **BUSHCRAFT** or **HUNTING & FISHING**. Such a roll is immediately re-rolled, and the new result cannot be pushed. You may also spend 3 **WP** to re-roll a result on the journey mishap (page 102) or hunting (page 103) tables, but the new result must be used.



COMBAT & DAMAGE



WAITING

On your turn in the round, you can choose to *wait*. This means that you swap places in the turn order with another creature whose turn comes after yours. You can swap with other player characters as well as NPCs (or a group of NPCs acting on the same turn), and they cannot refuse the trade. The swap lasts for the current round only. However, you cannot swap with anyone who has already had their turn, or who themselves chose to wait earlier in the round.

Monsters: Monsters (page 83) often have multiple turns in a single round, and the GM therefore makes one initiative roll for each of them. In that case you decide which of the monster's turns you swap into, as long as it comes after your current turn in the initiative order. Monsters themselves never choose to wait.

Life as an adventurer is hard and often violent. In *Dragonbane* you can run into wild beasts, malicious raiders, and daedra. Combat can be rough for your player character, sometimes even lethal. Before you enter combat, you should always ask yourself: is it worth it?

ROUNDS & INITIATIVE

Combat is played in *rounds*, each representing roughly ten seconds. Before the first round you decide who has the initiative – that is, in what order the combatants will act.



ROLLING THE INITIATIVE

At the start of an encounter, everyone taking part in it, voluntarily or otherwise, rolls a D20 and adds their *movement bonus* – the modifier your ② gives to your Movement (page 18). The GM rolls for the NPCs. This is called *rolling the initiative*.

The highest result acts first, the second highest acts second, and so on until everyone has acted. Your place in the initiative order is called your *turn*. If two combatants tie, the one with the higher ② acts first; if that is also equal, they each roll a D20 and the higher result acts first.

Write your result down where everyone can see it. You roll the initiative once per encounter, not once per round – when all participants have had their turn, the round is over and a new round begins at the top of the same order.



SURPRISE

If you perform an attack that the GM deems surprising to your enemy, you act first in the first round of combat, whatever your initiative result. If several characters participate in the surprise attack, they all act before anyone else, in their own initiative order. The remaining combatants then take their turns as usual. From the second round on, the normal order applies.

ACTIONS & MOVEMENT

On your turn in the round, you can *move* and perform *one action*. You simply explain how you want to move and what action you want to perform. If necessary, you also roll dice to see whether you succeed.

You decide whether to move before you act or vice versa. You can even use part of your movement, perform your action, and then finish the movement. You must perform your action and move *on your*

turn – you cannot save any of them for later (but see Waiting, above).



ACTIONS

An action in combat can be many different things, but the list below summarizes the most common ones. These actions are described in detail later in this Chapter.

Free Actions: Minor actions such as drawing a weapon kept at hand, dropping to the ground, or shouting a few words are all *free actions*. See the sidebar below for a complete list. Free actions do not count as your action in the round but you can only perform one *of each type* per round, and only on your own turn. For example, you can drop down or get up on your turn, but not both.



REACTIONS

Some actions are not performed on your turn, but on the opponent's. These are called *reactions* and include things like parrying or dodging attacks. This uses up your own turn in the round, which means that you cannot perform a reaction if you have already had your turn. Your turn is spent as soon as you perform a reaction.

Movement: When performing a reaction, you also lose your movement in the round. Several reactions, such as dodging or parrying, give you a certain movement as part of the action. You can read more about this under Melee Combat on page 45.

ACTIONS

An action in combat can be many different things, but the most common ones are summarized below. Rules for these actions are found later in the Chapter.

- ◆ **Dash:** This action doubles your movement rate in the round.
- ◆ **Melee Attack:** These can be performed against an enemy within 2 meters (4 meters for long weapons).
- ◆ **Ranged Attack:** Attacks with a ranged weapon can be made against targets within the weapon's range.
- ◆ **Parry:** Both melee and ranged attacks can be parried, but the latter requires a shield. Parrying is a *reaction* that takes place outside your turn and replaces your normal turn in the round.
- ◆ **Dodge:** Dodging a melee or ranged attack is also a reaction that takes place outside your turn and replaces your normal turn in the round.
- ◆ **Pick Up Item:** Pick up an item from the ground within 2 meters, or from your Inventory.
- ◆ **Equip/Unequip Armor/Helmet:** Suits of armor and helmets protect you from damage, but also restrict your movement.
- ◆ **First Aid:** The **HEALING** skill is used to save the life of someone who has had their **HP** reduced to zero and is at risk of dying.
- ◆ **Rally:** You can **INSPIRE** another player character at zero **HP** to rally and keep fighting.
- ◆ **Break Down Door:** Doors can take a certain amount of damage before they break down.
- ◆ **Pick Lock:** Picking a lock requires a **SLEIGHT OF HAND** roll. Doing so without lockpicks gives you a bane.
- ◆ **Use Item:** Use a potion or some other item within 2 meters.

- ◆ **Activate Ability:** Use an innate or perk.
- ◆ **Cast Spell:** In most cases, casting a spell counts as an action. This includes magical tricks. Some spells are reactions and do not require an action, while others are more time-consuming. For more on sorcery, see Chapter 5.
- ◆ **Helping:** Helping another character gives them a boon to a roll in the same round.
- ◆ **Round Rest:** You rest and recover D6 WP. This can only be done once per shift.

FREE ACTIONS

- ◆ **Draw Weapon:** Draw, exchange, or put away a weapon kept at hand.
- ◆ **Change Position:** Throw yourself to the ground or get up.
- ◆ **Drop Item:** Drop an item on the ground.
- ◆ **Shout:** Say or shout a few words.



MOVEMENT

Under normal circumstances, you can move as many meters as your Movement rate. But there are a few special cases to consider:

Dash: By choosing to *dash* as your action in the round, you can move twice as far as normal.

Stand/Crouch: You can drop to the ground or get up as part of your movement. These are free actions and do not affect your movement per se, but can only be done on your turn.

Leaping: As part of your movement, you can make a horizontal leap as long as half your movement rate with a successful **ACROBATICS** roll. If the distance is a quarter of your movement rate or less, you don't need to roll to leap it.

Door: Passing through a closed but unlocked door costs half your movement in the round. If you cannot move any further, you remain standing by the

now open door. A locked door must either be picked open or broken down.

Enemies: You cannot move past a standing enemy who wants to stop you. A humanoid creature of human size can block an area of roughly 2×2 meters. Monsters can block larger areas. To move past an enemy who is blocking the way, you must first bring it to the ground or reduce its **HP** to zero. Friendly individuals can be passed without any problem.

Free Attack: If you are standing within 2 meters of an enemy and then voluntarily move away from that enemy, you must make an **EVADE** roll. The roll does not count as an action, but if it fails, the enemy immediately gets to perform an additional melee attack against you – a *free attack*. The free attack does not count as an action and can neither be parried nor dodged. A monster that gets a free attack performs a monster attack (page 83) which also may affect other characters.

Note that a free attack is triggered even if you start your movement at a distance but pass by an enemy. Moving *around* an enemy does not trigger a free attack, as long as you stay within 2 meters. Also note that involuntary movement never triggers a free attack.

first round, after everyone else, keeping their own order among themselves.



SNEAK ATTACK

The key to winning a conflict is often to attack when the enemy least expects it.

Sneak Attack: When you sneak up on someone undetected and perform an attack, it is called a *sneak attack*. It can be done with both ranged and melee weapons, but never during active combat (except with the Backstabbing perk).

First you make a **SNEAKING** roll. Moving close enough to attack in melee combat (within 2 meters for most weapons) gives you a bane. If you fail, the enemy notices you – draw initiative.

If you succeed your attack counts as surprising, which means that you act first in the first round of combat. You also get a boon on the attack, and the target can neither dodge nor parry. Using a *subtle* weapon increases the damage by one die (for example 2D8 instead of D8). Sneak attacks are always performed individually, by one attacker against one target.

Ambush: A special kind of sneak attack is an *ambush* – lying in wait for an enemy and attacking as it passes by. In this case, each victim makes an **AWARENESS** roll to spot the ambush, with a bane if the attackers are well prepared. All those who fail act last in the



MELEE COMBAT

To attack someone in melee, you generally must be within 2 meters of your target. On the grid map you need to be positioned in a square adjacent to the enemy (including diagonally). When attacking in close combat, you use the skill that covers the type of weapon you are wielding.

Damage: If the attack hits, your weapon determines which dice you should roll to see how much damage you inflict on the enemy. The damage can be increased by your damage bonus and a dragon roll and decreased by armor.

Damage Bonus: Your damage bonus is determined by your score in the Color on which your weapon skill is based –  or .

Weapon: You can have up to three weapons *at hand*. Write them down in the Weapons section on your character sheet. To attack with a weapon, it must also be *drawn*. Drawing a weapon kept at hand, or exchanging your drawn weapon for another weapon at hand, is a free action. Picking up another weapon from the ground or from your inventory costs a regular action.

 **Requirement:** Some weapons have a  requirement. If your  is lower than the requirement, you get a bane on all attacks and parries with that weapon. If your  is less than half the requirement, you cannot use the weapon at all.

Grip: Weapons require either one or two hands to use. You can only have one two-handed weapon, or two one-handed weapons (including a shield), drawn at the same time. The  requirement of a one-

handed weapon decreases by 3 if you hold it with both hands.

Long Weapons: An attack with a weapon with the *long* feature (such as a long spear or lance) can hit enemies up to 4 meters away (two squares). With such a weapon it is also possible to attack past a friendly combatant and hit an enemy on the other side of that person.



PRONE TARGETS

If you are standing up but your enemy is lying on the ground, your attack gets a boon and inflicts an extra D6 damage.



CRITICAL HIT

By rolling a dragon when you attack, you score a *critical hit*. This means that a dragon roll is required to parry or dodge the attack, and that you may choose one of the following effects:

- ◆ Roll double the amount of dice for the weapon's damage, before adding any damage bonus and other bonuses. For example, if you get a critical hit with a broadsword (damage 2D6) and have damage bonus D4, the damage is 4D6+D4.
- ◆ You can immediately perform a second attack against another enemy. This additional attack is a free action.
- ◆ Armor has no effect against the attack, as it finds a gap or weak spot. This effect can only be chosen if the attack deals piercing damage (page 45).

SHOVE

If you hit an enemy with a melee attack and your  damage bonus is equal to or higher than your opponent's damage bonus, you can choose to shove the enemy up to 2 meters in any direction (to an adjacent square, if you are using a grid map) in addition to doing damage. This movement does not count toward the enemy's total movement in the round and does not trigger free attacks from anyone. Monsters cannot shove or be shoved.

DAMAGE TYPES

There are three types of damage: slashing, piercing, and bludgeoning. The damage types of various weapons are listed in the weapon tables in Chapter 6. Some weapons, such as swords, can inflict both slashing damage and piercing damage – you must state whether you stab or slash before rolling the die. The damage type influences the effectiveness of armor, and monsters can be resistant to certain types of damage.

DEMON ROLL IN MELEE

If you roll a demon when attacking in melee combat, you miss your target and cannot push the roll. You might also suffer an additional mishap. Roll on the table below. If the result is unreasonable, the GM decides the effect.

D6 EFFECT

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | You drop your weapon at your feet. Picking it up is an action. |
| 2 | You expose yourself to the enemy, who gets a free attack (page 43) that cannot be dodged or parried. |
| 3 | Your weapon cuts so deep into an object that it gets stuck. Pulling it free requires a 🎲 roll (counts as an action) |
| 4 | You accidentally toss your weapon D3+3 meters. To pick it up you must move and then perform an action. |
| 5 | You slam your weapon into something hard and damage it. Any use of the weapon gets a bane until it is repaired by an artisan. |
| 6 | You hit yourself by mistake. Roll for damage as usual, but without any damage bonus. |

Inanimate Objects: If you hit a non-living object, like a door or a lock, you hit automatically – only roll for damage. Inanimate objects often have an armor rating, however (page 50).



PARRYING

When hit by an attack in close combat, you can choose to *parry* the attack with a drawn weapon or shield. Note that you cannot draw a weapon to parry, as free actions can only be performed on your own turn. You must declare that you are going to parry before the attacker rolls for damage. You cannot parry unarmed. It is also impossible to both parry

and dodge the same attack. You can parry while prone. When parrying, you roll against your skill level for the weapon.

Reaction: Parrying is a reaction, as it breaks the initiative order. It replaces your regular turn, which is spent immediately. This means that you cannot parry if you have already had your turn in the round (but see the perk Defensive).

Durability: If your parry succeeds, the enemy's attack hits your weapon or shield, and you suffer no damage. However, if the damage exceeds your weapon's durability, the weapon is damaged and cannot be used until it is repaired with a **CRAFTING** roll.



Movement: When you successfully parry an attack, you can move both yourself and the enemy 2 meters (one square) in any direction. These movements follow the usual rules, but do not count toward anyone's movement in the round and trigger no free attacks from anyone.

Shield: If you have a shield drawn, you can parry with it instead of your weapon. There is no skill for shields – instead you can use any -based melee skill (i.e. any of them except **KNIVES** and **STAVES**) to parry with a shield.

Piercing Damage: Piercing attacks can never damage a parrying weapon or shield.

Monsters: As a rule, monster attacks (page 83) cannot be parried, unless otherwise specified.

ROLLING A DRAGON WHEN PARRYING

If you roll a dragon when parrying, you immediately perform a counterattack on your opponent – an automatic hit with your weapon that cannot be dodged or parried. This does not apply if the attacker rolled a dragon as well – in that case you need a dragon just to parry, and do not get a counterattack.



DODGING

As an alternative to parrying, you can try to dodge when hit by an attack. You cannot parry and dodge the same attack – you must choose one or the other. You can dodge while prone. You must declare that you are dodging before your opponent rolls for damage. Roll for **EVADE** – on success you evade the attack and take no damage. On a failure, you are hit by the attack.

Reaction: Dodging is a reaction and, like parrying, requires that you have not already had your turn in the round. Once you have dodged, your turn in the round is spent.

Movement: On a successful dodge you may, if you want, move up to 2 meters in any direction. This movement does not trigger free attacks from anyone.

Monsters: As a rule, monster attacks (page 83) can be dodged, unless otherwise specified.

Reading the Blow: If you fail a parry or a dodge and the attack hits you, you suffer the damage as usual – but you have learned something from the blow, and gain a boon on your next attack against that same enemy. The boon lasts until you use it or the fight ends, whichever comes first; if that enemy falls before you can strike back, it is lost. Boons do not stack, so failing several defenses against the same enemy still grants only a single boon, and if your attack would already have a boon for another reason this adds nothing. As always, a boon and a bane cancel each other out.

RANGED COMBAT

To use a ranged weapon, it must first be drawn (free action), just like in melee. You should preferably be positioned over 2 meters from your target (i.e. *not* in an adjacent square on the map). Standing 2 meters away or less gives you a bane on your attack. Roll against the skill for the weapon you are using. For throwing weapons, use the same skill as for melee attacks (such as **KNIVES** or **SPEARS**). If the attack hits, the weapon determines which dice you should roll to see how much damage it inflicts. The damage can be increased by damage bonus and a dragon roll, and decreased by armor.

Damage Bonus: You get a damage bonus for ranged weapons, just as in melee. But note that cannons do not give you a damage bonus.

Range: The weapon tables on pages 74–75 specify the range of various weapons – that is, the maximum distance (in meters) at which the weapon can be used effectively. You can fire at targets up to twice the listed range, but then you get a bane.



CRITICAL HIT

Rolling a dragon when performing a ranged attack results in a critical hit, which means that it can only be dodged (or parried with a shield) if the opponent

SPECIAL ATTACKS

In addition to simply trying to hit the enemy, there are a few special attacks that you can use in melee combat. You must always declare that you are using a special attack before rolling the attack.

Several special attacks are resolved by opposed rolls. When rolling for an NPC without the skill in question, the GM rolls against the default skill level 5 (page 33).

Find Weak Spot: If your weapon is *piercing*, you can try to find a gap in the enemy's armor or natural armor. You get a bane on the attack, but if it hits, the enemy counts as armorless.

Topple: You try to topple an enemy to the ground instead of inflicting damage. This is handled with an opposed roll between your skill level in the weapon you are using and the enemy's **EVADE**. If your weapon has the *toppling* feature, you get a boon. The attack counts as an action for you, but not for your opponent. It cannot be dodged or parried.

An effective way of using this special attack is to work together with another person – if you topple the opponent, your friend can attack the prone enemy before they can get up.

Disarm: You try to disarm your enemy instead of inflicting damage. This is handled with an opposed roll between your and the enemy's skill level in the weapons you are using. The attack counts as an action for you, but not for your opponent. It cannot be dodged or parried. If the enemy is holding the weapon with both hands, you get a bane. If you succeed, the weapon lands D6 meters away in a direction of your choice. Picking up a weapon from the ground is an action. Disarm does not work on shields or natural weapons.

Grapple: You try to grapple a humanoid enemy instead of inflicting damage. This is handled with an opposed roll between your **BRAWLING** and the enemy's **BRAWLING**. The attack counts as an action for you, but not for your opponent. It cannot be dodged or parried.

If your attempt fails, you fall to the ground. If it succeeds, both of you fall to the ground and the enemy is trapped in your grip. As long as you maintain your grip the enemy can neither move nor perform any action that requires body movement, except trying to break free. Doing so is an opposed roll between your **BRAWLING** and the enemy's **BRAWLING**. The roll is a free action for the enemy, but not for you.

While maintaining your grip, you are also unable to move or perform any action that requires body movement, except *break* – this counts as an unarmed attack with a boon that cannot be dodged or parried. Releasing the enemy is a free action.

also rolls a dragon. You may also choose one of the following effects:

- ◆ Your weapon's damage is doubled, excluding the damage bonus and other bonuses. Roll twice as many dice as normal and add them up. For example, a critical hit with a longbow inflicts 2D12 damage.
- ◆ Armor and natural armor have no effect against the attack, as it hits a gap or weak spot. This effect can only be chosen if the attack deals piercing damage (page 45).



PARRY & DODGE

Parrying a ranged attack requires a shield. It works the same way as in melee combat, except that rolling a dragon does not give you a counterattack. You can dodge ranged attacks just like melee attacks.

MELEE TACTICS

To be successful in melee combat it is important to realize that your most precious resource is your actions – you only get one per round, including reactions such as dodging or parrying.

If several player characters are fighting together, it is often very effective to focus on the same enemy, as that person can only parry or dodge once, which leaves them vulnerable to multiple attacks. But always remember that you too are exposed to attacks after performing your action. The perks Defensive and Lightning Fast significantly increase your ability to defend yourself against multiple opponents.

In single combat against an opponent as powerful as yourself, it may be wise to wait and let the enemy strike first. If their attack misses you do not need to parry or dodge, and can then perform your own attack while the enemy is unable to protect themselves. The drawback is that you surrender the initiative to your enemy, who may choose a completely different action than you expected.



OBSCURED TARGETS

If your view of the target is partially obscured by an object or person, no matter if it is a friend or foe, you get a bane on your attack. On a grid map you can shoot past a person standing between you and your target, but with a bane. If the target is completely out of sight, perhaps hiding behind a wall, you cannot shoot it at all. If you are playing without a map, the

GM decides whether your line of sight is partially or completely blocked.

DAMAGE

Life as an adventurer is hard and risky. The rewards may be great, but the only thing you know for sure is

DEMON ROLL IN RANGED COMBAT

If you roll a demon when performing a ranged attack, you miss your target and cannot push the roll. You may also suffer an additional mishap. Roll on the table below.

D6	EFFECT
1	You drop your weapon at your feet. Picking it up is an action.
2	You run out of arrows or fire salts and must get more before you can use the weapon again. Re-roll for sling or throwing weapons.
3	You hit a valuable or important item nearby. The GM decides what it is.
4	You break your weapon. Any use of the weapon gets a bane until it is repaired by an artisan.
5	You accidentally hit a random player character or friendly NPC. Roll for damage as usual, including damage bonus.
6	You hit yourself by mistake. Roll for damage as usual, but without damage bonus.



that you will suffer all sorts of damage along the way. Taking damage reduces your hit points (HP).



ARMOR

Wearing leather, chainmail, or plate armor can protect your body from damage. Equipping or unequipping armor counts as an action in combat. The armor you are wearing should be written down in the Armor section on your character sheet and does not count toward your encumbrance. You can only wear one suit of armor at a time. Some armors can give you a bane on certain skill rolls or restrict your movement.

Armor Rating: An armor's effectiveness is determined by its armor rating. Whenever you take damage from a physical attack, subtract the armor rating from the damage. If the damage from a melee attack is completely negated, the attacking weapon itself suffers the damage instead, which might break the weapon (see durability on page 46).

Helmets: Your armor can be combined with a helmet, which can further increase your armor rating. Equipping or unequipping a helmet counts as an action. Helmets can also give you a bane when using certain skills.



DEATH

If your **HP** reaches zero, you drop to the ground and risk dying. You cannot move or perform any actions except trying to rally (below).

Death Roll: On your turn in each subsequent round, you must make a *death roll* – a roll against your ☀. The death roll *cannot* be pushed. Record the results of your death rolls on your character sheet. After three successful death rolls you recover D6 **HP** and stop making death rolls. After three failed death rolls, your player character dies. Rolling a dragon counts as two successful death rolls, and rolling a demon counts as two failures. If the combat ends, keep counting rounds until all death rolls have been made. Any failed death rolls are reset if you survive.

Additional Damage: If you suffer additional damage while at zero **HP**, it automatically counts as a failed death roll.

Rally: Another player character within 10 meters and earshot can **INSPIRE** you to rally and keep fighting despite having zero **HP**. This counts as an action. If you rally, you can continue acting as normal, but must keep making death rolls as described above. You can even try to rally yourself, rolling against your ☀ with a bane (instead of **INSPIRE**).

Saving Life: When you have zero **HP**, another person next to you can save your life with a successful **HEALING** roll. Without bandages, they get a bane to the roll. This counts as an action. Multiple

DAMAGE TYPES & ARMOR

Damage types (page 45) affect armor as follows:

- ◆ Leather and studded leather gain a +2 bonus to their armor rating against bludgeoning damage.
- ◆ Chainmail gets a +2 bonus to its armor rating against slashing damage.
- ◆ Plate armor suffers a –1 penalty to its armor rating against bludgeoning damage.

Helmets add their rating against every type of damage. A table of every armor's effective rating against each damage type can be found on page 74.

If the type of damage is not stated, the armor has its normal effect.

SEVERE INJURIES

If you have been reduced to zero **HP** but survived, you risk severe injuries that can take a long time to heal and even have permanent effects. Make a roll against ☀. If you fail, roll on the table below.

The healing time is halved if you rest and get medical care for at least a shift per day from a person who makes a **HEALING** roll. Skill levels that are reduced by permanent injuries can be re-learned.

attempts are allowed. If the roll succeeds, you stop making death rolls and recover D6 **HP**. You cannot save your own life this way, even if you have rallied (see above). Additional **HEALING** rolls have no effect once you are no longer at zero **HP**, except when resting (see page 52). Sorcery can save lives as well.

Instant Death: You don't record negative **HP**, but if a single attack reduces your **HP** to a negative score equal to your full **HP**, your player character dies instantly. Time to honor the fallen adventurer and create a new one!

D20	INJURY	EFFECT
1-2	Broken nose	You get a bane on all AWARENESS rolls. Healing time: D6 days.
3-4	Scarred face	Bane on all INSPIRE , PERFORMANCE , and PERSUASION rolls. Healing time: 2D6 days.
5-6	Teeth knocked out	Your INSPIRE , PERFORMANCE , and PERSUASION skill levels are permanently reduced by 2 (to a minimum of 3).
7-8	Broken ribs	Bane on all skills based on 🍀 or 🍁. Healing time: D6 days.
9-10	Concussion	Bane on all skills based on 🌊. Healing time: D6 days.

D20	INJURY	EFFECT
11-12	Deep wounds	Bane on all skills based on 🍀 or 🍁, and every roll against such skill inflicts D6 points of damage. Healing time: 2D6 days.
13	Broken leg	Your movement rate is halved. Healing time: 3D6 days.
14	Broken arm	You cannot use two-handed weapons, nor dual wield, and get a bane on all other actions normally using both arms, such as climbing. Healing time: 3D6 days.
15	Severed toe	Movement rate permanently reduced by 2 (to a minimum of 4).
16	Severed finger	Your skill levels in all weapon skills are permanently reduced by 1 (to a minimum of 3).
17	Gouged eye	Your skill level in SPOT HIDDEN is permanently reduced by 2 (to a minimum of 3).
18	Trauma	Roll to resist fear (page 52) each shift you sleep. If you fail, the shift doesn't count as slept. Healing time: 2D6 days.

D20	INJURY	EFFECT
19	Changed personality	Your temperament is permanently altered. You and the GM decide how. The effect must be roleplayed.
20	Amnesia	You cannot remember who you or the other player characters are. The effect must be roleplayed. Healing time: D6 days.

CONDITIONS

In this game you can suffer five different conditions. Each condition gives you a bane on all rolls against a certain Color and skill rolls based on that Color:

- ◆ **Sickly** – ☠
- ◆ **Angry** – 🔥
- ◆ **Scared** – 😨
- ◆ **Dazed** – 🌀
- ◆ **Exhausted** – 🥱

Suffering a Condition: The most common way to suffer conditions is to push your roll (page 32). You must then choose a condition and describe how you get it. You can suffer conditions in other ways as well, for example because of monster attacks or spells.

Multiple Conditions: If you suffer a condition that you already have, you must choose another condition. If you have all five conditions, you instead lose D6 **WP** if you suffer another condition. If you are out of **WP**, you instead lose D6 **HP**.

Healing Conditions: You can heal one condition of your choice during a stretch rest. A shift rest heals all conditions.

HEALING & RESTING



Lost **HP** and **WP** are recovered by resting. There are three kinds of rest – round rest, stretch rest, and shift rest. While resting, you cannot perform any actions that require die rolls or **WP**.

Round Rest: A quick rest that lasts just a single round. During a round rest you recover only D6 **WP**, no **HP**. You can only have a round rest once per shift.

Stretch Rest: A short rest that only lasts for one stretch of time. During a stretch rest you heal D6 **HP**, or 2D6 **HP** if someone else is tending to you and succeeds with a **HEALING** roll. The caregiver cannot rest during the same stretch and can only heal one person during the rest.

During a stretch rest, you also recover D6 Willpower Points and heal a condition of your choice. If something dramatic interrupts your rest, the effects are lost. You can only have a stretch rest once per shift.

Shift Rest: A shift rest lasts one full shift of time and can only take place in a safe location where there are no enemies nearby. During a shift rest you recover all your lost **HP** and **WP** and heal all conditions. If a shift rest is interrupted by combat or hard work it has no effect.

Sorcery: Spells can allow you to heal **HP** more quickly than usual.

OTHER HAZARDS



DARKNESS

In complete darkness you cannot dash (page 43) or hit enemies with ranged attacks. To attack an enemy in melee combat, you must first make an **AWARENESS** roll (not an action).

Torches & Lanterns: A torch or lantern lights up 10 meters (five squares) in all directions. Lighting a torch or lantern is an action and requires flint and tinder or a fire to light it with, or the magickal trick **IGNITE** (page 65). If none of these are available, you can light it with a successful **BUSHCRAFT** roll, but that takes one stretch of work.

A torch or lantern is carried in one hand, which means that you cannot use two-handed weapons or a second one-handed weapon at the same time. A torch can be used as a weapon, and counts as a small wooden club that deals fire damage. Whenever you hit someone with it, you must immediately roll to see whether the flame goes out (below).

A torch or lantern can burn for up to a shift of time, but they are unreliable. After each stretch, or whenever the GM wants to heighten the drama, you must roll a die (the type depends on the light source, see page 78). A result of 1 means that the flame goes out.



FEAR

There are many horrifying beasts lurking in the ruins and forests of *Dragonbane*. Such creatures can perform so-called *fear attacks*. Fear attacks can also be triggered by sorcery and other terrifying experiences.

When struck by a fear attack you must immediately make a roll against ☹. The roll can be pushed and does not count as an action. Particularly frightening events can give you a bane on the roll. If

the ☹ roll fails, you must roll on the fear table below.

FEAR TABLE



POISON

Poisons are measured by potency. A weak poison has potency 9, a moderate poison has potency 12, and a strong poison can have potency 15 or even more. Whenever you ingest a poison, the GM makes an open opposed roll (page 33) between the potency and your ☼. If the poison wins, you suffer its full effect. If you win, you only suffer the limited effect of the poison. Poison has no effect on monsters.

NPCs: For poison effects on NPCs, roll against their maximum **HP**, reduced by 2 for each level of the Robust perk.

LETHAL POISON

- ◆ **Full Effect:** You take D6 damage per round, on your turn, until you reach zero **HP**. If you consume an antidote in time the effect is halted.
- ◆ **Limited Effect:** You take D6 damage on your next turn.

PARALYZING POISON

- ◆ **Full Effect:** You become Exhausted and must make a ☼ roll each turn (not an action). If it fails, you can neither move nor perform actions (not even free actions) that round. The effect wears off after one stretch or if you are given an antidote.
- ◆ **Limited Effect:** You become Exhausted.

SLEEPING POISON

- ◆ **Full Effect:** You become Dazed and must make a ☼ roll each turn (not an action). If it fails, you fall asleep and remain sleeping for one shift. Being given an antidote or taking at least one point of damage wakes you up.
- ◆ **Limited Effect:** You become Dazed.

D8	EFFECT
1	Enfeebled. The fear drains your energy and determination. You lose 2D6 WP (to a minimum of zero) and become Scared.
2	Shaken. You suffer the Scared condition.
3	Panting. The intense fear leaves you out of breath and makes you Exhausted.
4	Pale. Your face turns white as a sheet. You and all player characters within 10 meters and in sight of you become Scared.
5	Scream. You scream in horror, which causes all player characters who hear the sound to immediately suffer a fear attack as well. Each person only ever needs to make one ☹️ roll to resist the same fear attack.
6	Rage. Your fear turns to anger, and you are forced to attack its source on your next turn – in melee combat if possible. You also become Angry.
7	Paralyzed. You are petrified with terror and unable to move. You cannot perform any action or movement on your next turn. Make another ☹️ roll on each subsequent turn (not an action) to break the paralysis.
8	Wild Panic. In a fit of utter panic, you flee the scene as fast as you can. On your next turn you must dash away from the source of your fear. Make another ☹️ roll on each subsequent turn (not an action) to stop running and act normally again.



DISEASE

When you are exposed to a dangerous disease, the GM makes an open opposed roll between the disease's virulence rating and your ☼. If you win, you resist the disease. If not, you fall ill after one day – you become Sickly and lose D6 **HP**. While sick you cannot heal **HP**, **WP**, or conditions. Make a new roll against the disease every day, where each failure inflicts D6 damage. If you reach zero **HP** while sick, you die a day later. As soon as you win the opposed roll, you are fully cured – you stop rolling and can heal as usual.

Healing: If someone tends to you with the **HEALING** skill while you are sick, that person can make the roll against the disease instead of you. The caregiver rolls for **HEALING** against the virulence of the disease. An herbal concoction adds a boon to the roll.



FALLING

Falling on a hard surface inflicts a number of D6s of bludgeoning damage equal to half of the height of the fall in meters, rounded down. A fall of less than two meters inflicts no damage. A successful **ACROBATICS** roll reduces the number of D6 by half (rounded up). Armor does not protect against falling damage.



SWIMMING & DROWNING

All player characters are decent swimmers. In water your movement rate is half your movement rate on land. No ranged attacks can be performed in water, and melee attacks are performed with a bane. More difficult underwater maneuvers, like diving for something, require a **SWIMMING** roll. You get a bane if you are wearing chainmail or plate armor.

In water you must also make a **SWIMMING** roll after every stretch of time to stay afloat. If you are wearing chainmail or plate armor, you must roll every round. Underwater, you need to make a



successful roll against ☀ each round to hold your breath (not an action). If the roll fails you begin to drown, taking D6 damage per round until someone rescues you. If you reach zero **HP** while drowning, you make death rolls as usual, but only failed rolls count.



HUNGER

You must eat at least one ration of food (page 103) per day. After one day without food you become famished and cannot heal **HP**, **WP**, or conditions except through sorcery. You also take one point of damage per day that you haven't eaten. If you reach zero **HP** while famished, you die from starvation after one day. Once you have eaten a ration of food you are no longer famished and can heal normally again.



COLD

When the cold is bitter and you do not have enough shelter (according to the GM), you must roll **BUSHCRAFT** regularly. You usually roll once per shift, but in extreme cold you may have to roll every stretch or even every round. If you don't have a blanket, you get a bane to the roll, while a fur gives you a boon.

On failure you lose D6 **HP** and D6 **WP**, and can no longer heal these or conditions except through sorcery. You must then keep making rolls to withstand the cold, with the same effect if you fail. If you reach zero **HP** while cold, you die when it is time for the next roll. Only when you get warm, if only by a campfire, can you stop making rolls and heal normally again.



SLEEP DEPRIVATION

You need at least one shift of uninterrupted sleep every day. You cannot sleep in armor. After three shifts without sleep you can no longer heal **WP** or conditions. You heal **HP** as usual. You also lose D6

WP each shift you remain awake. If you reach zero **WP** while suffering from sleep deprivation, you collapse and sleep for at least one shift, and cannot be woken. Once you have slept at least one shift, you can heal **WP** and conditions normally again.

RIDING ANIMALS

A loyal zebra or some other mount is a great asset to any adventurer. Different types of pack animals and riding animals are listed on page 81, and their stats are found on page 99.

Saddlebags: The Gear lists specify how many units of weight the animal can carry.

Movement: While mounted you travel twice as fast as on foot – roughly 30 kilometers per shift (page 7). All player characters are assumed to be able to get up on a zebra and ride slowly, but for more advanced maneuvers a roll for **RIDING** is required.

Combat: In order to fight from the saddle, your mount must be combat trained. You may then move at your mount's movement rate instead of your own. Mounted, you fight as usual, but all attacks and parries use the lowest of your **RIDING** skill and the weapon skill. Also, **RIDING** replaces **EVAD** while mounted. If you don't have a saddle, all rolls get a bane. Enemies attacking you must choose whether they target you or your mount. Melee attacks from the ground get a bane against you.

Damage: Mounts heal **HP** just like player characters. A mount that reaches zero **HP** does not make death rolls, but simply dies.

IMPROVISED WEAPONS

Battles are sometimes fought in places where things in the environment can be used in combat – as weapons, for protection, or for movement. These improvised weapons can be lots of different things,

but what they all have in common is that they normally can only be used once, after which they are consumed. Using an improvised weapon is an action and can be combined with movement.

At the start of combat, the GM decides which improvised weapons are available – usually about D3 of them. The GM can mark an improvised weapon's exact location on the map, or say that it is available anywhere in the area. Once used, an improvised weapon is consumed.

Complete adventures can feature new and unique improvised weapons that are connected to a certain adventure site.



SORCERY



Some call sorcery a gift from the dragons, others a curse from the daedra, and still others call it the blessing of the gods or spirits. And it is true that dragons, daedra, gods, and spirits influence sorcery and can guide the sorcerer who wields it, but the reality is that sorcery is a basic force of nature that exists throughout the physical world as well as beyond it. Gods and daedra, dragons and spirits – they are all equally dependent on sorcery.

SCHOOLS OF SORCERY

Exploring sorcery is as much art as it is science. There are different schools of sorcery, each with a unique view on what sorcery is and how it works. Five are open to player characters. Others exist – harmonism, mentalism, necromancy, witchcraft and worse – but no one in Solaria will teach them to you.

Skills: Each school of sorcery is a separate secondary skill. As a newly created sorcerer you may select one school as a trained skill (based on ④). You don't get a base chance in schools of sorcery that you are not trained in, even as a sorcerer. You can learn additional schools of sorcery during the game (page 61).

Sorcery in Solaria: Very little is settled. The schools did not grow out of one another. They arrived separately, out of different parts of the world and at different times, and where they overlap they seem to do so by accident – a symbolist and an animist can get the same result by methods neither can explain to the other, and each is fairly sure the other is doing it wrong.



ANIMISM

The world is alive. It is full of spirits and gods, and there is something awake in a spring, a stone, a tree, an animal. Like nature itself, spirits and gods are neither good nor evil. They may not be omnipotent, but they possess great power and should be treated with respect. If you speak to them in the right way,

they may lend power to your animist sorcery. Animists mend wounds and drive out what does not belong – daedra and the undead, which are no part of the natural world.

This is the oldest thing anyone in Solaria does, and the hardest to see. Every spring, every black rock, and every name scratched in the niche by the door is someone an animist can talk to – but almost everyone who says a word over a cistern is only saying what their mother said, and nothing answers. The few for whom something does answer are mostly Sunameri, mostly women, and mostly known by some other name: the one you fetch when a cow will not stand, or when a birth has gone wrong. The temple has never moved against them. Lorkhan is a sun god with a calendar to run and no argument with anybody's grandmother.

The hills will teach you the first two ranks. Past that you go out – to the herders on the edge of the Dust Deserts, or south into the Warring States, where nobody stopped practising when the government stopped existing.



DAEDROLOGY

Something is outside the world. The few books that give it a name call it Oblivion, and the things that come out of it are called daedra, and beyond that almost nothing is agreed. The small ones are not much more than animals – vicious, stupid, and easy enough to bind once you know the words. What the big ones are, nobody who has met one seems willing to say plainly.

A daedrologist opens a door and asks for something. Most work alone. Where there are more, it is three or four people around one shrine – a cave mouth, a hilltop, a ruin nobody else will camp in – and their words are not the words used at the shrine two valleys over. There is no school and nothing written down that two practitioners would both recognise. What you learn, you learn from one person, and it is theirs.

Most places want nothing to do with it. A daedrologist who is found out is run off if they are lucky and drowned if they are not. But some places

are quieter about it, because the thing in the cave has been useful – it kept the wolves off, or it found the child, or it settled a debt – and nobody with a full granary asks what it was paid.

Pacts: Rank 3 spells and above are rarely taught. They are bargained for, and whatever answers will name a price. Your GM decides what it is and what happens when you fail to pay.



ELEMENTALISM

Elementalists hold that the world is made of wind, water, earth and fire, and that anyone who knows the proportions can argue with them. In practice the school is mostly fire. Fire answers faster than the rest and it is the one Solarians have always been on speaking terms with – the salt kilns, the glassworks, the ovens under the streets, the lamps kept burning all night along the canal walls. A country that spends that much of the day tending flames turns out the occasional person who can start one without a spark.

If anyone in Solaria has seen sorcery, it was probably this one. Elementalism is the only school whose work cannot be mistaken for something else – a fire that starts on a word, a man walking out of a burning room with his clothes untouched – and that is most of the reason there are so few elementalists, and why the ones there are do not stay anywhere long. Maalkatia is said to keep one or two with its army out in the Dust Deserts, which if it were true would explain a great deal about the last thirty years. Everywhere else, an elementalism is something that happened once on the Ciclopea road, to somebody's uncle, who still will not talk about it.



SYMBOLISM

Symbolists think of themselves as artisans rather than sorcerers. Their sorcery is written: a symbol carved, drawn or traced in the air, which holds its effect for as long as the mark lasts. Much of it is triggered by the simple act of being seen. Symbolism works differently enough from the other schools that it has its own rules – see page 87.

It is handed down inside families rather than taught, which in Solaria means mostly Sunameri families, and a house that has it does not say so. The marks are on lintels, cistern stones and granary doors all over the country, most of them old enough that nobody living remembers who cut them or what they were meant to keep out. Almost none of them are sorcery – a mason copying a shape his grandfather copied. Which ones are is not a question people ask aloud, and you cannot tell from the road. The Dunameri have a claim on the school too, and a fair one: a sorcery that only works once it is written down suits people who write everything down.



ALCHEMY

Alchemists ask what things are made of and how they might be taken apart and put back together. They do not cast spells at the world; they brew substances and then use them. An alchemist's "spells" are called recipes, and they are learned and prepared like any other spell, but they need ingredients and a laboratory – see page 96.

An alchemist's work travels much further than an alchemist does. A dose changes hands four or five times between the still and the mouth it ends in, and by then nobody in the chain could tell you who made it or what went into it. Ingredients come up the Ciclopea road or out of the Warring States, and the price of a dose says more about whether the passes are open than about anything magickal. The people at the end of that chain rarely think they are handling sorcery. The people at the start of it rarely correct them.



GENERAL SORCERY

General sorcery is not a school, but a collection of general spells. You can learn general spells no matter which school of sorcery you subscribe to.

SPELLS

The formulas sorcerers use to influence and alter the world are called spells. Many spells are described later in this Chapter. You either know a spell or you do not. You do not have skill levels in individual spells, only in the school. You hold your spells in your memory or grimoire.



RANK

Spells are divided into *ranks*. These have no mechanical effect, but indicate how complex and powerful spells are. As a sorcerer you start the game with only rank 1 spells, but you can learn higher rank spells during the game.



PREPARED SPELLS

Spells are complicated, and the maximum number of spells you can hold *prepared* in your memory at the same time is equal to your base chance for  (page 25). When you have reached your limit and want to prepare another spell, you need to replace a spell. To prepare spells, you need to study them in a grimoire. This takes a shift of time, regardless of the number of spells. It can be done during a shift rest (page 52). You can only prepare spells that you have learned (page 61). Mark your prepared spells with an X on your character sheet.



GRIMOIRE

Most sorcerers have a grimoire, and newly created sorcerers automatically get one. In the grimoire, you record all the spells you know. Recording one spell takes a shift of time. You can record unreadied spells.

Once you have learned more spells than can be held prepared, your grimoire becomes crucial. In an emergency, you can cast spells directly from the grimoire, but it takes twice as long as normal (see below).

Grimoires from other sorcerers are also an effective way to learn new spells, should you not have a teacher. Read more about learning new sorcery on page 61.

Lost Grimoire: If you lose your grimoire, you cannot prepare the spells you kept in it. To be able to use the unprepared spells again, you first need to get a new grimoire and record these spells in it.



MAGICKAL TRICKS

So-called *magickal tricks* are minor, relatively harmless spells. They are often the first thing a sorcerer learns, as these simple spells train their minds to handle magickal power. Each school has its own magickal tricks, except alchemy, which has none. The limit on prepared spells (above) does not apply to magickal tricks. Your magickal tricks are always prepared. All magickal tricks require a *gesture* (below) to be cast – except symbolist tricks, which are the only symbolist sorcery that needs no symbol drawn.

NEWLY CREATED SORCERER

As a newly created sorcerer you may select three rank 1 spells and three magickal tricks to start the game with. They must be chosen from your school of sorcery or general sorcery. You also get a grimoire where all your spells are recorded.

Alchemists have no magickal tricks to choose, so take three rank 1 recipes and nothing else. You also start with a small field laboratory and D6 doses of general herbs.



CASTING SPELLS

To cast a spell you must spend Willpower Points (**WP**) and roll against your skill level in the relevant school. Any school can be used to cast general spells. If the roll succeeds, the spell has the intended effect, as per its description. Otherwise, it has no effect. You can push the roll. Magickal tricks succeed automatically and always cost 1 **WP**.

Zero WP: Some spells can drain **WP** from another person. Hitting zero **WP** has no other effect than prohibiting the use of abilities that require **WP**.



POWER LEVEL

The *power level* of a spell indicates how much power you charge it with. The power level ranges from 1 to 3. Casting a spell costs 2 **WP** per power level. In other words, normal spells always cost at least 2 **WP**, and magickal tricks always cost 1 **WP**. Some spells do not use power level – these always cost 2 **WP**.

Power from the Body: If you have just one or zero **WP** left, you can draw power from your body if need be. But this is harmful, potentially even lethal. Roll a die of your choice (D4, D6, D8, D10, D12, or D20) before casting the spell – the result indicates how many **WP** you gain and must use straight away, but you also take the same amount of damage. **WP** not used immediately are lost. The damage is applied after the spell is cast. *Power from the body cannot be used for healing spells.*



SORCERY AND METAL

Metal has an anti-magickal effect, which means that you cannot use sorcery if you are wearing metal armor or have a metal weapon at hand (page 45). This includes partially metal items such as axes, spears, studded leather, and arrows (but not staves, clubs, or slings). Items in your inventory do not count.



REQUIREMENTS

To cast a spell, you must fulfill one or more *requirements* which are specified in the description of each spell.

- ◆ **Word:** The spell is activated with a chant or power word. It cannot be a whisper.
- ◆ **Gesture:** The spell is activated by making specific hand movements.
- ◆ **Focus:** The spell is activated with an item held in your hand, such as a wand, crystal ball, or amulet.
- ◆ **Ingredient:** The spell is activated using a certain ingredient, which is consumed in the process.
- ◆ **Symbol:** The spell is activated by a magickal symbol you carve, draw, or trace in the air. Symbolist spells use this requirement and no other – see page 87.

Some spells have multiple requirements. You cannot cast a spell unless all its requirements are fulfilled.

Alchemy does not use these requirements at all. Every recipe instead needs its listed ingredients and access to a laboratory – see page 96.



CASTING TIME

Unless otherwise stated, casting a spell always counts as an action in combat. However, there are *reaction* spells which are performed outside your own turn. Unlike other reactions in combat, such as parrying and dodging, reaction spells do *not* replace your regular action in the round. This means that you can cast as many of them as you want, if you have enough **WP**. There are also *rituals*, which take a stretch of time or even a shift to perform.

Grimoire: Casting an unprepared spell from your grimoire takes twice as long, which means that you must spend an extra round, stretch, or shift on preparations. Make the roll when the spell is completed. Reaction spells cannot be cast from your grimoire.



RANGE

Each spell has a maximum range. Unlike ranged weapons, spells cannot be used on targets outside their specified range. Personal range means that the spell only affects the person casting it.

Area of Effect: Some spells affect an entire area. That area is called the *area of effect*. Unless stated otherwise, the area of effect always starts at the sorcerer casting the spell.

Area of effect spells can be dodged but not parried, unless stated otherwise. You can exempt one or more targets within the area from the spell's effects, but you then get a bane on the roll.

Sphere: If the range is described as *sphere*, the spell affects all targets within the chosen area except the sorcerer himself.

Cone: If the range is described as *cone*, the spell affects all targets within a cone-shaped area whose width at any given point equals the distance from the source of the spell. The range indicates the length of the cone.



DURATION

Each spell specifies the duration of its effect.

- ◆ **Instant:** The effect occurs instantly and has no lasting effect.
- ◆ **Round:** The effect lasts until your turn in the next round.
- ◆ **Stretch:** The effect lasts for one stretch of time.
- ◆ **Shift:** The effect lasts until the end of the current shift.

- ◆ **Concentration:** The effect ceases if you perform another action, take damage, or fail a ☹️ roll for resisting fear. If you are interrupted by a sudden disturbance, such as a sound, you must make a ☹️ roll (not an action) to maintain your concentration.



FAILURE, DRAGONS AND DEMONS

If the roll for casting a spell fails, the spell has no effect, but you still spend your **WP**. You are free to describe how the failure manifests itself in the story, as long as it has no mechanical effect.

Rolling a Dragon: Rolling a Dragon when you cast a spell means that your target must roll a dragon to resist, parry, or dodge the spell, and that you may choose one of the following effects:

- ◆ The damage or range of the spell is doubled.
- ◆ The spell does not cost any **WP**.
- ◆ You can immediately cast another spell, but get a bane on the roll.

Rolling a Demon: If you roll a Demon, you cannot push the roll. There is also a risk of something going terribly wrong – see the optional rule for magickal mishaps below.

MAGICKAL MISHAPS

D20	MAGICKAL MISHAP
1	The magickal powers leave you Dazed.

MAGICKAL ITEMS

Magickal items may contain one or more spells that can be activated even by non-sorcerers. Unless stated otherwise, it takes a successful roll against **LANGUAGES** or any school of sorcery to identify the spells and be able to use them.

Willpower Points: Using the spells inside a magickal item still costs **WP**. Some magickal items can store **WP** which you can use instead of your own. Read more on page 62.

MAGICKAL MISHAP (OPTIONAL RULE)

A magickal mishap occurs if you roll a Demon (20) when casting a spell. Roll on the table below.

D20	MAGICKAL MISHAP	D20	MAGICKAL MISHAP
2	The spellcasting suddenly makes you Exhausted.	14	You are struck by amnesia and forget who you and the other player characters are. The effect must be roleplayed. Roll D4 every morning. On a 1, your memory returns.
3	The energies take a toll on your body and make you Sickly.	15	The spell also affects a friend or other unintended victim. A healing or helping spell affects an enemy.
4	You lose control of the spell, which makes you very Angry.	16	The spell backfires. An offensive spell affects you instead of the intended target. A protecting or healing spell inflicts damage instead.
5	The spell subjects you to visions of Oblivion that leave you Scared.	17	You turn into an animal. Roll D6. 1: cat, 2: fox, 3: goat, 4: wolf, 5: deer, 6: bear. You get stats according to the table on page 99 and cannot speak, but you retain your mental acuity. Roll a D4 every morning. On a 1, you revert back to your original form.
6	You see the world beyond the veil and realize your own insignificance. You feel Scared.	18	The years fall away from you. Your  and  each increase by 1, to a maximum of 18, but your skill levels do not change. The effect is permanent.
7	The sorcery ravages your body, inflicting D6 damage per power level.	19	You age a lifetime in a moment. Your  ,  , and  each decrease by 2, to a minimum of 3, and your  and  each increase by 1, to a maximum of 18. Your skill levels do not change. The effect is permanent.
8	The spell drains your resolve and you lose D6 WP per power level.	20	Your sorcery attracts a daedra (page 85) out of Oblivion. It shows up within the next shift and attacks or causes some kind of trouble. The details are up to the GM.
9	The spell gives rise to a magickal disease with virulence 3D6. You and everyone you come into contact with during the next shift are exposed to the disease.		
10	Another random spell of yours is activated instead of the one you cast, with the same target and power level.		
11	You vomit a frog the moment you tell a lie. Roll D4 every morning. On a 1, the effect wears off. It can also be lifted with DISPEL .		
12	Any silver or orichalcum you touch withers into dust. Roll D4 every morning. On a 1, the effect wears off. It can also be lifted with DISPEL .		
13	The spell blinds you, and you act as if in total darkness (page 52). Roll D4 every morning. On a 1, you recover. The effect can also be lifted with DISPEL .		

LEARNING SORCERY

You can learn new spells from a teacher or grimoire. You must have a skill level in the relevant school of sorcery, or any school of sorcery for general spells.

Prerequisites: Some spells have a prerequisite that must be met in order to learn them. It is usually a school of sorcery or knowing another spell.

Teachers: The easiest (but often most expensive) way to learn a spell is from a teacher who already knows it. The lesson takes one shift, but you cannot activate the new spell until the end of the game session. You must then use an advancement mark (page 29) for the school to learn the new spell instead of trying to increase your skill level in the school. Make a roll against , with a boon. On success you learn the spell, otherwise you do not.

Grimoires: If you are lucky, you can find spells in other sorcerers' grimoires. You can learn them on your own. This works the same way as with a teacher, but you roll against **LANGUAGES** instead of , without the boon.

Magickal Tricks: Magickal tricks are easier to learn than real spells. It takes one stretch to learn a new trick from a teacher or grimoire. No advancement mark or roll is required.

Schools of Sorcery: You can learn additional schools of sorcery by first acquiring the perk Sorcerous Talent (page 41), and then studying under a teacher with a skill level in the school for at least a week. At the end of the week you make a roll against . On a success you get your base chance () as the skill level in the school. On failure you may try again after another week of study. Even non-sorcerers can learn sorcery this way.

Tuition: What a teacher charges depends on the rank of the spell, not the school. Expect around 5 gold per shift for rank 1–2, and at least 50 gold per shift for rank 3–4. Nobody sells rank 5. The handful of sorcerers who can teach it have no interest in raising a rival, and want a favor rather than coin – a

task, a theft, a rescue, a killing. Your GM will have something in mind.

SPELL LIST

The following pages list every magickal trick, spell and recipe in this book. General Sorcery comes first, then the five schools in turn: Animism, Daedrology, Elementalism, Symbolism, and Alchemy.

GENERAL SORCERY



MAGICKAL TRICKS

Fetch: You make a loose object (no heavier than weight 1) within 10 meters float to you.

Flick: You give an object or creature within 10 meters a magickal flick. The "attack" inflicts 1 point of damage and can, for example, shatter glass.

Light: You create a bright light that shines from a focus of your choice. It illuminates a 10-meter radius area around your focus and lasts for one shift of time. The light goes out if you reach zero **HP**.

Open/Close: You open or close an unlocked door within 10 meters that you can see.

Repair Clothes: Clothes belonging to you or someone else within 10 meters are instantly repaired and cleaned.

Sense Sorcery: You can sense whether the place you are in, or an item you are holding, is affected by sorcery – and if so, what kind of sorcery.





DISPEL

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Any School of Sorcery
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You cancel an ongoing spell of lower or equal power level. **DISPEL** can also be used to end other magickal effects, if the adventure or GM allows it.



PROTECTOR

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Any School of Sorcery
- ◆ **Requirement:** Gesture, ingredient (something to draw with)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

You protect a person or place (no larger than a human) from sorcery. You can cast the spell on yourself. The power level of all spells cast at the person or place is reduced by the power level in **PROTECTOR**. You can also use the spell to protect against magickal attacks from monsters (page 83). In that case, each power level reduces the number of dice rolled for damage by 1.



MAGICKAL SHIELD

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** **PROTECTOR** or **DISPEL**
- ◆ **Requirement:** Gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Reaction
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You interfere with a spell cast by another sorcerer. This spell is a reaction and breaks the initiative order of combat, but does not replace your action in the round. You cast it after your opponent's roll to succeed, but before any roll for damage or other effect. If it succeeds, the power level of your opponent's spell decreases by the power level of your **MAGICKAL SHIELD**. If the result is zero or less, your opponent's spell has no effect at all. You can also use the spell to stop magickal attacks from monsters (page 83). In that case, each power level reduces the number of dice rolled for damage by 1.



TRANSFER

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** **MAGICKAL SHIELD**
- ◆ **Requirement:** Gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You can steal **WP** from other humanoid creatures or transfer your **WP** to someone else. You can take or give a number of **WP** up to twice cost for casting the spell – i.e. four at power level 1, eight at power level 2, and twelve at level 3. The **WP** used to cast the spell are lost in the transfer. You can never exceed your maximum **WP** or go below zero, and the same goes for your subject. If they refuse the transfer, you get a bane to your roll.



MAGICKAL SEAL

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** **TRANSFER**
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Shift
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Permanent

You bind a spell to an inanimate object of your choice. The power level of **MAGICKAL SEAL**



determines the power level of the bound spell. Binding a magickal trick requires power level 1. When casting **MAGICKAL SEAL** you also decide how the bound spell is activated. When that happens, the spell uses **WP** from the person activating it. If this person cannot or will not spend their **WP**, the spell is not activated. **MAGICKAL SEAL** can be combined with **CHARGE** to give the object its own **WP** to use. The two rituals must then be performed consecutively. Activating a bound spell dissolves the **MAGICKAL SEAL**, unless the **MAGICKAL SEAL** is combined with **PERMANENCE** (below).



CHARGE

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** TRANSFER
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

You transfer your **WP** to an inanimate object of your choice, which acts as a battery. Each power level lets you transfer up to 10 **WP**. Anyone in contact with the object can then use its **WP** instead of their own. After one shift of time, the charged **WP** dissipate, unless combined with **PERMANENCE**. **CHARGE** can also be combined with **MAGICKAL SEAL** (see above).



PERMANENCE

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** **MAGICKAL SEAL**
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Shift
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Permanent

This ritual is combined with another spell and makes it permanent. This costs the sorcerer one point of ☹

permanently (and reduces maximum **WP** by one). The power level of **PERMANENCE** must be equal to that of the spell being made permanent. **PERMANENCE** cannot be added to spells with instant duration. If **PERMANENCE** is combined with **MAGICKAL SEAL**, the latter becomes permanent and the bound spell can be activated any number of times.

ANIMISM



MAGICKAL TRICKS

Birdsong: You are surrounded by lovely birdsong for one stretch of time. The birds give you a boon to **AWARENESS**. This trick only works outdoors.

Clean: The room you are in is cleaned. All dust and dirt disappear, and the room is put in order.

Cook Food: You automatically succeed at cooking food (page 103) without a **BUSHCRAFT** roll, and it happens instantly (one action).

Floral Trail: Beautiful flowers sprout where you walk. The flowers wither after a shift.

Hairstyle: You change the color, length, and style of your hair as you see fit. In some situations this can give you a boon to **BLUFFING** and **PERSUASION** rolls.



ANIMAL WHISPERER

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Animism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch
- ◆ **Range:** 2 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

This spell lets you talk to a bird or mammal. You can ask a number of questions equal to the power level. Animals can tell you what they have seen, heard, or smelled – but they do not perceive the world as

humanoids do, and their answers are hard to interpret. The main advantage is that they never lie.



BANISH

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Animism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture, focus (holy symbol)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

Daedra, and undead rising from their graves, are a violation of the natural order and must be stopped. This spell inflicts 2D8 damage on such a being. Each additional power level increases the damage by D8. Armor and natural armor have no effect, and the spell cannot be dodged or parried.



CURE

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Animism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

The spell immediately ends the effect of a natural disease or poison (see pages 52–53) on yourself or another living creature. Magical diseases may require power level 2 or 3, or in rare cases be impossible to CURE.



ENSNARING ROOTS

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Animism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Gesture, ingredient (branches or roots nearby)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action

- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

The victim is ensnared by roots and branches and is unable to move. Breaking free requires an **EVADE** roll – with a boon at power level 1, normally at power level 2, and with a bane at power level 3. Each attempt counts as an action in combat. Only one attempt is allowed per round, but others can help. The spell does not work on monsters.



LIGHTNING FLASH

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Animism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 30 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You call down a flash of lightning from the sky. If the spell is cast successfully, the target takes 2D6 damage. The lightning flash continues to another random target within 2 meters of the initial target, inflicting 2D4 damage. Each power level beyond the first increases the number of dice rolled for damage by one (e.g., 3D6 and 3D4 respectively at power level 2). Metal armor has no effect but the spell can be dodged or parried as a ranged attack, and if this is successfully done, no further target is hit. Indoors, the **WP** cost to cast the spell is doubled.



NOURISH

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Animism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch
- ◆ **Range:** Personal
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You can get all the necessary nutrients and hydration by sprouting threadlike roots from your hands and

feet and burrowing them into the earth. This process takes a stretch to complete and fulfills your need for food and water for a full day. The required power level depends on the environment – power level 1 in forests and fertile wilderness; power level 2 in towns, villages, or vegetated mountains; and power level 3 in barren mountains or caverns.



TREAT WOUND

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Animism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You heal a living creature for 2D6 **HP**. You can use the spell on yourself. For each power level beyond the first, the spell heals an additional D6 **HP**.



CALM ANIMAL

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** ANIMAL WHISPERER
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You pacify a number of common mammals or birds up to the power level. The effect ends immediately if the animals are attacked. This spell has no effect on monsters.



ENGULFING FOREST

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** ENSNARING ROOTS
- ◆ **Requirement:** Gesture, ingredient (branches or roots nearby)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action

- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters (sphere)
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

You call upon the spirits of the forest who quickly make thickets of thorns and roots shoot up from the ground in the area of effect. The area counts as rough terrain (page 44), and everyone except yourself (not monsters) who is in the area of effect when you cast the spell is ensnared by roots and branches, unable to move. Breaking free requires an **EVADE** roll – with a boon at power level 1, normally at power level 2, and with a bane at power level 3. Each attempt counts as an action in combat. Only one attempt is allowed per round. Other people who are not ensnared can help.



HEAL WOUND

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** TREAT WOUND
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You heal a living creature for 2D8 **HP** and one non-permanent severe injury. You can use the spell on yourself. For each power level beyond the first, the spell heals an additional D8 **HP**.



LIGHTNING BOLT

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** LIGHTNING FLASH
- ◆ **Requirement:** Gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 40 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You call down a great bolt of lightning on a target, who suffers 2D8 damage. The bolt continues to another random target within 2 meters of the initial target, inflicting 2D6 damage, and then to a third target within 2 meters, who suffers 2D4 damage.

Each power level beyond the first increases the number of dice rolled for damage by one. Metal armor has no effect but the spell can be dodged or parried as a ranged attack, and if this is successfully done, no further target is hit. Indoors, the **WP** cost to cast the spell is doubled.



PURGE

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** BANISH
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture, focus (holy symbol)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You exorcise a daedra or undead, inflicting 2D10 damage on the unnatural creature. Each power level increases the damage by D10. Armor and natural armor have no effect, and the spell cannot be dodged or parried.



RECOVERY

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** CURE
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

The spell immediately removes one condition of your choice per power level from yourself or another living creature.



SLEEP

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** TREAT WOUND
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action

- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

Casting this spell requires an opposed roll against the target's ☹. You roll with a bane at power level 1, normally at power level 2, and with a boon at power level 3. If you win, the target falls into a deep sleep for a stretch. A sleeping person is very difficult to wake, but wakes up upon taking damage. The spell can only be used on the living and has no effect on monsters.



COMMAND ANIMAL

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** CALM ANIMAL
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Concentration

You take control of a number of mammals or birds (page 99) up to the power level. The animals obey your commands as long as you maintain concentration. Communication is telepathic and has no range limit. The animals can track enemies, run to a specific location to deliver a message, or attack your foes, just to name a few examples. In combat the animals act on your turn, moving and performing one action each just like any other creature. This ritual has no effect on monsters.



DAZE

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** SLEEP
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You force multiple individuals within range, up to a total equal to your base chance in ☹, to make a ☹

roll. All who fail become Dazed. This spell has no effect on monsters.



EXHAUST

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** SLEEP
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You force multiple individuals within range, up to a total equal to your base chance in ☹, to make a ☹ roll. All who fail become Exhausted. This spell has no effect on monsters.



REINVIGORATE

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** NOURISH and ENGULFING FOREST
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch
- ◆ **Range:** Personal
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

The threadlike roots sprouting from your hands (see **NOURISH**) can now do more than just draw nutrients and hydration from the land – they also heal your body and mind. This process takes a stretch to complete and fulfills your need for food and water for a full day. You are also reinvigorated and cured of all conditions. The required power level depends on the environment – power level 1 in forests and fertile wilderness; power level 2 in towns, villages, or vegetated mountains; and power level 3 in barren mountains or caverns.



RESTORATION

- ◆ **Rank:** 3

- ◆ **Prerequisite:** HEAL WOUND
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You heal a living creature for 2D10 **HP** and any one severe injury. You can use the spell on yourself. For each power level beyond the first, the spell heals an additional D10 **HP**.



THORN FIELD

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** ENGULFING FOREST
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture, and ingredient (a handful of seeds)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters (sphere)
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

You scatter a handful of seeds around you, which instantly take root even in the poorest soil or on stone floors. The area counts as rough terrain (page 44) and everyone except yourself (not monsters) who is in the area of effect when you cast the spell is ensnared by thorns, unable to move. They also suffer D8 piercing damage at the start of each turn. Breaking free requires a successful **EVADE** roll – made with a boon at power level 1, normally at power level 2, and with a bane at power level 3. Each attempt counts as an action in combat, and only one attempt is allowed per round. Other people who are not ensnared can help.



THUNDERBOLT

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** LIGHTNING BOLT
- ◆ **Requirement:** Gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 50 meters

- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You call down a mighty thunderstroke on a target, who suffers 2D10 damage. The thunderstroke continues to up to three random targets within 2 meters of each other. The damage is 2D8 for the second target, 2D6 for the third, and 2D4 for the fourth. Each power level beyond the first increases the number of dice rolled for damage by one. Metal armor has no effect but the spell can be dodged or parried as a ranged attack, and if this is successfully done, no further target is hit. Indoors, the **WP** cost to cast the spell is doubled.



HEALING RADIANCE

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** RESTORATION
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You let your healing powers shine upon all your allies within range, who immediately heal 2D6 **HP** each. For each power level beyond the first, the spell restores an additional D6 **HP** to each target. The spell does not heal yourself.



MASS PURGE

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** PURGE
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture, focus (holy symbol)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You exorcise multiple daedra or undead within range, up to a total equal to your base chance in ☹. If the spell succeeds, all targeted unnatural creatures take 2D10 damage. Roll damage separately for each target. Armor and natural armor have no effect. For

each power level beyond the first, you may either increase the damage by D10 or increase the range by 10 meters.



WEATHER MASTERY

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** THUNDERBOLT
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 100 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

You are so in tune with the forces of nature that you can create a drastic weather shift in the area around you. A minor shift, from cloudy to rainy or from dead calm to a light breeze, requires power level 1. Unusual but seasonally appropriate weather phenomena – a blizzard in winter, blazing heat in the summer, or heavy winds and lashing rains in the fall – requires power level 2. Summoning completely unnatural weather, such as a blizzard in the desert or a heatwave in the middle of winter, requires power level 3.



ANIMALISTIC INFLUENCE

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** WEATHER MASTERY
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch
- ◆ **Range:** 50 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

You cause animalistic emotions to overtake the mind and behavior of an intelligent, living creature. For example, you can make them feel the rage of a wild boar, the laziness of a cat, or the skittish fear of a sparrow. The GM decides how this affects the creature's behavior. You can also influence the mood of an entire group – power level 2 is required for a number of individuals up to your base chance in ☹, and power level 3 for up to five times that number.

The targets are behaviorally influenced but will still defend themselves if attacked. This ritual cannot be used on monsters and undead.



HEALING AURA

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** HEALING RADIANCE
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

Healing energy radiates from your body, causing all allies within range to heal 2D8 **HP** and one non-permanent severe injury (optional rule, see page 51). For each power level beyond the first, you may either increase the range by 10 meters or have the spell restore an additional D8 **HP**. The spell does not heal yourself.



RESURRECTION

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** HEALING RADIANCE
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture, ingredient (corpse)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Shift
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You can channel nature's forces to resurrect a dead person – not as an undead creature, but truly alive. The more time that has passed since the target died, the more difficult it is. Within the same shift requires power level 1, within a day requires power level 2, and within a week requires power level 3. If over a week has passed, the body is too decomposed to be **RESURRECTED**. Only one attempt can be made – if it fails, the victim is permanently dead.

Casting **RESURRECTION** is so taxing that it permanently reduces your maximum **WP** by 1, even if the ritual fails. However, your maximum **WP** can

still be increased through the perk Focused (page 39). A person brought back to life loses D3 skill levels in all ☹-based skills (to a minimum of 3). **RESURRECTION** cannot be undone by **DISPEL**.

DAEDROLOGY



MAGICKAL TRICKS

Summon Scamp: You can summon a scamp, a rat-sized daedra that stays for a shift. It has no skills but can help with your everyday tasks.

Stench: Once per shift, you can fill a room with a stench so foul that everyone in it must either leave or make a ☹ roll to avoid vomiting. This trick has no effect in combat or similar intense situations.

Slip of the Tongue: You can make someone within 10 meters misspeak by replacing up to three words in their sentence with something else (preferably rude or vulgar). This must be done on the fly – you interrupt mid-sentence, but to everyone nearby it sounds like the person you are interrupting is speaking your words. If you say more than three words, the extras will be heard in your voice. Afterward, the victim will be more cautious with their speech and cannot be affected by this trick again for 24 hours.



ABYSSAL STENCH

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Daedrology
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Personal
- ◆ **Duration:** Round

You release the vile stench of Oblivion through your pores and respiratory system. Until your next turn, anyone attempting a melee attack against you must succeed with a ☹ roll. The roll does not count as an

action. At power level 1 the victim gains a boon, at power level 2 the roll is made normally, and at power level 3 the victim suffers a bane. If the roll fails, the attack is canceled and the victim loses their action. The spell has no effect on daedra, undead, or monsters.



CARBUNCLE

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Daedrology
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You hurl a daedric winged louse at an opponent. The louse automatically finds its target, burrows into their skin, and begins to multiply. The victim immediately takes D4 damage, followed by escalating damage on each turn until the carbuncle bursts – first D6, then D8 and finally D10. Armor has no effect and the effect continues even if you are incapacitated. The power level determines when the carbuncle bursts: at the second damage roll at power level 1, at the third at power level 2, and at the fourth at power level 3. This spell has no effect on daedra or undead.



DAEDRIC GUST

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Daedrology
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters (cone)
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You summon a gust of pungent wind from Oblivion, blasting enemies in front of you. All opponents in the area of effect are shocked and must make a ☹️ roll to resist fear (page 53). At power level 1 the victim gains a boon, at power level 2 the roll is made

normally, and at power level 3 the victim suffers a bane.



DEADLANDS

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Daedrology
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch
- ◆ **Range:** 30 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

You infect the ground within a 30-meter radius with daedric energy, dragging a scrap of the Deadlands into the world, and may also designate an unaffected area at the center – typically large enough to set up camp. The affected ground becomes scorching hot, swampy, and filled with noxious fumes that irritate exposed skin and mucous membranes.

Wild animals and beasts automatically avoid the area. NPCs have their movement halved and living creatures (including monsters) also take D4 damage on each turn they begin in the deadlands. Flying creatures are not affected.



BEETLE BOIL

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** CARBUNCLE
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You launch a daedric, spawn-filled beetle at an opponent. The beetle automatically finds its target, bites through the skin, and releases its ravenous spawn. The victim immediately takes D6 damage, followed by escalating damage on each turn until the carbuncle bursts – first D8, then D10 and finally D12. The attack can be dodged like a ranged attack, but armor has no effect and the effect continues even if you are incapacitated. The power level determines

when the spawn die: at the second damage roll at power level 1, at the third at power level 2, and at the fourth at power level 3. This spell has no effect on daedra or undead.



BLOODLUST

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** CARBUNCLE
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

You temporarily invite a daedric spirit into your mind or that of an ally. The invasion is very unpleasant, especially in combat, where the daedra often screams with pleasure at every splash of blood and flash of pain. The target must immediately succeed with a ☹️ roll or gain the Sickly condition. In return, the daedra's bloodlust grants a boon on all melee attacks and ☹️ rolls to resist fear for the duration of the spell, which increases by one shift per power level. While under the daedra's influence, the target cannot dodge or parry.



DAEDRIC VISAGE

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** ABYSSAL STENCH
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Personal
- ◆ **Duration:** Round

You temporarily assume the grotesque, reeking face of a daedra. Until the start of your next turn, anyone attempting a melee attack against you must succeed with a ☹️ roll. At power level 1, the victim gains a boon; at power level 2, the roll is made normally; and at power level 3, the victim suffers a bane. If the roll fails, the attack is canceled and the victim must roll

on the Fear table (page 53). The spell has no effect on daedra, undead, or monsters.



DEADLAND MIRE

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** DEADLANDS
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 30 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Stretch

You transform the ground beneath one opponent per power level into a 2×2-meter patch of frothing, scalding mire from the Deadlands. The target sinks knee-deep into the mire and automatically takes 2D6 damage at the start of each subsequent turn. Armor has no effect. Escaping the mire requires an action and a successful **EVAD**E roll. Others can help. The spell has no effect on Large or Huge creatures, and creatures resistant to fire or heat do not take damage from the mire.



BEEBLE SWARM

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** DAEDRIC GUST and BEEBLE BOIL
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters (sphere)
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You summon a swarm of daedric beetles that feast on living flesh. The swarm attacks up to four targets within range – you decide which ones and in what order. The first victim takes 2D10 damage, the second 2D8, the third 2D6, and the fourth 2D4. Armor has no effect, but the swarm can be parried or dodged as a ranged attack, which if successful stops the swarm from moving on to the next victim. At power level 1 the victims gain a boon, at power level 2 the rolls are made normally, and at power level 3

the victims suffer a bane on parrying or dodging. The spell has no effect on daedra and undead.



DIMENSIONAL SLIP

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** DAEDRIC VISAGE
- ◆ **Requirement:** Gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Reaction
- ◆ **Range:** Personal
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

When hit by an attack, before damage is rolled, you can momentarily slip into Oblivion. If successful, you avoid all damage from the attack. Even if the spell fails, you may move 2 meters without triggering a free attack. This distance increases by 2 meters per power level beyond the first.



GUTWORM

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** BEETLE BOIL
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You open a rift to Oblivion inside an opponent's abdomen, inviting in a large daedric worm that begins to eat its way out. The victim immediately takes D10 damage, then another D10 on each turn for a number of rounds equal to the power level. Armor has no effect and the effect continues even if you are incapacitated. The spell has no effect on daedra or undead.



RAGE

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** BLOODLUST
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture

- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Stretch

You allow a powerful daedra of wrath to temporarily possess you or an ally. The target is consumed with white-hot fury directed at all opponents and gains the Angry condition. For the duration of the spell, the possessed cannot parry or dodge, but gains a bonus action (on the same turn) that can only be used to attack, as well as a boon on resisting fear and mind-altering sorcery. When the possession ends, the target must immediately make a ☼ roll or become Sickly.



BANISH TO OBLIVION

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** DIMENSIONAL SLIP
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Round

You temporarily banish a target to Oblivion. Casting the spell requires an opposed roll against the victim's ☹. At power level 1 you roll with a bane, at power level 2 the roll is made normally, and at power level 3 you gain a boon. If you win, the target vanishes immediately and reappears on your turn in the next round, charred and reeking, having taken 2D10 damage. Armor has no effect. The spell cannot be dodged, but cannot be used on Large or Huge monsters.



SUMMON CHAMPION

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** GUTWORM and RAGE
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture, focus (ritual circle)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch
- ◆ **Range:** 4 meters

◆ **Duration:** Stretch

You quickly draw a ritual circle in the sand, soil, or on a stone floor. If the ritual succeeds, a daedra of the GM's choosing materializes in the circle, ready to fight for or alongside you for a stretch, without demanding anything in return. It follows you around, attacking any target you point out, but it cannot be micromanaged (the GM uses the monster attacks table).

The tricky part is getting the daedra to return to Oblivion when the spell expires. This requires another **DAEDROLOGY** roll (counts as an action but requires no **WP**). At power level 1 you get a bane on the roll, at power level 2 it is rolled normally, and at power level 3 it is rolled with a boon. If the roll fails, the daedra breaks free from your control. Roll D6. 1–3: the daedra immediately attacks you and your allies, 4–6: the daedra chuckles and strides off to spread terror and havoc in the surrounding area unless you and your allies attack it immediately.

Dremora: The dremora described under **SUMMON DREMORA**, below, is particularly loyal and returns obediently to Oblivion when the spell expires.



SUMMON DREMORA

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** GUTWORM
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture, focus (ritual circle)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Shift
- ◆ **Range:** 4 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

You summon a number of dremora (see stats below) equal to twice the power level to guard a specific location or building up to 50 meters in diameter.

They cannot leave this area and will attack anyone who approaches from the outside, except you.

DREMORA

Keen Sense of Smell: These guardians have a very keen sense of smell, which gives opponents a bane on **SNEAKING** rolls to get past them.

Coordinated: Dremora are drilled to fight together. Because of this, dremora may choose their place in the initiative order rather than rolling for it, as long as they do not fight alone.



BIND CHAMPION

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** SUMMON CHAMPION
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture, focus (ritual circle)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Shift
- ◆ **Range:** 4 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** One day per power level

This ritual is similar to **SUMMON CHAMPION** but allows you to maintain control over the daedric champion for a longer period of time. If your roll is successful, the daedra is summoned into the ritual circle. Next, a negotiation is held. The daedra is willing to serve you and agrees to return to Oblivion at your command but demands something in return (the GM determines the cost – a sacrifice, a killing, a theft, a name).

You may **BARTER** to reduce the cost, but ultimately, you must either accept or reject the deal. In the latter case, the daedra returns to Oblivion with a sneer. If you accept, the daedra becomes your obedient servant for a number of days equal to the power level. It answers your questions to the best of its ability and attacks any target you designate, but it

Ferocity: 1	Size: Normal	HP: 28
Movement: 14	Armor: 2	

D6 MONSTER ATTACK

- 1 **Spear Sweep!** The dremora sweeps its long iron spear to knock an opponent's legs out from under them. The victim is knocked down and becomes Dazed.
- 2 **Shield Bash!** The monster bashes an opponent with its large shield. The spikes on the shield inflict 2D8 piercing damage, and the victim is knocked down.
- 3 **Paralyzing Spear Thrust!** The dremora thrusts its iron spear at an opponent. The attack inflicts 2D10 piercing damage and injects the victim with a paralyzing poison with potency 12.
- 4 **Impaling Horns!** The dremora impales an opponent with its horns. The victim takes 2D10 piercing damage.
- 5 **Entangling Rope!** The dremora pulls a rope with small weights from its belt and throws it at an opponent within 10 meters. The rope entangles the legs of the victim, who trips and falls. The victim is unable to move or perform actions that require movement, except trying to break free, which counts as an action and requires an  roll with a bane. Others can help.
- 6 **Teleportation!** The dremora sticks its iron spear into the ground and teleports to any location within 20 meters. The sudden movement does not trigger a free attack.

cannot be micromanaged (the GM uses the monster attacks table).

When the duration expires, the daedra returns to Oblivion, and you have a certain amount of time to uphold your end of the deal (typically until the next new or full moon). If the agreed price involves something that must be physically handed over, the daedra will return briefly to collect it. But the contract also stipulates that the daedra is allowed to return if payment is not made on time, to claim its due in the form of your flesh and blood.

◆ **Range:** 4 meters

◆ **Duration:** Shift

You open a temporary rift to Oblivion and summon a swarm of winged twilights with the explicit promise that they will soon be allowed to fight. The swarm has stats as vampiric bats (page 99), but its Ferocity is equal to the power level plus 1. The swarm obeys your commands without question but cannot be micromanaged (the GM uses the monster attacks table). It remains for up to a shift or until the daedra have tasted combat, whichever comes first.

**SUMMON DAEDRIC SWARM**

◆ **Rank:** 5

◆ **Prerequisite:** SUMMON DREMORA

◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture, focus (ritual circle)

◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch

RENEGOTIATION

Sometimes, instead of attacking outright, the daedra may offer to renegotiate the terms of the pact. This gives you one more moon to deliver, but the cost increases significantly.

ELEMENTALISM



MAGICKAL TRICKS

Heat/Chill: The area within 10 meters of you becomes pleasantly warm or cold. The effect protects against cold (page 54) for one shift of time.

Ignite: You light or extinguish a candle, torch, or lantern within 10 meters.

Puff of Smoke: An impressive puff of smoke erupts in front of you. Very popular for dramatic entrances, and can give you a boon to **SNEAKING** in certain situations as determined by the GM.



FIREBALL

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Elementalism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

The spell sends a fireball from your hand or focus at the target. The fireball can be dodged or parried as a ranged attack. The fireball inflicts 2D6 damage on a hit and sets fire to flammable objects. Each power level beyond the first increases the damage by D6 or creates another fireball that hits another target within range.



FROST

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Elementalism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 4 meters (sphere)
- ◆ **Duration:** Stretch

You drastically lower the temperature around you. All natural fires in the area of effect are extinguished and all living creatures lose D6 **HP** and D6 **WP** when the spell is cast, and become cold as per the rules on page 54 – they cannot heal **HP** or **WP** until they get warm.

Humanoids (not monsters) in the area of effect when the spell is cast are also frozen in place and can neither move nor perform actions (not even reactions). On each turn, a frozen victim can make a 🎲 roll (not an action) to break free. Each additional power level increases the range by 4 meters.

Any water in the area of effect immediately freezes. In a river this creates an ice floe that you can walk on or use as a raft.



GUST OF WIND

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Elementalism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters (cone)
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

The spell summons a great gust of wind. All untethered objects and creatures up to human size in the area of effect are pushed 2D4 meters away from you and suffer the same amount of bludgeoning damage. Against a swarm (page 83) the spell deals 2D6 damage. Each additional power level increases the number of dice by one. The spell has no effect on monsters that are Large or Huge (page 83).



PILLAR

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Elementalism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

The spell raises a pillar, three meters high and one meter wide, from the ground or a stone floor. If someone is standing in that spot, the victim must make an **ACROBATICS** roll (not an action) to avoid falling off the pillar. If the pillar is created under a low ceiling and the roll fails, the victim takes 2D6 bludgeoning damage instead. For each additional power level, the height of the pillar increases by three meters, which can mean falling damage to anyone who falls off (page 53).



SHATTER

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Elementalism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

By breaking the invisible bond that holds physical matter together, you can shatter physical objects. With this spell you inflict 2D10 damage on an inanimate and non-magickal item. Any armor rating has no effect. Each power level beyond the first increases the damage by D10.



FIRE BLAST

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** FIREBALL
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 30 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

The spell sends a large fire blast from your hand or focus at the target. The fire blast can be dodged or parried as a ranged attack. The fire blast inflicts 2D8 damage on a hit and sets fire to flammable objects. Each power level beyond the first increases the damage by D8 or creates another blast that hits another target within range.



STONE SHIELD

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** PILLAR
- ◆ **Requirement:** Gesture, ingredient (pebbles)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Reaction
- ◆ **Range:** Personal
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You instantly summon a shield of stone that decreases the damage of an incoming attack by 2D6. Each additional power level decreases the damage by another D6. You can cast the spell after the roll to hit, but before rolling damage. The spell can be combined with armor.



STONEWALL

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** PILLAR
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

The spell raises a wall from the ground or a stone floor – one meter thick, two meters high, and three meters wide. Each additional power level creates another section of the same size. If someone is standing in that spot, the victim must make an **ACROBATICS** roll (not an action) to avoid falling off. If the wall is created under a low ceiling and the roll fails, the victim takes 2D6 bludgeoning damage instead.



TIDAL WAVE

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** FROST
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture, ingredient (water source)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action

- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters (cone)
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You summon a great wave from a water source within range. The area of effect starts at the source, not at yourself. All untethered objects and creatures in the area of effect are pushed 2D6 meters away from the water source and suffer the same amount of bludgeoning damage. Each additional power level increases the number of dice by one.



WHIRLWIND

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** GUST OF WIND
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 4 meters (sphere)
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

The spell creates a mighty whirlwind around the sorcerer. All untethered objects and creatures up to human size in the area of effect are hurled 2D4 meters away, suffer the same amount of bludgeoning damage, and land prone. Each additional power level increases the range by 4 meters and inflicts another D4 damage.

If you take a bane on the roll, you can let one person in range be hurled to another spot of your choice within the spell's range. You decide whether that person takes damage and whether they land prone.



FIREBIRD

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** FIRE BLAST
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 40 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

The spell sends a terrifying bird of fire from your hand or focus at the target. The attack can be dodged or parried as a ranged attack. The firebird inflicts 2D10 damage on a hit and sets fire to flammable objects. Each power level beyond the first increases the damage by D10 or creates another firebird that hits another target in range.



FIRESTORM

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** FIRE BLAST and WHIRLWIND
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 4 meters (sphere)
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

The spell creates a whirling storm of fire around you. All targets in range suffer 2D6 damage. The attack can be dodged as a ranged attack. Each additional power level increases the range by 4 meters and inflicts another D6 damage.



FLAME ATRONACH

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** FIRE BLAST
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture, ingredient (open fire)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch
- ◆ **Range:** 4 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Stretch

The spell summons a fire elemental. The atronach stands about the height of a woman and is made of nothing but flame, and counts as a monster in combat (page 84). It follows your commands (free action) and acts independently with its own initiative, but must stay within sight of you.

The name is older than the school and does not come from it. Daedrologists say the word for a thing that walks and burns, and elementalists borrowed it.

Movement: 12**HP:** 5 per power level**Armor:** —

Elementalists say they summon fire and nothing else, and that what the daedrologists call it is their own business.

FLAME ATRONACH

Weapons: Burning grip. Hits automatically in melee combat (but can be dodged) and inflicts D6 damage per power level. Armor has no effect.

Fire Orb: The atronach can cast **FIRE BLAST** at the same power level as its own, using the sorcerer's WP.

Resistance: Piercing damage is halved.

Immunity: The atronach is immune to fire damage, including magical fire damage.



SYLPH

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** WHIRLWIND
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch
- ◆ **Range:** 4 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Stretch

The spell summons a wind elemental. The sylph looks like a storm cloud in the shape of a bird. It counts as a monster in combat (page 84). It follows its creator's commands (free action) and acts independently with its own initiative, but must stay within sight of the sorcerer.

SYLPH

Weapons: Howling winds. Hits automatically in melee combat (but can be dodged). The attack hurls

the victim D4 meters per power level and inflicts the same amount of bludgeoning damage.

Gust of Wind: The sylph can cast **GUST OF WIND** at the same power level as its own, using the sorcerer's WP.

Resistance: Piercing damage is halved.



UNDINE

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** TIDAL WAVE
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture, ingredient (water)
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch
- ◆ **Range:** 4 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Stretch

The spell summons a water elemental. The undine looks like a tidal wave whose crest is shaped like a woman composed entirely of water. It counts as a monster in combat (page 84). It follows its creator's commands (free action) and acts independently with its own initiative, but must stay within sight of the sorcerer.

UNDINE

Weapons: Wet embrace. Hits automatically in melee combat (but can be dodged) and inflicts D6 damage per power level. Armor has no effect.

Tidal Wave: The undine can cast **TIDAL WAVE** at the same power level as its own, using the sorcerer's WP.

Resistance: Piercing damage is halved.

Movement: 24**HP:** 5 per power level**Armor:** —**Movement:** 12**HP:** 5 per power level**Armor:** —



FIREBOMB

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** FIREBIRD or FIRESTORM
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 40 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You hurl a blazing sphere of fire at a point in the terrain. On impact it explodes with tremendous force. Everyone within 4 meters of the blast takes 2D8 fire damage. The attack can be dodged as a ranged attack. Each additional power level increases the damage by D8 and the blast radius by 4 meters.



HAILSTORM

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** SYLPH and FROST
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You blast a target with a vicious gale filled with razor-sharp shards of ice. The target takes 2D10 piercing damage and becomes cold (page 54). If the target is wearing leather armor, the ice shreds it, reducing its armor rating by 1. The attack can be dodged as a ranged attack. Each additional power level either increases the damage by D10 or creates an additional hailstorm that strikes another target within range.



ROCK TORNADO

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** STONEWALL and WHIRLWIND
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 4 meters (sphere)

- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You conjure a raging vortex of sharp rock shards around you. All targets within range take 2D8 bludgeoning damage. The attack can be dodged as a ranged attack. Each additional power level increases the range by 4 meters and deals another D8 damage.



SCALDING SHOWER

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** UNDINE and FIREBALL
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You gather and heat moisture from the ground and air into a sphere of boiling water above an intended target, then let it crash down. The target takes 2D10 damage and everyone within 2 meters of the target suffers 2D4 damage. Armor has no effect, but the attack can be dodged as a ranged attack. With each additional power level, the spell inflicts another D10 damage on the primary target and another D4 on everyone within 2 meters.



CONJURE

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** FIREBOMB, HAILSTORM, SCALDING SHOWER, or ROCK TORNADO
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

By drawing power and matter from your surroundings, you have developed the near-godlike ability to conjure an inanimate object out of thin air. You must choose a Common item with a maximum weight of 1 from chapter 6. The GM may allow items not found on the list, but you can only create

generic items – for example, not a key to a specific lock. At power level 2, you can create an Uncommon or a heavier item (up to weight 4). Power level 3 allows you to create a Rare item or an object as large as a cart, a rowboat, or a small hut.

Conjured objects are unstable and crumble to dust after one shift unless you combine **CONJURE** with **PERMANENCE**.



ELEMENTAL PATH

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** FIREBOMB, HAILSTORM, SCALDING SHOWER, or ROCK TORNADO
- ◆ **Requirement:** Gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Personal
- ◆ **Duration:** Stretch

You are immune to damage from natural elements, and damage from their magickal elemental effects is halved (after armor is applied, rounded up). In addition, you can move at normal speed through magma, earth, air (hovering), and water (without the need for air). The only exceptions are earth that is rich in metal and solid bedrock. Each additional power level increases the duration by one stretch.



METEOR SWARM

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** FIREBOMB and ROCK TORNADO
- ◆ **Requirement:** Word, gesture
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** 100 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

You summon a rain of burning meteors that streak down from the sky toward a point within range. Everyone within 6 meters of that point takes 2D10 bludgeoning and fire damage. The attack can be

dodged as a ranged attack. Each additional power level increases the damage by D10 and the blast radius by 4 meters.

SYMBOLISM



HOW SYMBOLIST SORCERY WORKS

Symbolism does not function quite like other schools of sorcery. Its spells (though not its magickal tricks) are typically cast by carving (takes one shift) or drawing (takes one stretch) a magickal symbol or simply tracing it in the air (counts as an action). Unless otherwise specified, the duration of a magickal symbol is equal to the casting time (one round for symbols traced in the air). Once the duration expires, the symbol's effect ends. Symbols can be **DISPELLED** just like other spells.

Permanent Symbols: A symbol's effect can be made permanent using **PERMANENCE** (above), but this requires the symbol to be carved into a durable material. **MAGICKAL SEAL** cannot be used on symbolist spells (and are generally unnecessary, as their effects are already bound to an object and persist without the need for additional power).

Requirement: All symbolist spells that follow the rules above have the symbol requirement.

SEEING A SYMBOL

Many symbolist spells are triggered when someone sees the symbol. The general rule is that an intelligent creature who is within range of the symbol (usually 20 meters), and facing it, immediately sees the symbol. The GM has the final say in unclear situations. The symbolist's allies or others aware of the danger may attempt to look away, but doing so requires a successful **EVADE** roll (not an action) each turn. On failure, the character inadvertently catches a glimpse of the symbol and suffers its effect. It is of course possible to blindfold oneself to avoid a

symbol's effects – however, a blindfolded person acts as if in total darkness (page 52).

Large Symbols: You can increase the range of a symbol by drawing or carving it larger. For each additional stretch (or shift if you are carving) spent creating the symbol, the range increases by 5 meters. You must decide the size of the symbol before you start drawing it. Roll for the spell once you have finished creating the symbol.



MAGICKAL TRICKS

Unlike other symbolist spells, these tricks do not require a symbol to be drawn.

Cipher: You turn a written text into a personal cipher so that only a named person you know can read it normally. The effect can be **DISPELLED**.

Dictation: A quill writes down exactly what you say, word for word, for a stretch of time.

Erase: You erase one page of text that has not been carved into a durable material, simply by looking at it.

Speed Reading: You can read one page of text per breath, retaining the information as if you had read it at a normal pace. You can learn something from a book (e.g. a spell) in a stretch instead of a shift (page 61).



FARSCRIBE

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Symbolism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** 100 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Stretch/shift

This symbol must be drawn or carved, not just traced in the air. If you then write or draw something on the symbol, you can project that text or image onto any flat surface within range. The text appears as glowing script at the same pace as you write it. The target surface does not need to be within sight, but

you must have seen it previously. Power level 2 increases the range to 1 kilometer, and power level 3 increases it to 10 kilometers.



HESITATION

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Symbolism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Round/stretch/shift

Anyone who sees your symbol must make a ☹ roll on their turn (not an action). On failure, the victim is gripped by doubt and hesitation, forcing them to act last in the initiative order for the rest of the encounter (if in combat) and imposing a bane on all skill rolls. The ☹ roll is made with a boon at power level 1, normally at power level 2, and with a bane at power level 3. A new attempt to resist the effect can be made each turn; once a roll succeeds, the effect ends for that individual.



LURE

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Symbolism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Round/stretch/shift

Your symbol entices everyone who sees it to draw closer. Anyone who sees the symbol must make a ☹ roll (not an action) on their turn. On failure, the victim must move toward the symbol at their normal movement rate (no dashing required). They cannot look away, which gives them a bane on **AWARENESS**. The ☹ roll is made with a boon at power level 1, normally at power level 2, and with a bane at power level 3. Victims are still fully capable of fighting; only their movement is affected. A new

attempt to resist the effect may be made each turn; once a roll succeeds, the effect ends for that individual.



SHIELD RUNE

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Symbolism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Round/stretch/shift

Your symbol creates an invisible shield around a person, imposing one bane per power level on all non-magickal attacks made against them. You may cast this spell on yourself.



SUNDER

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Symbolism
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Instant

By quickly drawing this symbol on a non-magickal inanimate object, such as a weapon or a door, you inflict 2D10 damage (ignoring armor rating) on the object. Each additional power level increases the damage by D10.



FORTIFY

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** SUNDER
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Round/stretch/shift

Your symbol reinforces a door, wall, bridge, or pillar for the duration. The object's armor rating increases by 10 points per power level.



HALT

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** HESITATION
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Round/stretch/shift

Anyone who sees your symbol must succeed at a ☹ roll to be able to move toward it at all. They roll with a boon at power level 1, normally at power level 2, and with a bane at power level 3. A new attempt to resist the effect may be made each turn; once a roll succeeds, the effect ends for that individual.



MAGICKAL ARMOR

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** SHIELD RUNE
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Round/stretch/shift

Your symbol protects a person against sorcery. You may cast this spell on yourself. Any spell cast on the protected individual is rolled with one bane per power level.



TELEPORTATION WARD

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** FARSCRIBE
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** Touch

- ◆ **Duration:** Round/stretch/shift

The symbol prevents all forms of teleportation and other magical transport to or from a specific location. Power level 1 wards a room, power level 2 wards a building, and power level 3 wards an entire city.



ARCANE VORTEX

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** TELEPORTATION WARD and MAGICKAL ARMOR
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters (sphere)
- ◆ **Duration:** Action/stretch/shift

Your symbol creates a vortex that consumes all magical energy in its vicinity. Anyone within range loses D6 WP per power level upon first entering the vortex, and each power level imposes a bane on all attempts to cast spells inside the vortex. Attacks made with magical weapons inside the vortex no longer count as magical (though the items retain all non-magical effects). You are not affected by the vortex, but everyone else is, whether friend or foe.



HORRIFY

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** HALT
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Round/stretch/shift

Everyone who sees the symbol must succeed at a ☹ roll with a bane or be forced to roll on the Fear Table (page 53). Roll one D8 per power level and use the highest result. This spell has no effect on monsters or undead.



POWER SOURCE

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** FORTIFY
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** 10 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Action/stretch/shift

Everyone within range (except yourself) recovers D6 WP and heals one condition per power level. The effect occurs when the spell is cast or when a person comes within range of the symbol while it is active. Everyone except you is affected, whether friend or foe. A person can only benefit from the symbol once per casting.



RETRIBUTION RUNE

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** MAGICKAL ARMOR
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** Personal
- ◆ **Duration:** Round/stretch/shift

Your symbol creates an invisible shield around a person, imposing one bane per power level on all non-magical attacks made against them. You may cast this spell on yourself. If an attack against the protected individual misses, it hits the attacker instead.



BLIND

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** HORRIFY
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Round/stretch/shift

Anyone who sees your symbol must succeed at a ☹ roll (not an action) or be blinded for one stretch. While blinded, they act as if in complete darkness (page 52). They make the ☹ roll with a boon at power level 1, normally at power level 2, and with a bane at power level 3. Once the effect ends, the victim is immune to the effect of this specific symbol. This spell has no effect on monsters or undead.



GOLEM

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** POWER SOURCE and RETRIBUTION RUNE
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Stretch/shift

By drawing or carving symbols upon a clay figure or stone statue, you bring it to life as a golem. The golem serves as your bodyguard and obeys your commands. For stats, see below.

GOLEM

Weapon: Stone fists. Hits automatically in melee (but can be dodged or parried) and deals D6 bludgeoning damage per power level.



PORTAL

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** ARCANE VORTEX
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** 100 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Action/stretch/shift

The symbol creates a portal to another location within one kilometer. You must either be able to see

your destination or have visited it previously. Creatures up to human size can pass through the portal as a normal movement. Power level 2 increases the range to 10 kilometers, and power level 3 increases it to 100 kilometers.



REFLECT SORCERY

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** RETRIBUTION RUNE and ARCANE VORTEX
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** Personal
- ◆ **Duration:** Round/stretch/shift

Your symbol protects a person against sorcery and may reflect hostile spells back at the attacker. You may cast this spell on yourself. Any spell cast on the protected individual by another sorcerer (not yourself) is rolled with one bane per power level. If an affected spell fails, the sorcerer who cast it suffers its effect instead. In unclear situations, the GM determines the outcome.



PETRIFY

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** GOLEM and BLIND
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Action/stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Action/stretch/shift

Anyone who sees the symbol must succeed at a ☹ roll or be turned to stone for the duration. They roll with a boon at power level 1, normally at power level 2, and with a bane at power level 3. While petrified, the victims cannot move or perform any actions (not even speak), but gain armor rating 10. The victims'

Movement: 8

HP: 8 per power level

Armor: 6

gear is petrified along with them. This spell has no effect on monsters or undead.



RAISE FORTRESS

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** GOLEM
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Shift
- ◆ **Range:** Touch
- ◆ **Duration:** Shift

By carving your symbols into the living rock, you raise an entire structure of stone. The power level determines the type of structure you create. Power level 1 raises a small cottage, power level 2 raises a two-story tower, and power level 3 raises a walled castle. The building's walls and fortifications have an armor rating equal to 10 times the power level and can withstand 20 points of damage per power level before collapsing. Once the duration expires, the structure crumbles into sand.



RUNIC PRISON

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** ARCANE VORTEX and PORTAL
- ◆ **Requirement:** Symbol
- ◆ **Casting Time:** Stretch/shift
- ◆ **Range:** 20 meters
- ◆ **Duration:** Stretch/shift

You draw or carve a symbol containing a person's name. If that creature sees the symbol, they must succeed at a ☉ roll or be pulled into the symbol, remaining imprisoned there for the duration along with their gear. They make the ☉ roll with a boon at power level 1, normally at power level 2, and with a bane at power level 3. You can draw/carve this symbol on an object and carry it with you. If the spell is made permanent through PERMANENCE, the

victim does not age while imprisoned. This spell has no effect on monsters or undead.

ALCHEMY



HOW ALCHEMY WORKS

Alchemy differs from other schools of sorcery in that you do not cast spells directly on your surroundings. Instead you create magickal substances, often in the form of potions. Unless otherwise stated in the recipe, the substance is consumed or applied (as an action), whereupon its effect occurs immediately.

Preparation: Preparing an alchemical recipe normally takes one shift. An **ALCHEMY** roll determines whether you succeed. You make the roll and spend your **WP** at the end of the preparation process. If successful, you produce one dose of the substance and each additional power level yields one more dose. Each dose counts as a separate item.

Power Level: With the exception of poisons, alchemical substances do not have power levels. Instead, the power level determines how many doses you produce.

Ingredients: Alchemical recipes require specific ingredients, which are listed with each recipe. These ingredients are consumed when the recipe is prepared, even if the roll fails. You can read more about ingredients under Ingredients, below.

Laboratory: To prepare an alchemical recipe, you need access to tools such as cauldrons, mortars and pestles, funnels, flasks, and vials to store the finished potions. A small field laboratory containing the most essential tools counts as a Rare item with weight 1 and normally costs 50 gold. However, newly created alchemists gain such a field laboratory as part of their starting gear.

All recipes in this school of sorcery have the alchemical laboratory requirement, and it is therefore not listed individually for each recipe. Alchemical recipes can be prepared in an ordinary kitchen, but this imposes a bane on the **ALCHEMY** roll.



Conversely, a large and well-equipped alchemical laboratory that occupies an entire room grants a boon on the roll, but costs at least 500 gold.

Shelf Life: Once prepared, an alchemical substance remains potent forever, or at least long enough that it has no practical relevance. An alchemical substance cannot be neutralised with **DISPEL** – once brewed, the only way to be rid of a dose is to destroy it.

INGREDIENTS

Every alchemical recipe requires certain ingredients. There are all kinds of ingredients, and they are measured in doses. One dose of each listed ingredient is required to produce one dose of the finished substance, unless otherwise stated. Doses of ingredients count as tiny items. See the list below for examples of common (and less common) ingredients.

General Herbs: A basic ingredient required for many recipes is general herbs. As an alchemist, it is wise to always keep a small supply of general herbs in your pack.

Finding Herbs: If you spend a shift foraging plants in the wild (page 103) and succeed at your **BUSHCRAFT** roll, you may choose to find D6 doses of general herbs instead of food. Rarer herbs may also be found if the GM deems it reasonable, but usually only one dose per successful roll.

Extracting Ingredients: Some rarer ingredients must be extracted from (usually) dead animals and monsters. This takes a stretch of time and requires a **BEAST LORE** roll. A successful roll yields D3 doses of the ingredient, while rolling a dragon yields D6 doses. If the roll fails, no further attempts can be made on the same creature.

INGREDIENT	COST	SUPPLY	INGREDIENT	COST	SUPPLY
Ambergris	3 gold	Rare	Hyena Tooth	5 silver	Rare
Auroch Blood	3 gold	Rare	Iron Filings	1 silver	Common
Balsam	1 gold	Rare	Lodestone	1 gold	Rare
Basilisk Blood	10 gold	Unique	Manticore Spike	2 gold	Rare
Basilisk Eye	10 gold	Unique	Marrow Fat	5 silver	Uncommon
Bat Blood	2 silver	Uncommon	Mead	5 copper	Common
Bear Tooth	4 silver	Uncommon	Mummia	8 gold	Unique
Bitumen	1 silver	Common	Octopus Ink	5 silver	Rare
Boar Tusk	2 silver	Uncommon	Quicksilver	5 gold	Rare
Charcoal	5 copper	Common	Rhinoceros Horn	4 gold	Rare
Cinnabar	7 gold	Unique	Saltpeter	1 silver	Uncommon
Daedra Heart	10 gold	Unique	Sea Serpent Bile	2 gold	Rare
Deer Antler	2 silver	Uncommon	Spider Venom	3 gold	Rare
General Herbs	2 silver	Common	Sulfur	3 silver	Uncommon
Gravewax	1 gold	Rare	Vitriol	2 gold	Rare
Hydra Blood	6 gold	Unique	Wolf Blood	3 silver	Uncommon



MAGICKAL TRICKS

Unlike most other schools of sorcery, alchemy has no magickal tricks.



FOCUS TONIC

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Alchemy
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, wolf blood

Cures the Dazed condition.



HERBAL INFUSION

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Alchemy
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs

Grants a boon on **HEALING** rolls to tend to someone suffering from a disease (page 53).



INVIGORATING DECOCTION

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Alchemy
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, boar tusk

Cures the Exhausted condition.



LIQUID COURAGE

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Alchemy
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, bear tooth

Cures the Scared condition.



MEDICINAL WATER

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Alchemy

- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, deer antler

Cures the Sickly condition.



PARALYZING POISON

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Alchemy
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, bat blood

See page 53. Can be ingested by a target or applied to a weapon. The poison has potency 12, plus 3 for each additional power level.



SOOTHING BREW

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Alchemy
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, mead

Cures the Angry condition.



SPIRITLIFTER

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Alchemy
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, sulfur

Cures the Disheartened condition.



STUN POWDER

- ◆ **Rank:** 1
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** Alchemy
- ◆ **Ingredients:** Saltpeter, sulfur

Can be blown into the face of a target within 4 meters (**BRAWLING** roll). If hit, the target becomes Dazed.



ANTIDOTE

- ◆ **Rank:** 2



- ◆ **Prerequisite:** PARALYZING POISON
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, sea serpent bile

Cancels the full effect of a poison (page 52). Any limited effects remain.



HEALING DRAUGHT

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** HERBAL INFUSION
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, marrow fat

Immediately restores D6 HP.



LOCK ACID

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** SPIRITLIFTER
- ◆ **Ingredients:** Sulfur, vitriol

Corrodes and destroys a lock or other small metal object in one stretch.



LOVE POTION

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** LIQUID COURAGE and FOCUS TONIC
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, ambergris

Grants a boon on all ☯-based skill rolls directed at the person who drank the potion. The effect lasts for one shift.



PUFF BOMB

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** STUN POWDER
- ◆ **Ingredients:** Charcoal, saltpeter, sulfur

Can be thrown up to ☯ meters (**BRAWLING** roll) and deals D8 fire damage on a hit. Can also be used to light a campfire.



SLEEPING POISON

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** PARALYZING POISON
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, spider venom

See page 53. Can be ingested by a target or applied to a weapon. The poison has potency 12, plus 3 for each additional power level.



SMOKESCREEN

- ◆ **Rank:** 2
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** STUN POWDER
- ◆ **Ingredients:** Charcoal, saltpeter, sulfur, octopus ink

A smoke bomb that can be thrown up to ☯ meters. It creates a thick cloud of smoke in a 4-meter radius around the point of impact. The smoke blocks all vision, and everyone in the area of effect acts as if in complete darkness (page 52). At the start of each round, roll a D4 outdoors or a D8 indoors. On a 1, the smoke dissipates.



CORROSIVE SLUDGE

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** LOCK ACID
- ◆ **Ingredients:** Sulfur, vitriol, gravewax

A viscous acid that can be thrown up to ☯ meters (**BRAWLING** roll) and deals D8 damage on a hit. If the target is wearing armor, its armor rating is permanently reduced by the same amount (does not affect natural armor).



DROPS OF STRENGTH

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** ANTIDOTE and INVIGORATING DECOCTION
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, auroch blood

Increases  to 18 for one shift, raising the consumer's  damage bonus (to +D6) and carrying capacity (to 9). Also cures the Exhausted condition and grants a boon on all -based skill rolls (skill levels are unaffected).



ELIXIR OF WISDOM

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** ANTIDOTE and SOOTHING BREW
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, lodestone

Grants a boon on all -based skill rolls for one shift. Also cures the Angry condition.



HEALING POTION

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** HEALING DRAUGHT
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, balsam

Immediately restores 2D6 HP.



LETHAL POISON

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** SLEEPING POISON
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, spider venom

See page 52. Can be ingested by a target or applied to a weapon. The poison has potency 12, plus 3 for each additional power level.



NIMBLE NECTAR

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** ANTIDOTE and FOCUS TONIC
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, quicksilver

Increases  to 18 for one shift, raising the consumer's  damage bonus (to +D6) and

movement rate (page 25). Also cures the Dazed condition and grants a boon on all -based skill rolls (skill levels are unaffected).



SUNFLASH

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** PUFF BOMB
- ◆ **Ingredients:** Charcoal, saltpeter, sulfur, manticore spike

Creates a bright flash when thrown on the ground. Everyone within 10 meters who is unprepared must succeed at an **EVADE** roll (not an action) or be blinded and lose their next turn. They cannot perform reactions until then.



TINCTURE OF BEAUTY

- ◆ **Rank:** 3
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** SPIRITLIFTER and LOVE POTION
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, cinnabar

Grants a boon on all -based skill rolls for one shift. Also cures the Disheartened condition.



BATTLE FUMES

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** DROPS OF STRENGTH
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, saltpeter, sulfur, auroch blood

A bubbling cauldron that releases strengthening fumes for one shift. Anyone who takes a Stretch rest within 4 meters of the cauldron gains a boon on all melee attacks for the next shift.



EXPLOSIVE ORB

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** SUNFLASH



- ◆ **Ingredients:** Charcoal, saltpeter, sulfur, iron filings

Can be thrown up to 🎯 meters (**BRAWLING** roll), dealing 3D6 bludgeoning damage to the target and everyone within 4 meters of the target.



HEALING TINCTURE

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** HEALING POTION
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, hydra blood

Immediately restores 3D6 **HP** and 3D6 **WP**.



HEALING VAPORS

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** HEALING POTION, SMOKESCREEN
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, saltpeter, sulfur, balsam

A bubbling cauldron that releases healing vapors for one shift. Anyone who takes a Stretch rest within 4 meters of the cauldron gains the full benefits of a Shift rest.



PHILOSOPHER'S STONE

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** ELIXIR OF WISDOM
- ◆ **Ingredients:** Daedra heart, basilisk blood

Produces one dose of Philosopher's Stone, which is used as an ingredient in other recipes.



TOXIC MIST

- ◆ **Rank:** 4
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** LETHAL POISON and SMOKESCREEN

- ◆ **Ingredients:** Charcoal, saltpeter, sulfur, spider venom

A poison bomb that can be thrown up to 🎯 meters. It produces a toxic mist in a 4-meter radius around the point of impact. Anyone in the area of effect is afflicted by a paralyzing, sleeping, or lethal poison (user's choice) with potency 15.



CREATE GOLD

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** PHILOSOPHER'S STONE
- ◆ **Ingredients:** Philosopher's stone, iron filings

Each dose created transmutes into gold (worth D8 × 10 gold coins).



ELIXIR OF LIFE

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** HEALING TINCTURE
- ◆ **Ingredients:** General herbs, philosopher's stone, hydra blood

Immediately restores all lost **HP** and **WP**. Also cures all conditions, diseases, poison effects, and severe injuries. Anyone at 0 **HP** who drinks the Elixir of Life stops making death rolls.



GARGOYLE

- ◆ **Rank:** 5
- ◆ **Prerequisite:** PHILOSOPHER'S STONE
- ◆ **Ingredients:** Philosopher's stone, gravewax, balsam

A squat stone figure about 30 cm tall, which climbs down off the workbench and follows your commands. It has 6 **HP**, Movement 8, skill level 15 in **SNEAKING** and **EVADE**, and increases your maximum **WP** by 2 while within 10 meters of you. However, the gargoyle is disobedient and must be **PERSUADED** daily not to wander off.



GEAR



This Chapter covers various kinds of goods and services available in the world of *Dragonbane* and their usual cost. The tables also list the items' weight (page 28) and mechanical effects.



SUPPLY

Some goods and services are rare, and the player characters cannot expect to find everything they are looking for in any little village. Each listed item has a supply rating, graded on the following scale.

- ◆ **Common:** Available in any village or marketplace.
- ◆ **Uncommon:** Can usually only be purchased from the artisan making it, which does not necessarily mean it will be available in every village.
- ◆ **Rare:** Must generally be specially ordered from artisans.
- ◆ **Unique:** Can only be obtained in treasure troves or from the person who found the precious item.



WEAPONS & ARMOR

As an adventurer, you always want a weapon close at hand – you never know where danger may be lurking. The tables on pages 74–75 list common types of weapons. The values shown in the tables are explained below.

Grip indicates if you need one or two hands to wield the weapon. Read more on page 45.

☞ indicates how much ☞ you need to use the weapon effectively. Read more on page 45.

Damage indicates how much damage the weapon inflicts on a hit. The damage can be increased by Damage Bonus and decreased by armor.

Durability determines how much damage you can parry without damaging the weapon. Read more about parrying on page 46.

Range indicates the maximum range in meters at which the weapon can be used effectively. Read more on page 49.

Cost indicates the weapon's typical price. The actual price can vary depending on local supply and demand.

Features indicates which features the weapon has:

- ◆ **Subtle:** The weapon grants a boon and increased damage when performing sneak attacks (page 43).
- ◆ **Long:** Attacks with this melee weapon can hit an enemy up to 4 meters away (two squares).
- ◆ **Toppling:** The weapon grants a boon when trying to topple an opponent (page 48).
- ◆ **Piercing:** The weapon inflicts piercing damage, which can affect the effectiveness of armor (page 50).
- ◆ **Slashing:** The weapon inflicts slashing damage. If the weapon is both slashing and piercing, you must choose whether to slash or pierce before rolling the attack.
- ◆ **Bludgeoning:** The weapon inflicts bludgeoning damage, which affects the effectiveness of armor (page 50).

Armor Rating indicates the amount of damage the armor subtracts from an attack. You can only wear one suit of armor at a time, but armor can be combined with a helmet.



ARMOR & HELMETS

ARMOR	ARMOR RATING	COST	SUPPLY	EFFECT
Leather	1	2 silver	Common	—
Studded Leather	2	10 silver	Uncommon	Bane on SNEAKING rolls.
Chainmail	4	50 silver	Uncommon	Bane on EVADE and SNEAKING rolls.
Plate Armor	6	500 silver	Rare	Bane on ACROBATICS , EVADE , and SNEAKING rolls.
Open Helmet	+1	12 silver	Uncommon	Bane on AWARENESS rolls.
Great Helm	+2	100 silver	Rare	Bane on AWARENESS and all ranged attacks.



ARMOR AGAINST DAMAGE TYPES

An armor's rating is not the same against every kind of attack (page 50). Padding turns a blow aside but parts under an edge; mail does the opposite; plate turns everything but is still a shell over a body, and a hard enough impact is felt through it. The table below gives each armor's effective rating against each damage type. Helmets add their rating against all three.

ARMOR	VS SLASHING	VS PIERCING	VS BLUDGEONING
Leather	1	1	3
Studded Leather	2	2	4
Chainmail	6	4	4
Plate Armor	6	6	5

MELEE WEAPONS

WEAPON	GRIP	☺	RANGE	DAMAGE	DURABILITY	COST	SUPPLY	FEATURES
Unarmed	—	—	2	D6	—	—	—	Bludgeoning
Blunt Object, Light	1H	—	☺	D8	3	—	—	Bludgeoning, can be thrown
Blunt Object, Heavy	2H	16	2	2D8	3	—	—	Bludgeoning
Knife	1H	—	☺	D8	6	5 orichalcum	Common	Subtle, piercing, can be thrown



WEAPON	GRIP	☞	RANGE	DAMAGE	DURABILITY	COST	SUPPLY	FEATURES
Dagger	1H	—	☞	D8	9	1 silver	Common	Subtle, piercing, slashing, can be thrown
Parrying Dagger	1H	—	2	D6	15	2 silver	Uncommon	Subtle, piercing, slashing
Short Sword	1H	7	2	D10	12	8 silver	Common	Piercing, slashing
Broadsword	1H	10	2	2D6	15	12 silver	Common	Piercing, slashing
Longsword	1H	13	2	2D8	15	25 silver	Uncommon	Piercing, slashing
Greatsword	2H	16	2	2D10	15	50 silver	Rare	Piercing, slashing
Scimitar	1H	10	2	2D6	12	10 silver	Uncommon	Toppling, slashing
Handaxe	1H	7	☞	2D6	9	2 silver	Common	Toppling, slashing, can be thrown
Battleaxe	1H	13	2	2D8	9	10 silver	Uncommon	Toppling, slashing
Two-Handed Axe	2H	16	2	2D10	9	25 silver	Uncommon	Toppling, slashing
Mace	1H	7	2	2D4	12	8 silver	Common	Bludgeoning
Morningstar	1H	13	2	2D8	12	14 silver	Uncommon	Bludgeoning
Flail	1H	13	2	2D8	—	16 silver	Uncommon	Bludgeoning, toppling, cannot be used for parrying
Warhammer, Light	1H	10	2	2D6	12	10 silver	Uncommon	Bludgeoning, toppling
Warhammer, Heavy	2H	16	2	2D10	12	20 silver	Uncommon	Bludgeoning, toppling
Wooden Club, Small	1H	7	2	D8	9	1 orichalcum	Common	Bludgeoning
Wooden Club, Large	2H	16	2	2D8	12	2 orichalcum	Common	Bludgeoning
Staff	2H	7	2	D8	9	2 orichalcum	Common	Bludgeoning, toppling
Short Spear	1H	7	STR×2	D10	9	5 orichalcum	Common	Piercing, can be thrown
Long Spear	2H	10	4	2D8	9	1 silver	Common	Long, piercing
Lance	1H	13	4	2D10	12	12 silver	Rare	Long, piercing, requires combat trained mount
Halberd	2H	13	4	2D8	12	20 silver	Rare	Long, toppling, piercing, slashing
Trident	1H	10	☞	2D6	9	5 silver	Uncommon	Toppling, piercing, can be thrown
Shield, Small	1H	7	2	D8	15	4 silver	Common	Bludgeoning
Shield, Large	1H	13	2	D8	18	12 silver	Common	Bludgeoning
Mastercrafted						×10		Reduces ☞ requirement by 3, increases durability by 3

RANGED WEAPONS

WEAPON	GRIP	☹	RANGE	DAMAGE	DURABILITY	COST	SUPPLY	FEATURES
Sling	1H	—	20	D8	—	1 orichalcum	Common	Bludgeoning, tiny item
Short Bow	2H	7	30	D10	3	25 silver	Common	Piercing, requires quiver
Longbow	2H	13	100	D12	6	50 silver	Uncommon	Piercing, requires quiver
Cannon, Light	2H	7	40	2D6	6	75 silver	Uncommon	Piercing, requires fire salts, no damage bonus
Cannon, Heavy	2H	13	60	8D8	9	—	Unique	Piercing, requires fire salts, no damage bonus
Cannon, Hand	1H	7	30	2D6	6	90 silver	Rare	Piercing, requires fire salts, no damage bonus

CLOTHES

GARMENT	COST	SUPPLY	EFFECT
Boots	2 silver	Uncommon	Protects against some journey mishaps (page 102).
Cloak	8 orichalcum	Uncommon	Protects against some journey mishaps (page 102).
Fine Garments	10 silver	Uncommon	Boon on ☹-based skills when the GM finds it reasonable.
Fur	1 silver	Uncommon	Boon on BUSHCRAFT for resisting cold (page 54).
Rags	5 lead	Common	Bane on ☹-based skills when the GM finds it reasonable.
Simple Clothes	5 orichalcum	Common	Required to avoid a bane on ☹-based skills.

MUSICAL INSTRUMENTS

ITEM	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Bagpipe	30 silver	Uncommon	1	Reduces the WP cost of the Musician ability to 1 and increases range to 50 meters.
Drum	4 silver	Common	1	Increases the range of the Musician ability to 20 meters.
Flute	2 silver	Common	1	Reduces the WP cost of the Musician ability to 2.
Harp	8 silver	Uncommon	2	Reduces the WP cost of the Musician ability to 1.
Horn	6 silver	Common	1	Increases the range of the Musician ability to 100 meters.

ITEM	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Lyre	20 silver	Uncommon	1	Reduces the WP cost of the Musician ability to 1.

TRADE GOODS

ITEM	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Abacus	2 silver	Common	1	Boon on 🎲 rolls for solving mathematical problems.
Blanket	5 orichalcum	Common	1	Required to avoid a bane on rolls to avoid the effects of cold (page 54).
Chess Set	1 silver	Common	1	Opposed roll for 🎲 determines who wins.
Dice	1 orichalcum	Common	—	Chance determines who wins.
Field Kitchen	4 silver	Common	2	Boon on BUSHCRAFT rolls for cooking (page 103).
Field Ration	1 orichalcum	Common	1/4	One ration must be consumed per day, otherwise you become hungry (page 54).
Fire Salts	5 silver	Uncommon	1	Required to fire a cannon. Ruined if they get wet.
Grappling Hook	3 silver	Common	1	Can be used to secure a rope. Can be thrown and secured with an ACROBATICS roll up to 🎲 meters (🎲 × 2 with a bane).
Lockpicks, Advanced	20 silver	Rare	1	Boon on SLEIGHT OF HAND rolls for picking locks.
Lockpicks, Simple	1 silver	Uncommon	1	Required to avoid a bane on SLEIGHT OF HAND rolls for picking locks.
Magnifying Glass	30 silver	Uncommon	1	Boon to SPOT HIDDEN rolls.

ITEM	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Map	5 silver	Uncommon	—	Required to avoid a bane on BUSHCRAFT rolls for leading the way during journeys.
Marbles	1 silver	Common	1	Can be thrown at a humanoid enemy within 10 meters, as an action. Next turn the enemy must make an EVADE roll (not an action) in order to move.
Padlock	10 silver	Common	—	Locks a door or chest. Can take 20 points of damage, armor rating 5.
Perfume (10 doses)	5 silver	Common	1	Boon on 🎲-based skill rolls when the GM finds it reasonable.
Playing Cards	5 orichalcum	Uncommon	—	Opposed roll for BLUFFING determines who wins.
Quiver of Arrows, Iron Head	2 silver	Common	1	Required to fire a bow.
Quiver of Arrows, Wooden Head	5 orichalcum	Common	1	Required to fire a bow. The effectiveness of armor is doubled.
Rope, Hemp (10 meters)	1 silver	Common	1	Boon on ACROBATICS rolls for climbing, but the rope must be secured to something.
Rope, Silk (10 meters)	10 silver	Uncommon	—	Boon on ACROBATICS rolls for climbing, but the rope must be secured to something.
Saddle	10 silver	Common	1	Required to avoid a bane when fighting from the saddle.
Sleeping Fur	1 silver	Common	1	Required to avoid a bane on BUSHCRAFT rolls for making camp.
Spyglass	50 silver	Rare	1	Boon on BUSHCRAFT rolls for leading the way during journeys.

ITEM	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Tent, Small	2 silver	Common	2	Can accommodate up to two people. Grants a boon on BUSHCRAFT rolls for making camp. Only one person rolls, but others can help.
Tent, Large	4 silver	Common	4	Can accommodate up to six people. Grants a boon on BUSHCRAFT rolls for making camp. Only one person rolls, but others can help.
Whistle	5 orichalcum	Common	—	Can be heard from up to 100 meters away.

STUDIES & SORCERY

ITEM	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Amulet	3 silver	Uncommon	—	Can be used as a focus for spells.
Book	25 silver	Uncommon	1	Boon on skill rolls in a specific subject. The cost varies depending on the subject.
Brooch	5 silver	Uncommon	—	Can be used as a focus for spells.
Chalk	1 lead	Common	—	Can be used as a focus for spells.
Grimoire	50 silver	Unique	1	The cost varies depending on the content and may be much higher.
Hourglass	25 silver	Rare	1	Can be used as a focus for spells.
Notebook	5 silver	Common	1	Empty, can be used as a grimoire.
Orbuculum	18 silver	Uncommon	1	Can be used as a focus for spells.
Paper (sheet)	2 orichalcum	Uncommon	—	Can be used to write down spells.
Parchment (sheet)	1 orichalcum	Common	—	Can be used to write down spells.
Quill & Ink	10 silver	Uncommon	1	Can be used to write down spells.
Reliquary	5 silver	Uncommon	1	Can be used as a focus for spells.
Wand	10 silver	Uncommon	1	Can be used as a focus for spells.

LIGHT SOURCES

ITEM	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Flint & Tinder	5 orichalcum	Common	—	Required to light torches, candles, or lanterns, and to make a fire.
Lamp Oil	3 orichalcum	Common	1	Holds ten doses. Each dose keeps an oil lamp or lantern burning for up to one shift of time.
Lantern	10 silver	Common	1	Illuminates a 10 meter radius. Burns for up to a shift of time, but roll D8 after each stretch of time. On 1 the lantern goes out and must be refilled and relit (action).
Oil Lamp	1 silver	Common	1	Illuminates a 10 meter radius. Burns for up to a shift of time, but roll D6 after each stretch of time. On 1 the lamp goes out and must be refilled and relit (action).
Tallow Candle	1 lead	Common	—	Illuminates a 4 meter radius. Burns for up to a shift of time, but roll D4 after each stretch of time, or if the bearer attacks or is attacked. On 1 the candle goes out.
Torch	5 lead	Common	1	Illuminates a 10 meter radius. Burns for up to a shift of time, but roll D6 after each stretch of time, or if the torch is used as a weapon. On 1 the torch goes out.

TOOLS

TOOL	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Crowbar	2 silver	Common	1	2D6 damage against a door or wall, without risk of being damaged. Hits automatically.
Hammer	1 silver	Common	1	2D4 damage against a door or wall, without risk of being damaged. Hits automatically.
Needle & Thread	3 orichalcum	Common	—	Mends clothes with a CRAFTING roll.
Pickaxe	3 silver	Common	1	2D8 damage against a door or wall, without risk of being damaged. Hits automatically.
Saw	5 silver	Uncommon	1	Cuts metal or wood in one stretch.

TOOL	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Shovel	2 silver	Common	1	Reduces the time spent digging by half.
Sledgehammer	3 silver	Common	2	2D10 damage against a door or wall, without risk of being damaged. Hits automatically.
Blacksmithing Tools	20 silver	Uncommon	1	Used for CRAFTING (page 34).
Carpentry Tools	8 silver	Uncommon	1	Used for CRAFTING (page 34).
Tanning Tools	5 silver	Uncommon	1	Used for CRAFTING (page 34).

CONTAINERS

ITEM	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Backpack	3 silver	Common	—	Increases carrying capacity by 2. A person can only use one backpack at a time.
Barrel	2 silver	Common	2	Holds up to 15 weight units. Can take 10 points of damage, armor rating 3.
Basket	4 orichalcum	Common	1	Holds up to 10 weight units.
Bottle	1 silver	Common	1	Contains 1 unit of liquid.
Bucket	5 lead	Common	1	Contains up to 5 units of liquid.
Chest	5 silver	Common	3	Holds up to 20 weight units. Can take 25 points of damage, armor rating 5.
Clay Jug	5 orichalcum	Common	1	Contains 1 unit of liquid
Saddle Bag	6 silver	Common	—	Increases an animal's carrying capacity by 2. An animal can carry no more than two saddle bags.

MEDICINE

ITEM	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Poison, Lethal (dose)	2 silver × potency	Uncommon	1	See page 52.
Poison, Paralyzing (dose)	12 orichalcum × potency	Uncommon	1	See page 53.
Poison, Sleeping (dose)	6 orichalcum × potency	Uncommon	1	See page 53.

ITEM	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Herbal Concoction (dose)	1 silver	Uncommon	1	Boon on HEALING rolls for resisting disease (page 53).
Healing Potion (dose)	50 silver	Rare	1	Instantly heals 2D6 HP . Stronger potions heal more HP , but are more expensive.
Bandages (10)	5 orichalcum	Common	1	Required to avoid a bane on HEALING rolls for saving lives. Each attempt consumes a bandage.
Surgical Instruments	15 silver	Uncommon	1	Boon on HEALING rolls for saving a life.

SERVICES

SERVICE	COST	SUPPLY	EFFECT
Bath at an Inn	6 lead	Common	Heals a condition of your choice in one stretch. Only one bath per day has this effect.
Bodyguard	2 silver/day	Uncommon	Stats as a typical guard on page 105.
Bowl of Stew	5 lead	Common	Covers the daily need of food.
Clothes Repair	5 orichalcum	Common	Eliminates the effect of torn clothes (page 102).
Courier	1 orichalcum/kilometer	Common	Delivers a message to the recipient.
Feast	2 silver	Uncommon	Covers the daily need of food.
Goblet of Wine	2 orichalcum	Uncommon	After drinking two goblets in a single shift, each additional goblet causes a condition of your choice.
Haircut	2 orichalcum	Common	Heals a chosen condition in one stretch. Can only be done once per week.
Healing	5 silver	Uncommon	HEALING rolls succeed automatically.

Lodging at Inn, Separate Room	5 orichalcum	Common	A shift rest can be had without a BUSHCRAFT roll.
Lodging at Inn, Dormitory	1 orichalcum	Common	A shift rest can be had without a BUSHCRAFT roll, but roll D4 each shift. On a 1 someone's snoring prevents anyone else in the room from sleeping.
Lodging at Inn, Luxury Suite	2 silver	Uncommon	A shift rest can be had without a BUSHCRAFT roll.
Meal at an Inn	3 orichalcum	Common	Covers the daily need of food.
Road Toll	2 lead	Common	Allows passage.
Stagecoach	3 lead/kilometer	Common	Transportation to a specified destination.
Tankard of Mead	4 lead	Common	After drinking three tankards in a single shift, each additional tankard causes a condition of your choice.
Teacher	5 silver/shift or more	Uncommon	A shift of instruction grants an extra advancement roll (page 29).

HUNTING & FISHING

ITEM	COST	SUPPLY	WEIGHT	EFFECT
Bear Trap	3 silver	Uncommon	1	Can be used for hunting (page 103).
Fishing Rod	8 orichalcum	Common	1	Gives D4 rations of food when fishing (page 103).
Fishing Net	2 silver	Common	2	Gives D6 rations of food when fishing (page 103).
Snare	5 lead	Common	1	Can be used for hunting (page 103). Can only be used once.

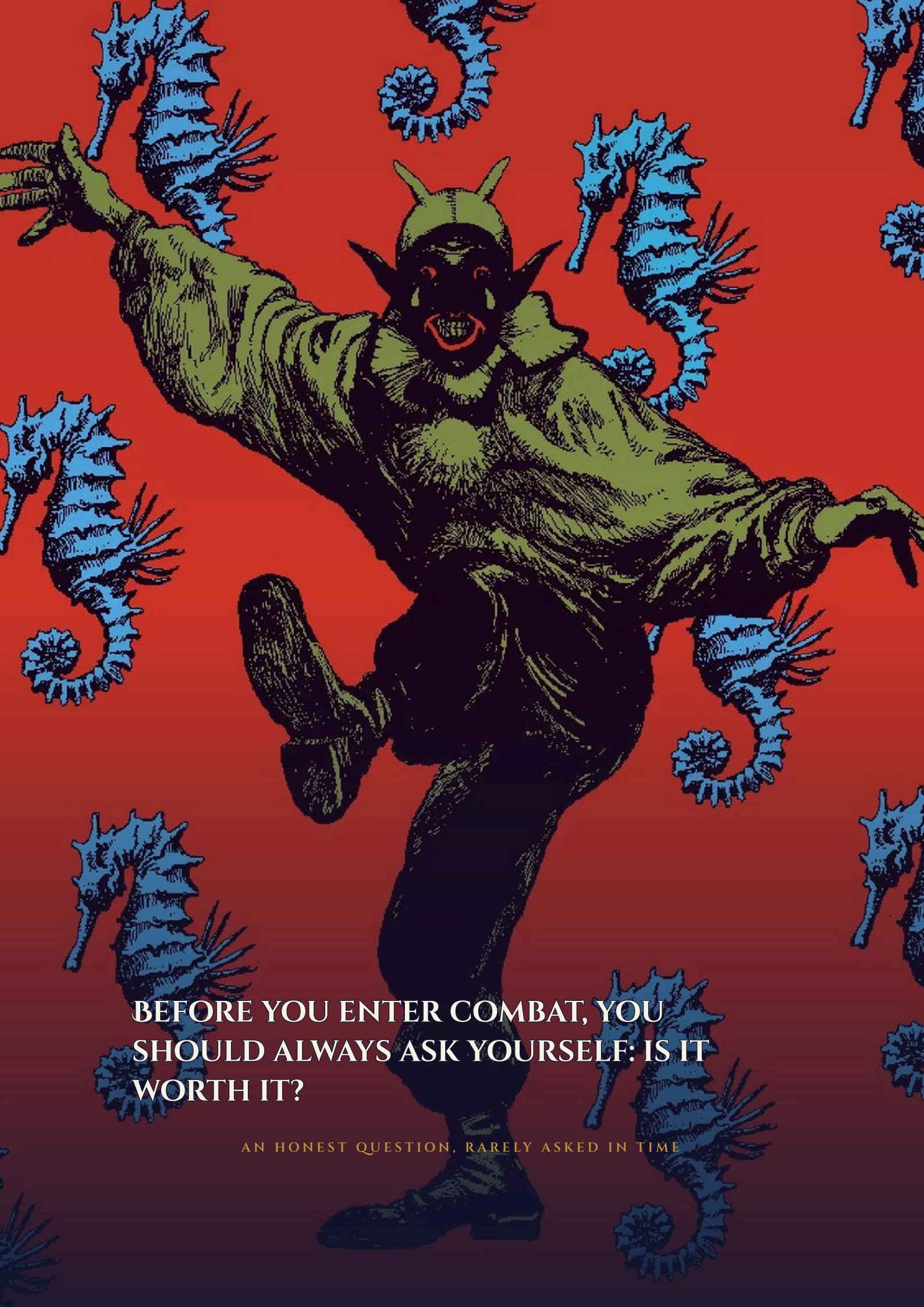
MEANS OF TRAVEL

VEHICLE	COST	SUPPLY	EFFECT
Canoe	6 silver	Common	Can carry two people and 10 weight units

VEHICLE	COST	SUPPLY	EFFECT
Cart	15 silver	Common	Pulled by one zebra or donkey. Can carry two people and 50 weight units.
Rowing Boat	15 silver	Common	Can carry four people and 50 weight units
Sailing Boat	40 silver	Uncommon	Can carry six people and 100 weight units
Wagon	30 silver	Common	Pulled by two zebras or donkeys. Can carry four people and 100 weight units.

ANIMALS

ANIMAL	COST	SUPPLY	COMMENT
Chicken	4 orichalcum	Common	Yields one ration of food when slaughtered. The meat should be cooked (page 103).
Combat Trained Zebra	400 silver	Rare	Can carry one rider and 10 weight units, or two riders
Cow	10 silver	Uncommon	Yields D4 rations of food (milk) per day, and 2D10 rations of food when slaughtered. The meat should be cooked (page 103).
Donkey	12 silver	Common	Can carry 10 weight units. Cannot be ridden.
Guard Dog	15 silver	Common	Protects its owner. For stats, see page 99.
Homing Pigeon in Cage	2 silver	Uncommon	Flies home to its dovecote when released, wherever it is
Pig	2 silver	Common	Yields 2D6 rations of food when slaughtered. The meat should be cooked (page 103).
Riding Zebra	60 silver	Uncommon	Can carry one rider and 10 weight units, or two riders
Sheep	3 silver	Common	Yields 2D4 rations of food when slaughtered. The meat should be cooked (page 103).



**BEFORE YOU ENTER COMBAT, YOU
SHOULD ALWAYS ASK YOURSELF: IS IT
WORTH IT?**

AN HONEST QUESTION, RARELY ASKED IN TIME